# Deforestation without Development? Trade, Land Use, and Technology Investments*

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**Abstract**

Does higher foreign demand for agricultural exports drive economic development through technology adoption, or simply fuel deforestation through land expansion? We study this question during Brazil's 2000s commodity boom, combining novel data on the near-universe of agricultural input purchases from cross-bank transactions with satellite data on farm-level land use. Using a shift-share shock, we find that a proportional increase in foreign demand for beef and soy causes farmers in the Amazon to reallocate land from capital-intensive soybean toward land-intensive pasture, reducing their purchases of machinery and technology as pasture replaces forest. We show that this response emerges as a privately optimal decision due to the asymmetric use of land and technology across agricultural activities, since abundant land can cause farmers to specialize in pasture, reducing the area under crop cultivation needed to justify technology investments. We then embed this mechanism in general equilibrium and find that deforestation accounted for almost half of agricultural value added growth, compared with less than 10% from technology. Lastly, we provide a welfare rationale for forest protection beyond environmental externalities, arising instead from incentivizing labor-saving modernization which reduces labor misallocation. A perfectly enforced no-deforestation tax of around US$700 per hectare redirects growth toward technology adoption and raises the welfare gains from trade by more than 75 percent.

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**JEL Codes**: O11, O13, F14, F18, Q15, Q17, Q23, Q56.

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## 1 Introduction

Trade is well established as a driver of technology adoption among manufacturing firms, in which access to foreign markets raises revenues and stimulates investment in capital and modern inputs (Lileeva & Trefler 2010, Aw et al. 2011, Bustos 2011). Yet in many low- and middle-income countries, agriculture, rather than manufacturing, accounts for a large share of output and employment. Agricultural modernization through labor-saving technologies has also long been regarded as central to economic development, allowing labor to reallocate toward more productive sectors (Johnston & Mellor 1961, Schultz 1968, Gollin et al. 2007). Whether trade promotes agricultural modernization in the same way in these economies is less clear. Like manufacturing firms, agricultural producers can expand output by investing to raise productivity. But farms may also expand by bringing uncultivated land into production, particularly where land supply is highly elastic (Boserup 1965). Agricultural expansion accounts for nearly 90 percent of global deforestation (FAO 2022). Trade may therefore encourage agricultural modernization, but it may instead (or simultaneously) induce expansion onto new land with potentially adverse consequences for the environment.

Motivated by these issues, we first ask if higher foreign demand for agricultural exports stimulates technology adoption, or simply fuels deforestation through land expansion. Second, given the relationship between modernization and land use, we ask if there is a role for environmental protection in shaping the welfare gains from trade beyond environmental externalities.

We use Brazil's experience during the agricultural commodity boom as a laboratory to address these questions. Brazil offers a unique setting in which the elasticity of land supply varies dramatically within a single country. Inside the Amazon region (i.e., the Legal Amazon), forests are relatively abundant and property rights are weakly enforced, while for the rest of Brazil agricultural land is largely consolidated and the scope for land expansion is small. To analyze this setting, we construct a novel panel dataset by combining confidential records on the near universe of cross-bank electronic transfers with satellite imagery to obtain a rare window into both land use and input purchases at the farm level. Using a shift-share shock based on each farmer's exposure to non-Brazilian import demand, we find no empirical evidence that rising foreign demand stimulates agricultural technology adoption. Instead, we find that exporters, which intermediate trade between Brazilian farmers and foreign markets, purchase disproportionally more goods from farmers within the Legal Amazon. Facing higher demand, farmers within the Amazon then reduce their expenditures on machinery and modern inputs as they reallocate land from capital-intensive soybean cultivation toward land-intensive pasture. Notably, our estimated effects persist even after controlling for each farmer's exposure to differential growth in foreign demand for beef and soy, ruling out the possibility that our results are driven by relatively higher demand for beef.

We show that this pattern emerges naturally from the asymmetric use of technological inputs and land across livestock production and crop cultivation. To guide intuition, we start with a parsimonious model in which a representative farmer is constrained in her fixed endowment of land (i.e., the owned plot) which can be allocated between land-intensive pasture and capital-intensive cropland. Specifically, we allow crop production to raise output on the owned plot by increasing capital use,

while pasture is allowed to expand beyond the owned plot by imperfectly substituting deforested land for pasture at a constant clearing cost. If the clearing cost is sufficiently low, a proportional increase in foreign demand for livestock and crops then raises the marginal value of pasture more than the marginal value of cropland. As a result, the farmer reallocates land away from capital-intensive crop production, which may lower the level of crop revenue and capital spending altogether –a result that contrasts with standard models of trade and technology adoption.

To understand the role of deforestation for the welfare gains from trade, we then embed this mechanism into a rich general equilibrium model with heterogeneous farmers and endogenous technology adoption that can rationalize our empirical findings. First, we use the model to decompose agricultural value added growth during the commodity boom and find that deforestation accounted for almost 50% of growth, compared with less than 10% from changes in technology adoption. Second, we show that environmental protection can redirect agricultural growth toward technology adoption and increase the welfare gains from trade. The direct effect of deforestation on welfare through environmental externalities like carbon emissions, biodiversity losses, or reduced rainfall might be large. However, we deliberately shut these channels down, such that forests enter neither household utility nor firm productivity, and deforestation carries no social cost beyond the private cost of clearing. Instead, we show that forest protection can encourage the shift from traditional, labor-intensive production towards modern, input-intensive crop cultivation, allowing labor to move towards more productive uses outside agriculture. The marginal value of labor is higher in the non-agricultural sector due to differences in sectoral markups, such that a reallocation of labor out of agriculture is welfare improving. Under a sufficiently strong environmental tax, welfare gains from reducing labor misallocation outweigh the welfare losses from restricting land expansion, increasing the welfare gains from trade.

Our contribution is twofold. First, we provide novel farm-level evidence that rising export demand causes farmers to forgo technology adoption in favor of land expansion when uncultivated land is readily available. Specifically, we construct a novel dataset that combines confidential transaction records from the Brazilian central bank with geo-referenced farm boundaries and satellite imagery, allowing us to trace beef and soy exports back to individual farms and observe both land use changes and input purchases over time. Because farmers may raise yields through different types of investments, we split farm expenditures into machinery (e.g., tractors and harvesters), durable capital and irrigation (e.g., silos and irrigation systems), and technology inputs (e.g., agronomic services and precision agriculture).

We then estimate how land use and investment decisions respond to a shift-share shock that interacts each farmer's pre-determined destination exposure with non-Brazilian import demand, isolating foreign demand from domestic supply conditions. Agricultural trade in Brazil is almost entirely intermediated by export firms, so we construct farm-level exposure to foreign demand by chaining farms' exposure shares to exporters with exporters' exposure shares to destination countries. Our regression results suggest that higher foreign demand causes exporters to increase their purchases disproportionately from farms within the Legal Amazon, where farmers respond by shifting land from capital-intensive soybean cultivation toward land-intensive pasture and reducing spending on

machinery and technology. We also find that farmers expand pasture by clearing forest, contributing to a decline in forest cover within the Amazon. Outside the Amazon, we find little evidence of changes in land use or spending following an increase in foreign demand, consistent with the weaker response of exporters' purchases. In a complementary difference-in-differences design, we exploit the timing of farmers' use of rural credit and show that receiving rural credit raises spending on modern inputs and shifts land from pasture toward soybean, encouraging modernization. Our empirical results present strong evidence that agricultural modernization follows changes in farmers' land use mix. In contrast to pasture, cultivating soybean requires machinery and agronomic inputs, such that the demand for technology inputs falls in tandem with the share of land under crop cultivation.

In our second contribution, we show that a sufficiently strong deforestation tax can increase the welfare gains from agricultural trade without resorting to assumptions about carbon externalities, biodiversity losses, or climatic changes that affect firm productivity or household utility. Here, we build a static general equilibrium model to understand how an agricultural export boom drives deforestation and affects technology adoption. We assume the economy is populated by an agricultural sector with heterogeneous farms producing both crops and livestock alongside a non-agricultural sector with firms supplying consumption, intermediate, and technology goods. Within agriculture, we introduce two sources of heterogeneity: farmers draw an idiosyncratic productivity shock and a cost of clearing forest. We use the clearing cost draw to capture variation in land scarcity and property rights, which allows us to capture geographic variation of land characteristics without explicitly modeling spatial units. Upon observing the respective draws, farmers allocate land on their owned property between crop cultivation and pasture. Drawing on agronomic evidence, we assume that crops and pasture differ in their underlying use of technology and land such that the returns to adopting modern technology accrue solely to crop cultivation, while only pasture can replace forest. Furthermore, we take into account that inherent land heterogeneity limits the substitutability between pasture and crops as well as between the established owned plot and newly deforested pasture. In line with our parsimonious framework, farmers thus decide how to allocate the owned plot between crops and pasture, how many additional hectares to deforest, and whether to adopt modern crop technology.

A key feature of the equilibrium is that even high-productivity farms may find it optimal not to adopt the modern technology if their clearing cost is sufficiently low—a feature we observe directly in the data. We then show that under a commodity boom where prices for livestock and crops rise proportionally, farms drawing a low clearing cost (e.g., farms with access to abundant land or weakly enforced property rights) find it optimal to specialize further into pasture and abandon the modern technology, effectively de-modernizing their production.

We calibrate the model to the beginning of the commodity boom period in 2003 for Brazil using granular microdata, aggregate statistics, and our own empirical estimates to discipline the parameter space in our model. We show that our framework is able to match a range of key untargeted moments that capture differences in land use, farm scale, and modernization between the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil. Furthermore, the implied share of modern firms in each sector matches proxies that we construct from Brazilian firm surveys and the agricultural census. Equipped with the calibrated model, we first study the cross-sectional response to an agricultural commodity boom, focusing on

how farms with different clearing costs adjust land use and technology adoption. We then extend the calibration over time from 2000 to 2014 to quantify how these responses aggregate into growth in agricultural value added over the boom. Changes in land use accounted for around 56 percent of value added growth, with deforestation alone accounting for around 43 percent, while technology adoption contributed less than 10 percent.

We then ask how an environmental policy that redirects growth away from deforestation shapes welfare gains from trade. Therefore we introduce a perfectly enforced per-hectare environmental tax on deforested pasture that is rebated lump-sum to the household. In our calibrated model, differences in sectoral markups distort the allocation of labor towards agriculture, where the marginal value of labor is lower relative to non-agriculture. A deforestation tax then raises the return on technology and encourages the adoption of modern crop technology that saves labor relative to traditional production methods. Hence, the deforestation tax distorts the land expansion margin, but also draws pasture farms into modern agriculture, allowing labor to reallocate towards its more productive use.

In a counterfactual exercise we show that a perfectly enforced no-deforestation tax of around US$700 per hectare, which eliminates deforestation in equilibrium, increases the welfare gains from trade by more than 75 percent. Importantly, welfare gains from trade only materialize after a reduction in aggregate deforestation of more than 90% (at a tax above US$170 per hectare), at which point the welfare gain from the reduction in labor misallocation outweighs the welfare loss from restricting land expansion.

**Related Literature.** Our paper connects to several strands of the literature. First, a growing body of work studies how international trade affects agricultural production and deforestation. Several papers document that commodity booms increase tropical forest loss (Pendrill et al. 2019, Abman & Lundberg 2020, Da Mata & Dotta 2021, Harding et al. 2021, Hansen & Wingender 2023), while quantitative models of agricultural trade emphasize that trade promotes modernization and can be land-saving. Farrokhi & Pellegrina (2023) show that trade lowers the cost of intermediate inputs, promoting the adoption of modern technology and reducing the total amount of land devoted to agriculture. Pellegrina (2022) studies how soy adaptation reshaped the spatial organization of Brazilian agriculture, and Farrokhi et al. (2025) build a dynamic trade model in which trade reduces deforestation globally by shifting production toward more productive regions. Carreira et al. (2024) disentangle trade from technology at the municipality level and find that soy seed adoption rather than Chinese export demand drove deforestation. We depart from the literature by using novel farm level data, as opposed to regional or municipality level data, that allows us to trace input purchases and land use changes to individual farms, directly observing the farmer's choice between adopting modern technology and expanding onto new land. We show that the reallocation of land between crops and livestock within a farm can dictate the farmer's modernization decisions, due to their asymmetric use of technology and land, which the literature has not taken into account.

Second, our paper contributes to a broad literature that views international trade as a driver of economic growth and modernization. A large body of evidence finds that openness raises income and productivity across countries (Frankel & Romer 1999, Alcalá & Ciccone 2004), that wider exposure

to foreign markets leads firms to adopt modern technology, invest in R&D, and upgrade product quality (Bustos 2011, Aw et al. 2011, Lileeva & Trefler 2010, Verhoogen 2008, Bloom et al. 2016, Atkin et al. 2017), and that trade raises aggregate productivity by reallocating activity toward the most productive firms (Melitz 2003, Bernard et al. 2007). A parallel body of growth theory formalizes how trade can accelerate innovation and the diffusion of technology (Grossman & Helpman 1991, Rivera-Batiz & Romer 1991, Sampson 2016, Perla et al. 2021), and quantitative models trace sizable welfare gains to sectoral linkages and trade in intermediate goods (Caliendo & Parro 2015). Taken together, these studies find that larger markets raise the return to modern technology, so that trade and modernization advance together. Almost all of the firm-level evidence comes from manufacturing. However for the agricultural sector we show that taking into account cheap land to deforest and extensify production can lead to an optimal reallocation away from adopting modern technology. Our idea that agriculture responds to trade differently from manufacturing is also linked to earlier work on structural transformation by, e.g., Matsuyama (1992) who shows that in an open economy, a comparative advantage in agriculture can slow growth when manufacturing has learning by doing externalities.

Third, we relate to a large literature on environmental policies and deforestation, which finds that policy instruments such as satellite monitoring, higher enforcement, and restrictions on rural credit can reduce deforestation (Assunção et al. 2015, Assunção, McMillan, Murphy & Souza-Rodrigues 2023, Assunção et al. 2020, Assunção, Gandour & Rocha 2023). Souza-Rodrigues (2019) provides a structural framework for estimating the demand for deforestation in the Amazon and finds that taxes on agricultural land can be highly cost-effective in preserving the rainforest. Dominguez-Iino (2026) finds a downstream tax on agribusiness a poorly targeted substitute for a tax on farmers, because agribusiness buyers with monopsony power pass little of the tax through to the upstream frontier where emissions are most intense. Araujo (2024) studies how deforestation feeds back onto agricultural productivity through altered rainfall, and Araujo et al. (2026) estimate the efficient level of forest conservation accounting for the carbon externality. We depart from this literature by finding a welfare rationale for an environmental tax without relying on an externality such as carbon or rainfall, but rather due to incentivizing farmers to adopt labor-sparing modern technology.

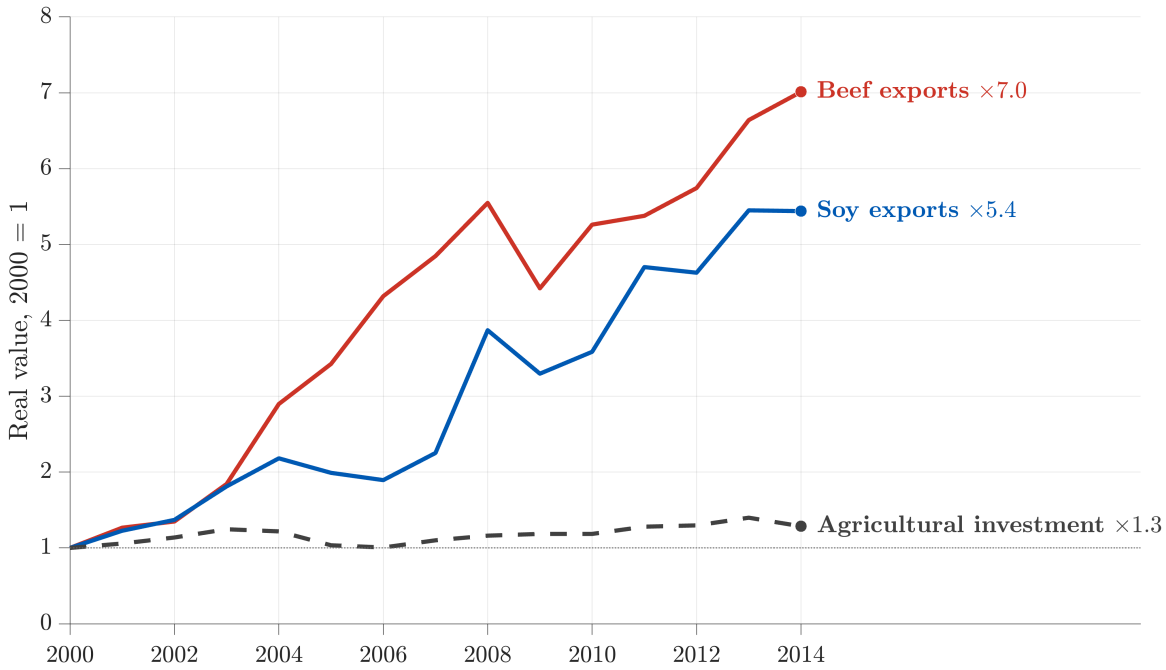
Fourth, we relate to the broad literature on the drivers and consequences of tropical deforestation (see Balboni et al. 2023, for a recent survey). Early work established that clearing follows the economic returns to land, with roads, transport costs, and output prices shaping environmental outcomes (Chomitz & Gray 1996, Barbier & Burgess 1997, Pfaff 1999), while later work emphasizes the political incentives of local governments (Burgess et al. 2012). Closest to our work is Szerman et al. (2022) who show that a productivity gain from electrification favors crops and leads credit-constrained farmers to reallocate land away from land-intensive grazing and into capital-intensive crop cultivation, reducing total land demand. They find that the resulting conservation gains are comparable in magnitude to those from some of the most prominent conservation policies implemented in Brazil. In our paper, we use a similar mechanism arguing that modernization gains predominantly accrue to crop cultivation instead of livestock, consistent with evidence that crop technology developed by Brazil's public research agency moved land from pasture into crops (Akerman et al. 2026). We also take into account that crops are largely unsuitable for cleared land. By combining the asymmetric use of technological

inputs and land, we show that an export boom may incentivise farmers to extensify rather than modernize.

## 2 Background

Over the past two decades, Brazil became the world's largest exporter of both beef and soybeans. During the commodity boom between 2000 and 2014, real agricultural exports for beef and soy grew more than sevenfold and fivefold respectively, driven largely by rising demand from China, where rapid income growth translated into higher consumption of livestock products requiring soy feed (Nepstad et al. 2006, Costa et al. 2016) (see Figure 1). Yet export growth was not accompanied by a corresponding increase in agricultural demand for investment goods. Instead, agricultural spending on capital goods remained relatively flat, a fact difficult to reconcile with standard models of export driven growth, where expanded access to foreign markets raises firm revenues and stimulates technology adoption (e.g., Lileeva & Trefler 2010, Bustos 2011, Aw et al. 2011). We would therefore expect the agricultural sector to increase purchases of capital goods alongside rising exports.

Figure 1: Real Beef/Soy Exports and Agricultural Investment, 2000–2014




*Notes:* All series are normalized to one in 2000 and labels report the 2014 value relative to 2000. Soy exports are the sum of FAOSTAT export values for soya beans, soya bean cake, and soya bean oil. Beef exports are the sum of FAOSTAT export values for boneless cattle meat, bone-in cattle meat, beef and veal preparations, edible cattle offal, live cattle, and salted, dried, or smoked bovine meat. Export values are in constant 2003 US dollars, deflated by the US consumer price index. Agricultural investment is gross fixed capital formation in agriculture, forestry, and fishing in Brazil, from the FAOSTAT Capital Stock domain, expressed in constant 2015 reais.

The export boom also coincided with one of the largest expansions of agricultural land in modern

history. Between 2000 and 2020, crop and pasture area expanded substantially in the Amazon and Cerrado biomes (Zalles et al. 2019, Souza Jr et al. 2020). In the Amazon alone, 18.9 million hectares of forest were cleared between 2000 and 2006, driven predominantly by the expansion of cattle pasture (Barona et al. 2010). Crops and pasture differ fundamentally in their land suitability and use of technological inputs. We document these differences in the following two observations, which are well established in the agronomic sciences but largely overlooked in the economics literature.

**Observation 1:** *Modernization gains predominantly accrue to crop production instead of livestock.*

It is well understood that crop yields respond strongly to purchased inputs such as machinery, chemical fertilizers, and improved seed varieties (e.g., Rada 2013, Goldsmith 2008). Just improved seed varieties alone can raise grain yields by roughly two percent a year (Umburanas et al. 2022). Mechanization can then further amplify productivity by facilitating practices like double-cropping, allowing a single plot to be harvested multiple times within a year (e.g., Goldsmith & Montesdeoca 2018). Beef production does not offer comparable returns to capital due to inherent physiological limits on cattle growth and feed conversion. Roughly seventy percent of a cow's energy is allocated to basic biological maintenance rather than to gain (e.g., Ferrell & Jenkins 1985) which means that livestock eventually reaches a physiological limit on how much excess meat can be generated per animal, regardless of the investment into feed or management (e.g., Owens et al. 1995, Webb & Casey 2010). Consequently, the returns to modernization predominantly concentrate within crop farming.

**Observation 2:** *Pasture is the main driver of deforestation, while crops are largely unsuitable for freshly cleared land.*

The literature also documents that freshly cleared forests are often poorly suited for crop cultivation due to acidic soils that are short of essential nutrients (e.g., Sanchez et al. 1982, Lopes 1992). Converting tropical forests into cropland therefore takes years of costly soil correction before a first harvest, whereas cattle can graze deforested land as soon as it is cleared. Pasture is thus often the first use of newly cleared forest, while crops remain on consolidated land (e.g., Macedo et al. 2012). Reflecting this asymmetry, cattle pasture occupies more than 60 percent of deforested land in the Brazilian Amazon, compared to under five percent for crop cultivation (Almeida et al. 2016).

Both observations are also visible in aggregate statistics on agricultural investment and land use. Between 2000 and 2012, Brazilian crop farming purchased on average roughly ten times as much machinery and equipment compared to livestock. On the other hand, out of roughly 40 million hectares of forest converted for agricultural use, only 3 million hectares transitioned into cropland while 37.6 million hectares were converted into pasture (see Appendix Figure F.1).

## 3 A Parsimonious Framework

To guide intuition, we start by setting up a simple parsimonious framework where a representative farmer maximizes profit over crop and livestock production given technologies that reflect the asymmetric use in land and technology. Importantly, we also take into account that inherent land

heterogeneity prevents land from being perfectly substitutable between established farmland (i.e., the owned plot) and newly deforested pasture. We then use this framework to demonstrate how cheap land for pasture expansion competes with crop production and can depress capital spending during an export boom.

Specifically, we assume that crops $y_c$ and beef $y_p$ are supplied by a representative farmer who takes the respective prices ($p_c$, $p_p$) as given, hires capital at an exogenous rental rate $r$, hires labor at a wage that we normalize to one, and clears forest at a constant cost $c$ per area unit. The farmer is endowed with a plot of owned land of unit size that can be split between crop use $l_c$ and pasture use $l_p$,

$$l_c + l_p \;\leq\; 1. \tag{1}$$

In line with *Observation 1* and *Observation 2*, we further assume that crops can only be produced on owned land $l_c$, capital $k$, and labor $n_c$, whereas beef is produced with labor $n_p$ on a land composite $\bar{l}_p$ that bundles owned pasture $l_p$ and freshly cleared forest $d$,

$$y_c \;=\; l_c^{\gamma_c}\, k^{\nu_c}\, n_c^{1-\gamma_c-\nu_c}, \qquad y_p \;=\; \bar{l}_p^{\gamma_p}\, n_p^{1-\gamma_p} \;\text{ where }\; \bar{l}_p \;=\; \left(l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} + d^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_p-1}}. \tag{2}$$

Here, we assume that only crops use capital, reflecting *Observation 1*, and freshly cleared land only enters pasture, reflecting *Observation 2*. Key to our mechanism is to allow owned pasture $l_p$ and freshly cleared forest $d$ to be imperfect substitutes in cattle production with elasticity $\varepsilon_p > 1$, which captures well-known differences in land characteristics such as ranching infrastructure and market access (see, e.g., Margulis 2004, Chomitz & Gray 1996). The representative farmer then solves

$$\pi \;=\; \max_{l_c,\, l_p,\, k,\, d,\, n_c,\, n_p} \; p_c\, y_c + p_p\, y_p \;-\; r\, k \;-\; (n_c + n_p) \;-\; c\, d \qquad \text{s.t.} \qquad l_c + l_p \leq 1. \tag{3}$$

Furthermore, we assume that the farmer faces isoelastic foreign demand for crops and beef with a common elasticity $\eta > 1$ such that in equilibrium

$$p_c \;=\; \rho\, p^w\, y_c^{-1/\eta} \quad \text{and} \quad p_p \;=\; (1-\rho)\, p^w\, y_p^{-1/\eta} \tag{4}$$

where $p^w$ captures the common component in exogenous agricultural world prices and $\rho \in (0,1)$ governs the relative demand for crops versus beef.

We apply this setup to an increase in the world price for agricultural goods $p^w$. Note that a rise in the price of beef alone would shift the farmer toward cattle production through a change in the relative price, which we deliberately rule out so that any reallocation comes from the differential use in land and technology between crops and pasture.

We are interested in whether the export boom, captured by an increase in $p^w$, leads the farmer to intensify production, by reallocating land into capital-intensive crop cultivation, or to extensify production, by raising cattle on deforested land $d$. Here we deliberately assume that freshly cleared forest substitutes imperfectly for owned pasture (e.g., due to the lack of fencing, water, and road access) with an elasticity $\varepsilon_p < \infty$. The farmer therefore raises cattle by partly combining cleared forest $d$ with owned pasture $l_p$, which in turn competes with land dedicated to crops $l_c$. This means a farmer whose clearing cost $c$ is sufficiently low to induce extensification consequently also reallocates land away from crops, which can lower crop revenues and capital spending altogether. We formalize this mechanism in Proposition 1.

**Proposition 1.** *Let $s_c \equiv l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$ be the crop share of farmed land and $rk^*$ the farmer's spending on capital goods. Then there exist clearing costs $0 < \bar{c} < c^\star$ such that a boom $dp^w > 0$*

*(i)* (Extensification.) *if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ and $1 < \varepsilon_p < 1 + \gamma_c(\eta - 1)$, shifts land use toward pasture whenever clearing is cheap, $c < c^\star$,*

$$\frac{\partial l_c^*}{\partial p^w} < 0, \qquad \frac{\partial d^*}{\partial p^w} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial s_c^*}{\partial p^w} < 0;$$

*(ii)* (De-modernization.) *if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ and $1 < \varepsilon_p < \gamma_c(\eta - 1)$, reduces capital spending where clearing is cheap and raises it elsewhere,*

$$\frac{\partial (rk^*)}{\partial p^w} < 0 \quad \text{if } c < \bar{c}, \qquad \frac{\partial (rk^*)}{\partial p^w} > 0 \quad \text{if } c > \bar{c}.$$

*The proof is in Appendix K.1.*

To understand the mechanism of Proposition 1, note that the equilibrium change in crop revenue satisfies

$$d\ln(p_c\, y_c) \;=\; \underbrace{\frac{\eta}{1 + \gamma_c(\eta - 1)}}_{\text{direct price effect}}\, d\ln p^w \;+\; \underbrace{\frac{\gamma_c(\eta - 1)}{1 + \gamma_c(\eta - 1)}}_{\text{land reallocation}}\, d\ln l_c^*. \tag{5}$$

Hence, crop revenue increases with both the world price and the crop area $l_c$. With an increase in $p^w$, crop revenue therefore only falls if the reallocation away from $l_c$ is large enough to outweigh the increase in $p_c$. This is important because investment co-moves with crop revenue, by the first-order condition $rk = \nu_c\, p_c\, y_c$. A farmer reallocates land away from crops if and only if the boom raises the value of a hectare in pasture more than a hectare in crops, which ties the underlying clearing cost $c$ directly to the level of crop modernization $k$.

Suppose that clearing forest is cheap (e.g., in a situation where property rights are weakly enforced and land is abundant and cheap to clear), so the farmer finds it optimal to extensify and deforests $d$. By assumption, the cleared forest $d$ only partly substitutes for owned pasture, and thus also raises the value of the owned pasture $l_p$ operated alongside the new land $d$. Formally, combining the first-order conditions for owned pasture $l_p$ and cleared forest $d$, an additional hectare of owned pasture raises the farmer's profit from cattle by $c\,(d/l_p)^{1/\varepsilon_p}$, which increases in $d$. The reallocation therefore depends on the clearing cost only through the amount of cleared land the farmer operates alongside owned pasture. In the limit of free clearing, the reallocation takes the closed form

$$\lim_{c \to 0} \frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} \;=\; -\,\frac{\eta\left[1 + \gamma_c(\eta - 1) - \varepsilon_p\right]}{\varepsilon_p}, \tag{6}$$

which is negative if and only if $\varepsilon_p < 1 + \gamma_c(\eta - 1)$ and thus recovers exactly the parametric condition of Proposition 1(i). Given a low enough clearing cost $c$, land therefore moves toward pasture whenever cleared forest substitutes sufficiently poorly for owned pasture relative to foreign demand feedback for crops, $d\ln p_c = -\frac{1}{\eta}\, d\ln y_c$ from (4), and to the land share of the crop activity $\gamma_c$. Note that the price feedback is weak when world demand is elastic (high $\eta$), because otherwise a decline in the crop supply would raise $p_c$ such that the farmer may no longer find it optimal to specialize in cattle production.

Under this condition, we then show in Proposition 1 that below a threshold $c^\star$, the boom raises the value of a hectare by more in pasture than in crops such that the farmer reallocates land away from crops, $\partial l_c^*/\partial p^w < 0$. Below an even stricter threshold $\bar{c} < c^\star$, the loss from the smaller crop area exceeds the gain from the higher price such that crop revenue falls, and the farmer consequently spends less on capital goods, $\partial(rk^*)/\partial p^w < 0$. Importantly, we think the parametric restriction for Proposition 1 is a relatively mild assumption. Pellegrina (2022) estimates land shares of $\gamma_c = 0.50$ for soy, $0.49$ for wheat, and $0.41$ for corn, so the threshold is approximately $(1+\eta)/2$ and rises with the elasticity of world demand, which is plausibly high for homogeneous export commodities (e.g., Broda & Weinstein 2006).[1] Under an illustrative $\eta = 5$, part (i) requires $\varepsilon_p < 3$ and part (ii) $\varepsilon_p < 2$.

Also, note that here we completely abstract from any gains from specialization within the owned plot. The literature documents substantial gains from concentrating agricultural production in a single use, arising from indivisible equipment, use-specific knowledge, and homogeneous land suitability within plots (e.g., Holmes & Lee 2012). When a boom raises agricultural prices, farms with low clearing costs that already operate large pastures would reallocate owned land even more aggressively toward pasture under such a specialization force, strengthening the extensification channel and relaxing the parametric restriction on $\varepsilon_p$. We introduce this channel in our general equilibrium model in Section 10.3.

In Proposition 1, we establish that taking into account the differential use of land and technology between crop and livestock production, a proportional commodity boom can have very different effects on technology adoption within the agricultural sector depending on the cost of deforestation and the degree of substitutability between land already under agricultural production and land available for expansion. In particular, a decline in modernization may arise as a profit-maximizing decision when cheap uncultivated land is available, a result that contrasts with the standard literature on trade and technology adoption.

## 4 Data and Sample

We exploit confidential data on the near universe of cross-bank electronic transfers from the Central Bank of Brazil (BCB) between 2010 and 2020. Linking these transaction records to farm-level land use outcomes and export exposure, however, presents several challenges. First, agricultural establishments in Brazil are often not registered as formal firms with a corporate tax identifier (cnpj). Instead, land typically belongs to individuals identified only by a personal tax identifier (cpf), which means we must trace transactions of individuals rather than firms. Since those personal accounts may also be used for non-agricultural purchases, we exclude transactions directed to suppliers in sectors that are unlikely to represent farm inputs, such as gambling, tobacco, domestic services or entertainment.[2] Second, agricultural trade in Brazil is predominantly intermediated by large trading companies like

[1] Costinot et al. (2016) estimate $\eta$ at $5.4$ for ten major crops.

[2] Specifically, we exclude payments to suppliers classified under the following 2-digit cnae divisions: 12 (tobacco products), 58 (publishing), 59 (film, video, and sound recording), 79 (travel agencies and tour operators), 90 (arts, creative activities, and entertainment), 92 (gambling and betting), 93 (sports, recreation, and leisure), 96 (other personal services), 97 (domestic services), and 99 (international organizations).

Bunge, Cargill, and JBS, so measuring exports directly at the farm level would be futile. We instead link farms to downstream exporters through payment relationships to measure each farm's exposure to changes in foreign demand. Third, while Brazil's Rural Environmental Registry (CAR) provides geo-referenced boundaries for over 6 million rural properties, the registry available to the BCB does not identify the individuals or firms operating each property. We overcome this limitation by linking CAR properties to borrowers in Brazil's Rural Credit System, which requires farmers to register their property when obtaining credit. Fourth, the individual operating a farm is often not the landowner but rather a manager (or farmer) whose identifier would not appear in property registries in the first place. We address this by assuming that input purchases are made from the same account holder that receives rural credit, allowing us to link transaction flows to specific properties even when the farmer differs from the owner and is not registered as a formal firm. Combining these data sources, we construct a novel dataset that traces beef and soy exports back to individual farms and observes both their land use changes and their input purchases over time.

**Brazilian Payment System.** We use confidential information on the universe of cross-bank electronic transfers processed through the central clearing houses of the Central Bank of Brazil (BCB). We draw on data from the *Sistema de Transferência de Reservas* (STR) and the *Sistema de Transferência de Fundos* (SITRAF) between 2003 and 2020. STR and SITRAF process *Transferências Eletrônicas Disponíveis* (TEDs), which are real-time, gross settlement wire transfers used for the majority of payments in Brazil during our sample period. Following Kamkar et al. (2026), we exclude transactions involving financial institutions, government transfers, and tax payments. Specifically, we remove interbank transfers facilitating liquidity management, transfers related to social security contributions, judicial deposits, and the internal movement of funds within financial institutions. We further restrict the sample to non-financial firms that transact a minimum aggregate value of 10 BRL annually to eliminate technicalities such as penny checks. In 2019, the cleaned sample covers approximately 9.8 million unique firms and 155.7 million unique transaction pairs. The data captures the universe of cross-bank TEDs which make up more than 90% of all cross-bank transactions.[3] Transactions where the sender and recipient hold accounts at the same bank remain unobserved. Kamkar et al. (2026) show that the share of unobserved within-bank transactions corresponds to the Herfindahl-Hirschman Index of bank concentration. They estimate that unobserved flows account for less than 15 percent of non-local transactions and roughly 25 percent of local transactions. Hence, we argue that the observed cross-bank transactions offer a meaningful window into trade relationships in Brazil.

**Land Use Outcomes.** We exploit the Rural Environmental Registry (CAR) which contains geo-referenced boundaries for over 6 million rural properties in Brazil. Furthermore, we match the property boundaries with annual satellite imagery from MapBiomas, which provides land cover classification at a 30×30 meter resolution for the entire Brazilian territory. By overlaying the geo-referenced CAR shapes onto the raster data, we calculate the annual area allocated to specific uses

[3]Our data does not contain paper-based checks (processed through *Centralizadora da Compensação de Cheques e Outros Papéis*, COMPE), *Documentos de Ordem de Crédito* (DOCs), which are low-value next-day transfers, *Transferências Especiais de Crédito* (TECs), a system used for batch payments, or payments from the instant payment system Pix, which was launched at the end of the observed period in November 2020. The share of unobserved payments in the total transaction volume is small, around 8 percent on average between 2006 and 2020 (Kamkar et al. 2026).

within each property, including forest formation, pasture and soybean.

**Rural Credit System.** We identify agricultural producers and their associated CAR property using Brazil's Rural Credit System *Sistema de Operações do Crédito Rural e do PROAGRO* (SICOR) from 2013 to 2020. More specifically, we exploit the requirement that borrowers must register their property in the Rural Environmental Registry (CAR) to link borrower tax identifiers (cnpj or cpf) with CAR properties.[4] Importantly, we assume that a farmer observed on a specific CAR property in SICOR also operated on the same property anytime between 2010 and 2020 as long as the property had more than 5% of its property area covered by farming activities. We also use data from *Registro Comum de Operações Rurais* (RECOR) between 2000 and 2012 to identify all cpfs/cnpjs that are responsible for farming. Even though RECOR contains no links to CAR properties, we still want to capture transactions between informal agricultural producers (those who are not registered with a cnpj) since, for example, soy is a major input into the production of beef. This gives us a broad sample of Brazil's agricultural sector that captures all producers that have a record in the rural credit system since 2000 with over 8 million unique tax identifiers (borrowers) and around 2.3 million unique CAR properties.

**Export Data.** We exploit granular customs data from the TRASE initiative to measure agricultural exports for the beef and soy supply chains. TRASE combines per-shipment trade records with sanitary inspection logs to construct a firm-by-year-by-destination panel, covering 2004 to 2020 for soy and 2010 to 2020 for beef (excluding 2018). Since TRASE identifies exporters by name, we manually match the entities to their corporate tax identifiers (cnpj) using public records. Most beef and soy exports are intermediated by trading companies, so the set of exporters is largely different from the set of agricultural producers, and we recover the link between the two through the payment data described above.[5] Figure F.2 (Appendix) plots the cumulative distribution of average yearly export values for beef and soy exporters. The figure highlights the concentration in agricultural exports, where a few dominant intermediaries, such as Bunge, Cargill, and ADM for soy, and JBS, Minerva, and Marfrig for beef, control the majority of trade volume.

### 4.1 Descriptive Statistics

First, we consider all farmers in our panel, regardless of whether they are linked to an exporter, and aggregate their payments to suppliers of modern inputs such as tractors, irrigation equipment, and agronomic services.[6] We then compute each farmer's mean annual spending per hectare of property area in real USD.

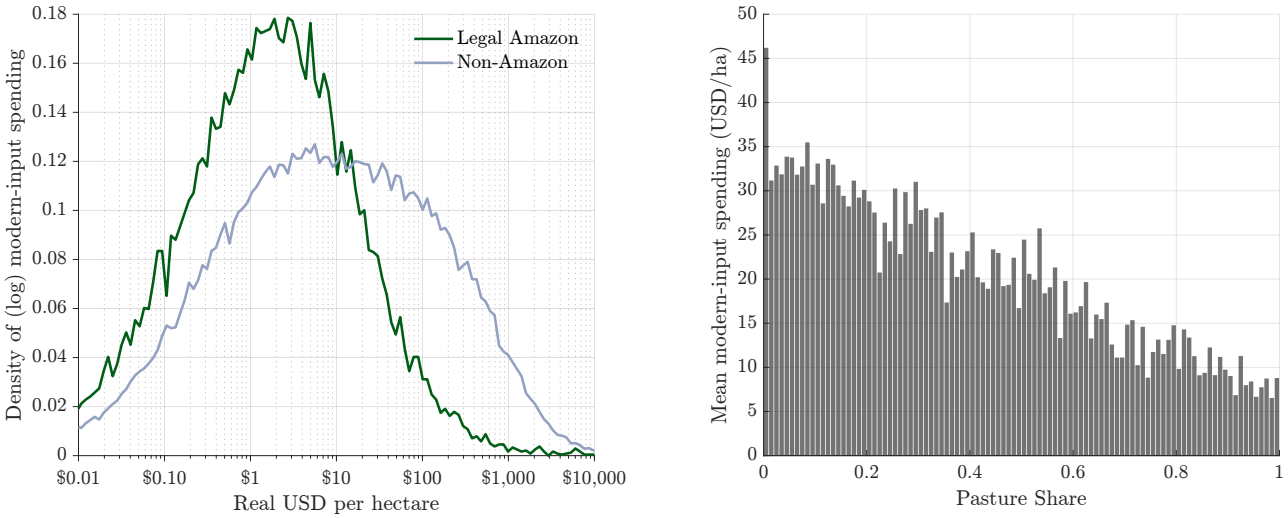
In Figure 2 we then document that on average, the level of spending into modern inputs is an order of magnitude lower in the Amazon compared to the rest of Brazil. Additionally, reflecting *Observation*

[4]The borrower represents the active agent managing the farm's operations and purchasing inputs, whereas the landowner may be an absentee landlord detached from daily production decisions or be the borrower herself.

[5]Of the 1,523 exporters in TRASE, 89 are classified as agricultural producers themselves and we drop them, accounting for 1.3 percent of total export value. We then match 92 percent of the remaining TRASE exporters to at least one upstream farmer through the payment data, covering 97 percent of total beef and soy export value.

[6]We aggregate spending across three categories: *Machines*, *Capital Goods & Irrigation*, and *Technology Goods & Services* according to supplier industry codes (see Appendix Table E.1).

Figure 2: Modern Input Spending per Hectare, by Region and by Pasture Share



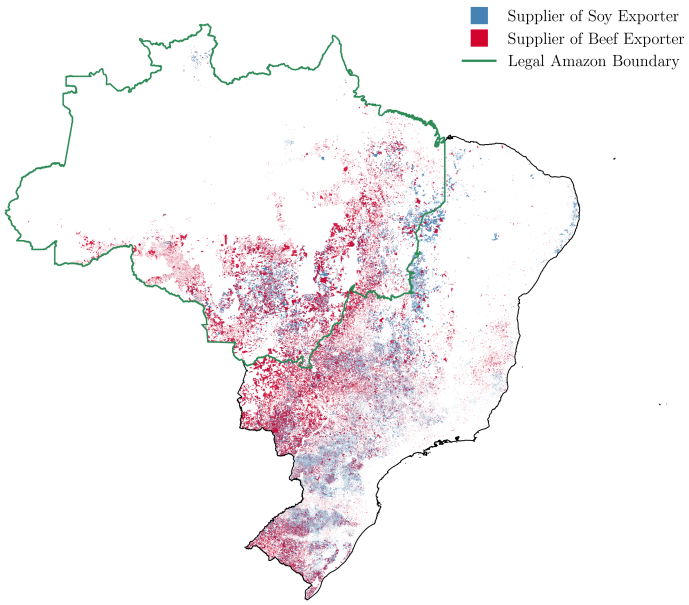

*Notes.* The sample includes all farmers with at least 5 percent of property area under crops or pasture who are observed making payments between 2010 and 2020. We classify modern inputs as payments to suppliers of agricultural machinery, capital goods and irrigation equipment, and technology goods and services (Table E.1), deflated to constant USD, and compute spending per hectare of property area. *Left panel:* density of log spending per hectare among farmers with positive spending; 20,017 farmers (40,082 unique CAR properties) in the Legal Amazon and 113,552 farmers (260,339 unique properties) in the rest of Brazil. *Right panel:* mean spending per hectare by pasture share of farmed area (100 bins), including farmers with no observed modern-input spending; 640,321 farmers (949,589 unique CAR properties), of whom 20.7 percent record positive spending in modern inputs. Data is Winsorized at the 99th percentile ($2,576/ha).

*1*, we also show that the average spending on modern inputs falls from roughly US$46 to US$9 per hectare (a decline of over 80 percent) as the pasture share rises from zero to one. In the left panel of Figure 2 we plot the distribution of per-hectare spending among farmers, separately for the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil. In the Legal Amazon, per-hectare spending concentrates between one and three dollars, while outside the Legal Amazon the distribution shifts rightward by roughly an order of magnitude, with substantial mass above one hundred dollars per hectare. In the right panel of Figure 2, we plot average per-hectare spending binned by pasture share.

Next, we investigate farmer-exporter linkages. Figure 3 maps all CAR properties in our sample that are linked to beef or soy exporters through the payment linkages described above, covering over 460,000 individual properties. Since each farmer may operate multiple properties, the map displays the underlying property-level geography rather than the farmer-level panel used in estimation. The final regression sample contains 128,272 unique farmers and 352,040 farmer-year observations between 2010 and 2020, where each farmer's land-use outcomes aggregate across all CAR properties associated with that farmer's tax identifier. We classify a farmer as being in the Legal Amazon if more than 50 percent of the farmer's CAR properties fall within the Legal Amazon boundary. Our panel includes 30,295 farmers within the Legal Amazon (99,499 observations) and 98,009 farmers located outside the Legal Amazon (252,541 observations).

Table F.1 in Appendix F reports summary statistics at the farmer-year level, separately for the Amazon

Figure 3: Spatial Distribution of Agricultural Producers Linked to Exporters



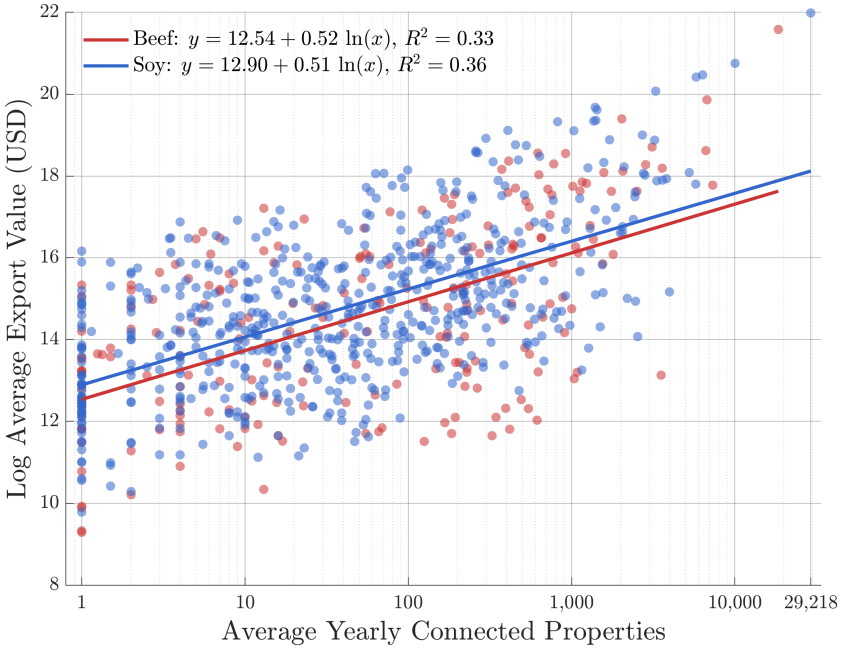

*Notes:* The map plots the geo-referenced locations of all agricultural properties in our sample between 2010 and 2020 that are linked to beef (red) or soy (blue) exporters via transaction records. The green line denotes the Legal Amazon boundary. The sample includes 202,674 properties linked to beef exporters, 347,487 linked to soy exporters, and 88,394 linked to both.

and non-Amazon subsamples. The data reveal substantial heterogeneity across the two regions. Farmers in the Amazon operate on larger properties (roughly 3,000 hectares on average compared to under 1,800 outside) and allocate a larger share of their land to pasture (about 46% vs. 21%) and forest (about 19% vs. 11%). Amazon farmers are also more heavily exposed to beef exporters, with nearly 60% of their export exposure flowing through beef on average, compared to about 30% outside the Amazon. Spending on machinery, capital goods, and technology per hectare is an order of magnitude lower in the Amazon than outside, consistent with the low capital intensity of pasture-based production (*Observation 1*). Outside the Amazon, farmers allocate a larger share of their land to soybeans (about 34% vs. 20%). Table F.2 in Appendix F reports summary statistics split by beef and soy linkages.

Figure 4 plots average annual export value against the average number of upstream properties supplying each exporter. The relationship is strikingly log-linear, with export volumes rising less than proportionally in the number of connected properties.[7] At the top end of the distribution, the largest exporters source from over 10,000 properties, while at the bottom, smaller exporters maintain only a handful of supplier relationships. One implication is that larger exporters source proportionally less export value per supplier relationship, with an exporter maintaining ten times as many supplier relationships generating only about three times the export value. We show in Appendix Figures F.3–F.3c that there is no systematic correlation between exporter size and the

[7]The estimated elasticity of export value with respect to the number of connected properties is approximately 0.5 for both beef and soy. An elasticity below one implies that larger exporters source less per property than smaller ones, consistent with decreasing returns to scale in sourcing, though the $R^2$ of 0.33–0.36 suggests substantial heterogeneity around this relationship.

Figure 4: Exporter Size and Upstream Sourcing




*Notes:* The figure plots each exporter's log average yearly export value (USD) against the average number of upstream properties it sources from (log scale) between 2010 and 2020. Red dots represent beef exporters and blue dots represent soy exporters. The lines show log-linear fits with reported $R^2$.

average land composition (forest, pasture, or soybean share) of connected farmers, which is relevant for identification since it suggests that exporter-level demand variation is not confounded with farmer-level land characteristics.

Beyond the exporter relationships, it is useful to understand how farmers allocate their spending across different types of suppliers more generally. Appendix Figure F.4 reports the share of total farm-level spending directed to different supplier industries, separately for farmers linked to beef and soy exporters. For both groups, the largest spending category is agriculture and livestock, which captures inter-farm transactions such as purchases of feed, seed, and live animals and accounts for roughly half of all spending. The next-largest categories are transportation and logistics, wholesale trade, and chemicals and fertilizers. We distinguish between three categories of spending on modern inputs: *Machines*, *Capital Goods & Irrigation*, and *Technology Goods & Services*, each accounting for roughly 1 to 2 percent of total annual farm spending.[8]

## 5 Empirical Specification

Brazilian agricultural trade runs almost entirely through intermediaries, with a handful of trading firms such as ADM, Bunge, and Cargill (often referred to as the *ABC* firms) handling most of the export value alongside a long tail of much smaller intermediaries. With few exceptions, these firms do not produce agricultural goods themselves but instead specialize in logistics and processing, purchasing beef and soy from potentially thousands of upstream farmers and selling them on international

[8]Table E.1 in Appendix C reports the supplier industry codes used to define each category.

markets. Agricultural export shocks therefore propagate upstream from export intermediaries to farmers through payment relationships.

We observe transaction flows between farmers and export intermediaries in the payment data. Goods flow upstream from farmer to exporter, while payments flow in the opposite direction, so incoming payments measure each farmer's sales exposure to individual intermediaries. For each farmer-exporter pair, we measure the share of exporter $x$ in farmer $i$'s total payments received from exporters in the first year farmer $i$ appears in the data,

$$w_{ix} = \frac{\text{Payments}_{x \to i,\, t_0}}{\sum_{x'} \text{Payments}_{x' \to i,\, t_0}} \tag{7}$$

where $\text{Payments}_{x \to i,\, t_0}$ denotes the total transaction value from exporter $x$ to farmer $i$, and $t_0$ is the first year farmer $i$ appears in the data. We then chain these weights $w_{ix}$ with each exporter's destination composition, measured in the first year $t_0'$ that the exporter appears in our sample, to obtain farmer-level destination shares

$$s_{ic}^k = \sum_x w_{ix} \cdot \underbrace{\frac{\text{Exports}^k_{x \to c,\, t_0'}}{\sum_{c'} \text{Exports}^k_{x \to c',\, t_0'}}}_{s^k_{xc}}, \qquad k \in \{\text{beef, soy}\} \tag{8}$$

where $s_{xc}^k$ is the share of exporter $x$'s commodity-$k$ exports destined for country $c$, fixed at the first year $t_0'$ the exporter appears in the data. The farmer-level share $s_{ic}^k$ thus measures farmer $i$'s pre-determined exposure to destination country $c$ for commodity $k$, traced through the farmer's initial exporter linkages. We report the distribution of initial years at which the exporter destination shares $s_{xc}^k$ are fixed in Appendix Table A.2.

Using these pre-determined shares, we construct a farmer-level demand shock as the share-weighted growth rate of non-Brazilian import demand

$$\Delta z_{it} = \sum_k \sum_c s_{ic}^k \cdot \Delta \ln g_{ct}^k \tag{9}$$

where $g_{ct}^k$ denotes total non-Brazilian imports of commodity $k$ by destination country $c$ in year $t$, explicitly excluding Brazilian exports to avoid contamination by domestic supply-side factors. The growth rate $\Delta \ln g_{ct}^k$ captures year-on-year fluctuations in foreign demand at each destination, and the pre-determined shares $s_{ic}^k$ translate these into farmer-specific shocks.

The shock $\Delta z_{it}$ pools beef and soy exposure into a single demand shock, so that farmers connected to both beef and soy exporters receive a shock that reflects their total agricultural export exposure. The pooled shock captures both common movements in foreign demand and changes in relative demand between the two commodities. This is a natural starting point given the substantial growth in foreign demand for both commodities during Brazil's agricultural export boom, as differences in their growth rates were themselves part of the boom. In Section 8, we additionally control for differential growth in foreign demand between the two commodities to isolate the common component of the shock and obtain very similar estimates, which suggests that our baseline results are not driven by shifts in

relative demand between beef and soy.[9]

We study land-use and expenditure outcomes at the farmer-year level. For land use outcomes, $Y_{it}$ denotes the share of a farmer's total registered property area allocated to forest, pasture, or soybean, aggregated across all CAR properties the farmer operates in a given year. For expenditure outcomes, $Y_{it}$ measures the farmer's total outgoing payments to upstream input suppliers, decomposed into three categories based on the 7-digit cnae sector classification of the recipient (see Appendix Table E.1 for the complete mapping).

1. *Machines.* Spending on the core machinery fleet used in agricultural production, including agricultural tractors, harvesters, planters, earthmoving equipment, vehicles and trucks, and the maintenance and repair of agricultural equipment.

2. *Capital Goods & Irrigation.* Physical infrastructure and equipment, including irrigation systems, water management infrastructure, electrical equipment such as generators and transformers, and specialized transport equipment.

3. *Technology Goods & Services.* The knowledge-intensive margin of farm investment, including computing and electronic equipment, IT and software services, engineering and agronomic consulting, and scientific research and development.

Farmer-level spending in these categories is lumpy and often zero, so instead of using standard logs we use $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ as our baseline transformation for spending outcomes, which preserves zeros while approximating log-linearity for positive values, allowing us to estimate semi-elasticities that incorporate both the extensive margin (whether a farmer spends at all) and the intensive margin (how much). We verify robustness to the inverse hyperbolic sine transformation $\ln(Y_{it} + \sqrt{Y_{it}^2 + 1})$ (see Burbidge et al. 1988) and to extensive margin dummies $\mathbb{1}[Y_{it} > 0]$, both reported in Appendix B. We also verify robustness to broader and narrower supplier classifications (Appendix E).

Following Aghion et al. (2024), our baseline specification regresses outcome $Y_{it}$ on leads and lags of the shift-share demand shock

$$Y_{it} = \sum_{\tau=-5}^{8} \alpha_\tau \, \Delta z_{i,t-\tau} \; + \; \mu_i \; + \; \delta_t \; + \; \gamma_t' \mathbf{C}_i \; + \; X_{it}' \lambda \; + \; \varepsilon_{it} \tag{10}$$

where $\mu_i$ and $\delta_t$ are farmer and year fixed effects. The vector $\mathbf{C}_i$ contains three time-invariant farmer-level characteristics, each interacted with a full set of year fixed effects. These are (i) the sum of farmer $i$'s destination shares $\bar{s}_i = \sum_{k,c} s_{ic}^k$, which controls for incomplete shares following Borusyak et al. (2025), (ii) the fraction of farmer $i$'s export exposure flowing through beef exporters, which absorbs differential trends associated with farmers' pre-determined exposure to beef relative to soy, and (iii) the shares of farmer $i$'s CAR property area allocated to forest and to soybeans in the first year $t_0$ a farmer appears in the sample, each separately interacted with year fixed effects, which

[9] We also decompose the instrument into separate product-specific shocks $\Delta z_{it}^{\text{beef}}$ and $\Delta z_{it}^{\text{soy}}$ in Appendix D and show that both commodities generate qualitatively similar patterns.

absorb differential trends between farmers with different initial land compositions.[10] The control vector $X_{it}$ includes the number of CAR properties associated with farmer $i$, which accounts for variation in farm scale that may affect both land use and spending decisions, and two measures of local weather conditions from McNally et al. (2017), the annual minimum rainfall anomaly and the standard deviation of monthly rainfall anomalies, defined as deviations from the 1982–2016 monthly average. These climate controls absorb weather-driven fluctuations in agricultural productivity that could otherwise confound the effect of demand shocks on land use and investment. Standard errors are clustered at the farmer level. The coefficients $\{\alpha_\tau\}$ trace out the dynamic response of $Y_{it}$ to a unit increase in the demand shock.

We estimate equation (10) separately for farmers inside and outside the Legal Amazon, where farmers face different costs of bringing additional land into production. Within the Legal Amazon, abundant uncultivated land and weak enforcement against illegal land occupation favor pasture expansion through forest clearing (Barreto 2021). Outside the Amazon, agricultural land is largely consolidated, leaving farmers fewer opportunities to expand onto new land.

## 6 Identification

The main threat to identification is reverse causality arising from unobserved supply-side shocks that simultaneously determine both exports and farmer-level outcomes. A positive productivity shock, such as favorable weather or a disease-free season, could increase a farm's output and export volume while also changing the farmer's land allocation and investment decisions. In standard heterogeneous-producer models, more productive firms self-select into supply chains connected to larger exporters, generating a positive correlation between export exposure and outcomes that is driven by selection on productivity rather than by a causal effect of foreign demand (e.g., Melitz 2003). Ordinary least squares estimates of the relationship between exports and farmer-level outcomes would therefore conflate the causal impact of foreign demand with these unobserved supply-side factors.

Our identification strategy addresses this concern through the construction of the demand shock $\Delta z_{it}$ in equation (9). The shift component, $\Delta \ln g^k_{ct}$, captures year-on-year growth in non-Brazilian imports of commodity $k$ at each destination, explicitly excluding Brazilian exports to avoid contamination by domestic supply conditions. The share component, $s^k_{ic}$, is fixed at the first year each farmer-exporter pair appears in the data, so the identifying variation arises from the interaction of pre-determined farmer-level exposure with time-varying fluctuations in foreign demand at each destination. Identification requires that non-Brazilian import demand at each destination is orthogonal to the idiosyncratic supply conditions of individual Brazilian farmers, conditional on the fixed effects and controls in equation (10). The reduced-form specification provides a transparent test of this assumption. Because all leads and lags of $\Delta z$ enter a single regression, the coefficients at $\tau < 0$ measure whether *future* demand shocks predict *current* outcomes. Under the identification assumption, they should not. As

[10] We verify robustness to alternative initial characteristics, controlling instead for initial soybean share only, initial pasture share only, initial forest share only, or no initial characteristic at all (Appendix E).

we show below, the lead coefficients are insignificant across our main outcomes.

A shift-share design can be justified either through the exogeneity of many independent destination-level shocks or through the exogeneity of a few dominant shocks that carry the identifying variation (Borusyak et al. 2025). Our instrument draws on 143 destination countries (Table A.1 in Appendix A reports full diagnostics and discusses the concentration of importance weights; Appendix E shows that dropping any top-5 destination leaves results unchanged). The effective number of independent demand shocks is approximately 9, which is relatively low and reflects the concentrated structure of global beef and soybean trade. The largest importance weight falls on China at 29%, reflecting its dominant role in global demand for beef and soybeans. Chinese import demand for these commodities is driven by structural income growth and the associated dietary transition toward higher protein consumption, rather than by conditions in Brazilian agriculture, plausibly satisfying the exogeneity requirement for the dominant shifter.[11]

## 7 Results

We show a visual representation of our findings in Figures 5–7, which plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10), separately for farmers within and outside the Legal Amazon. A one-unit increase in $\Delta z_{it}$ corresponds roughly to a doubling of foreign demand. The land use coefficients give the resulting change in the area share in percentage points, while the spending and payment coefficients give the resulting percent change and can be read as elasticities with respect to foreign demand.[12]

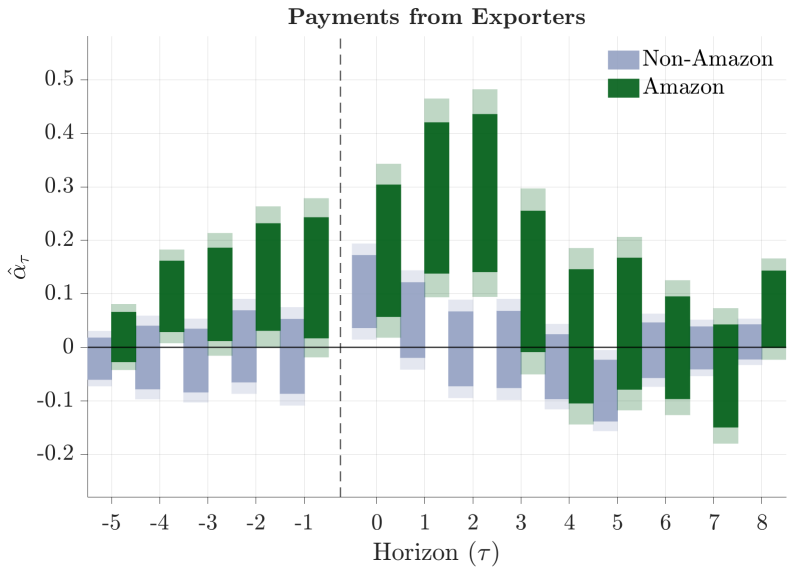
We begin by investigating how the demand shock $\Delta z_{it}$ transmits from exporters to farmers through the payment system. Therefore we regress the log of total payments farmer $i$ receives from all exporters he is exposed to in $t_0$. Specifically, we estimate equation (10) with $Y_{it} = \ln \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}_i^0} \text{Payments}_{x \to i,\, t}$, where $\mathcal{X}_i^0$ is the set of exporters linked to farmer $i$ in the first year farmer $i$ appears in the data ($t_0$), capturing payments along precisely the channel through which the demand shock propagates to the farm. Figure 5 shows that, in the Amazon, a doubling of foreign demand raises payments from linked exporters by roughly 33 percent at $\tau = 1$–$2$. Outside the Amazon, the pass-through is significantly smaller at around 10 percent at impact. Our results therefore suggest that exporters facing higher foreign demand scale up their agricultural purchases disproportionately more from suppliers located within the Amazon.

Next, we examine the effect of foreign demand on farmers' land use and modern input spending. The top two panels of Figure 6 show that farmers in the Amazon respond to higher export demand by switching away from capital-intensive soybean cultivation and toward land-intensive pasture. More specifically, the share of land dedicated to soybeans contracts by roughly 2 percentage points within three years of the shock, while the pasture share expands by a comparable magnitude over the same

[11] In Appendix E we probe the sensitivity of our results to this concentration by excluding dominant destinations one at a time, dropping the three largest exporters, excluding farmers connected to both beef and soy exporters, fixing the baseline year at 2010 for all farmers, and using a shorter event window of $\tau = -3$ to $+6$. Results are stable across all exercises.

[12] Given that Brazilian agricultural exports grew sevenfold between 2000 and 2020, a doubling over a few years is well within the range of observed variation.

Figure 5: Agricultural Export Demand and Payments from Exporters




*Notes:* The figure plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is $\ln \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}_i^0} \text{Payments}_{x \to i,\, t}$, where $\mathcal{X}_i^0$ is the set of exporters linked to farmer $i$ in the first year farmer $i$ appears in the data ($t_0$). Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

horizon, and both effects persist for several years.[13] Outside the Legal Amazon, we observe little reallocation between pasture and soybean following the demand shock, consistent with the limited pass-through of foreign demand to farmers documented in Figure 5.

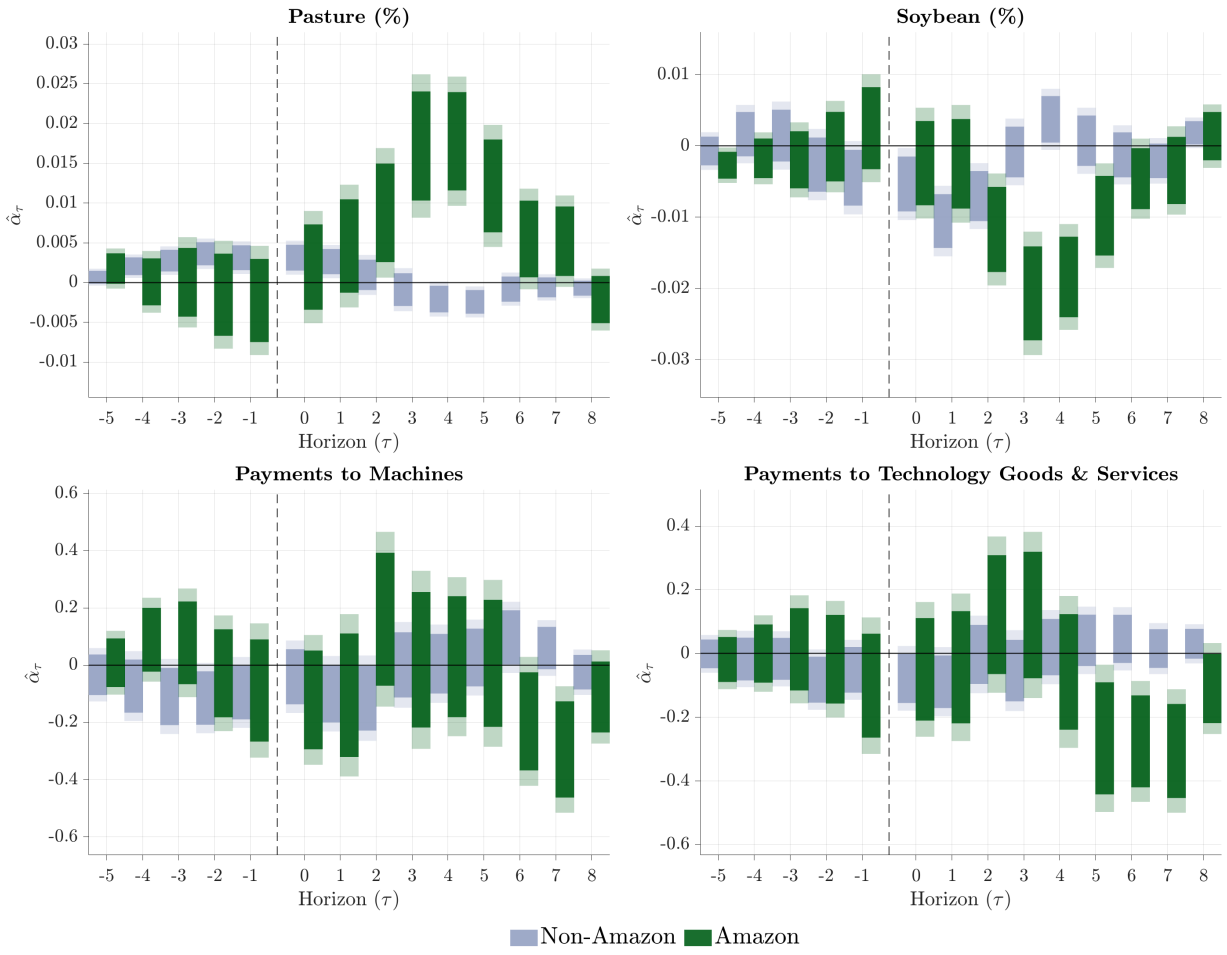
The bottom two panels of Figure 6 show that spending on modern inputs in the Amazon declines following the demand shock. Specifically, payments to *Technology Goods & Services*, which capture purchases from IT, engineering, agronomic consulting, and R&D, fall by roughly 25 percent at peak, and machinery spending declines by a similar magnitude.[14] The decline in spending emerges only around $\tau = 5$ and persist through $\tau = 7$, well after land reallocation from soy to pasture begins at $\tau = 2$ and peaks at $\tau = 3$–$4$. The timing is therefore consistent with spending that adjusts to the previous land-use change, since pasture requires fewer modern inputs compared to soybean cultivation. In the Legal Amazon, we also observe a decline in the number of suppliers from whom farmers purchase machines and technology (Appendix Figure B.3). Again, consistent with the weaker pass-through outside of the Legal Amazon, spending on modern inputs does not respond to the demand shock.

We also estimate the responses to separate beef and soy demand shocks to examine whether the

[13] On the average Amazon farm of about 3,000 hectares (Table F.1), a 2 percentage point reallocation corresponds to roughly 60 hectares per farm. This figure varies considerably across the size distribution, with the largest farms in the sample exceeding 300,000 hectares, where a 2 percentage point reallocation translates into roughly 6,000 hectares. For comparison, Scott et al. (2025) find that a permanent 17 percent increase in beef prices roughly doubles steady-state deforestation rates in the Amazon, while short-run responses are near zero.

[14] The peak decline in technology goods and services is approximately 0.30 in $\log(1 + Y)$ at $\tau = 5$–$7$, implying a reduction of about $1 - e^{-0.30} \approx 26$ percent. Machinery spending follows with a peak of 0.29 at $\tau = 7$. Results for *Capital Goods & Irrigation*, reported in Appendix Figure C.1, are qualitatively similar.

Figure 6: Agricultural Export Demand and Farm-Level Responses



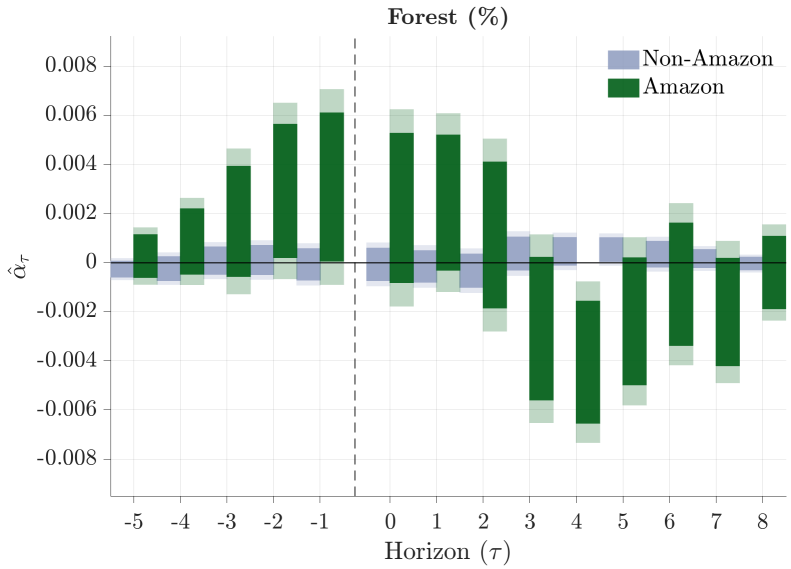

*Notes:* Each panel plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level. Panels (a) and (b) report effects on pasture and soybean land-use shares, where each share is computed by aggregating satellite-measured land cover across all CAR properties a farmer operates and dividing by total registered property area. Panels (c) and (d) report effects on $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ where $Y_{it}$ is total annual spending on suppliers classified under Machines and Technology Goods & Services (see Appendix Table E.1 for the full classification). Capital Goods & Irrigation results are reported separately in Appendix Figure C.1.

patterns persist when we measure foreign demand using either commodity. Both sets of estimates suggest a shift from soybean toward pasture and a reduction in spending on modern inputs within the Amazon (Appendix D, Figures D.1 and D.2). However, demand for beef and soy may move together, so similar responses may not necessarily reflect independent effects of demand for each commodity. In Section 8, we instead use the pooled demand shock and control for the differential growth between soy and beef demand to isolate the response to a proportional increase in foreign demand for both commodities.

Figure 7 shows the effect of foreign demand on forest cover. Within the Amazon, the forest share declines by roughly 0.4 percentage points beginning around three years after the shock. The timing is consistent with farmers clearing forest to accommodate the shift from soybean cultivation toward extensive pasture production. Outside the Amazon, the forest share remains largely unresponsive to

the demand shock, consistent with the limited response of pasture and soybean shares.

Figure 7: Agricultural Export Demand and Forest Cover




*Notes:* The figure plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is the forest land-use share, computed by aggregating satellite-measured forest cover across all CAR properties a farmer operates and dividing by total registered property area. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

Taken together, our results suggest that when foreign demand for agricultural commodities rises, exporters increase their purchases disproportionately from Amazon farmers within the first two years. In response, farmers in the Amazon shift production from capital-intensive soybean cultivation toward land-intensive pasture over the following two to four years, specializing into pasture at the expense of forest and reducing the area under crop cultivation needed to justify technology investments. Specifically, farmers decrease their spending on technology goods persistently by around 25 percent, five to seven years after the shock. In Appendix E, we report a comprehensive set of robustness exercises, including alternative sample restrictions, specification variants, and instrument modifications.

## 8 Robustness: Relative Beef and Soy Demand

Next we investigate whether our results are driven by a *proportional* increase in foreign demand for beef and soy or by a *relative* shift for foreign demand toward beef. The main concern for the interpretation of our baseline results is that our estimates could simply be driven by systematically higher growth rates of non-Brazilian beef imports such that farmers specialize into pasture due to differences in relative demand rather than the availability of cheap land to convert to pasture. Recall that in our parsimonious framework in Section 3, we show that even under a proportional commodity boom, farmers may find it optimal to reallocate land away from soybeans and decrease their capital spending if cheap uncultivated land is available for deforestation.

To address this concern, we construct a control variable $\Delta q_{it}$ that captures any growth differential between foreign demand in soy and beef farmer $i$ is exposed to

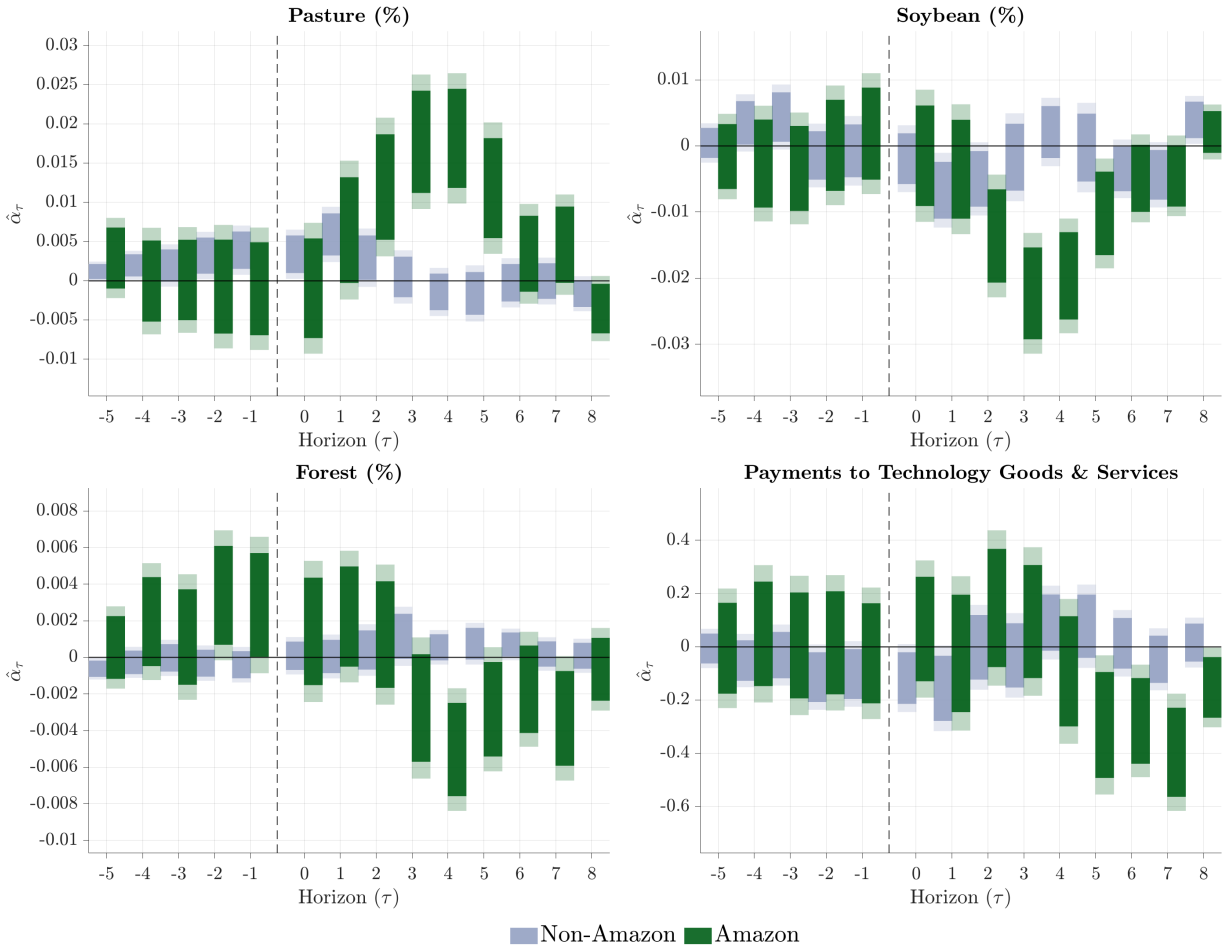
$$\Delta q_{it} = \sum_{c} s_{ic}^{\text{beef}} \Delta \ln g_{ct}^{\text{beef}} \; - \; \sum_{c} s_{ic}^{\text{soy}} \Delta \ln g_{ct}^{\text{soy}}, \tag{11}$$

and then add the control $\Delta q_{it}$ to equation (10) at every $\tau$ such that

$$Y_{it} = \sum_{\tau=-5}^{8} \alpha_\tau \Delta z_{i,t-\tau} \; + \; \sum_{\tau=-5}^{8} \beta_\tau \Delta q_{i,t-\tau} \; + \; \mu_i \; + \; \delta_t \; + \; \gamma_t' \mathbf{C}_i \; + \; X_{it}' \lambda \; + \; \varepsilon_{it}. \tag{12}$$

where $\beta_\tau$ captures the dynamic effects of the relative demand shift.

Figure 8: Farm-Level Responses to a Proportional Demand Shock



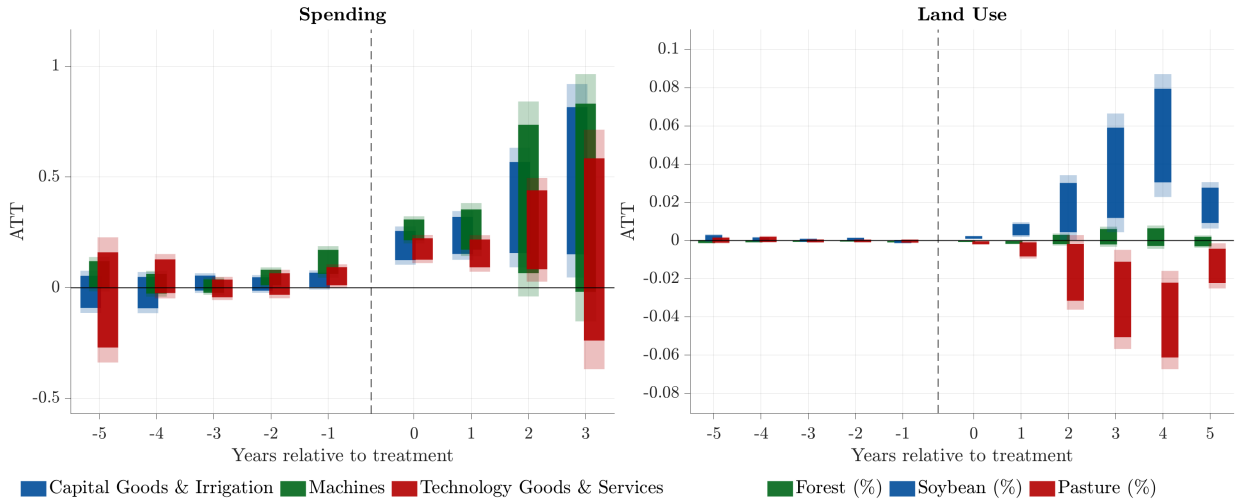

*Notes:* Each panel plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (12) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). Conditional on the control in equation (11), the coefficients capture the response to demand growth common to beef and soy. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level. Panels (a)–(c) report effects on pasture, soybean, and forest land-use shares, where each share is computed by aggregating satellite-measured land cover across all CAR properties a farmer operates and dividing by total registered property area. Panel (d) reports effects on $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ where $Y_{it}$ is total annual spending on suppliers classified under Technology Goods & Services (see Appendix Table E.1 for the full classification).

Conditional on the control $\Delta q_{it}$, the identifying variation for our coefficients of interest $\alpha_\tau$ is then identified from the differential exposure to common shocks, completely absorbing any relative

demand effects at each horizon. We plot the estimated coefficients $\alpha_\tau$ for the pasture, soybean, and forest shares and for technology spending in Figure 8, which documents that the decline in capital spending within the Amazon persists in both sign and magnitude. Our robustness exercise therefore suggests that the baseline results reflect the common component of beef and soy demand growth and persist after controlling for relative demand shifts, consistent with the prediction of Proposition 1.

## 9 Rural Credit, Land Use and Investments

Figure 9: Callaway-Sant'Anna DiD: Spending and Land Use




*Notes:* Both panels plot event study estimates from a Callaway-Sant'Anna difference-in-differences design, where treatment is defined as the first year a farmer obtains rural credit. The left panel reports effects on $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ where $Y_{it}$ is total annual spending on suppliers classified under Capital Goods & Irrigation (navy), Machines (green), and Technology Goods & Services (red), with the event window spanning $\tau = -5$ to $+3$. The right panel reports effects on land-use shares for forest (green), soybean (blue), and pasture (red), where each share aggregates across all CAR properties a farmer operates, with the event window spanning $\tau = -5$ to $+5$. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals. Estimation uses the doubly-robust inverse probability weighting method with not-yet-treated farmers as the control group, 1,000 bootstrap replications, and 99% confidence level, clustering at the farmer level.

Our payment data captures only cross-bank transactions, meaning that payments between a farmer and a supplier who hold accounts at the same bank are unobserved. Our classification of suppliers into three investment categories could also miss or misattribute relevant purchases, even though our results are robust to broader and narrower supplier classifications (Appendix E). To assess whether these features of the data affect our ability to detect spending increases, we estimate a complementary specification where we exploit farmers' first use of rural credit. Specifically, Brazil's rural credit system provides subsidized loans dedicated to agricultural investment, which should mechanically increase purchases of machinery, irrigation, and capital goods. Moreover, in our parsimonious framework (Section 3), a reduction in the cost of capital $r$ would trivially raise technology spending and shift land away from pasture, since cheaper capital increases the return to capital-intensive crop cultivation. Therefore, we estimate a Callaway & Sant'Anna (2021) difference-in-differences specification around

the first time a farmer receives subsidized rural credit, using not-yet-treated farmers as the control group.[15]

Figure 9 reports the results. The left panel shows that spending on machines, capital goods and irrigation, and technology all increase immediately when farmers first access rural credit, by roughly 20 percent at $\tau = 0$, and continue to grow over subsequent years. The right panel shows that access to rural credit also shifts how farmers use their land. After obtaining credit, farmers reduce the share of land allocated to pasture and expand the share under soybean, consistent with the implication of our parsimonious model in Section 3.

## 10 A General Equilibrium Model of Land Use and Technology Adoption

In line with our parsimonious framework from Section 3, our empirical analysis shows that an export boom leads farmers in the Amazon to reallocate land away from crop cultivation and reduce spending on modern technology. We now embed the mechanism from Section 3 into a general equilibrium model with heterogeneous farms that differ in their productivity and their cost of converting forest into pasture. We build a static, single-country general equilibrium model populated by a representative household and two sectors: agriculture and non-agriculture. Within both sectors, production is organized under monopolistic competition, and heterogeneous firms and farms make endogenous decisions over entry and technology adoption. Importantly, we assume that markups differ across sectors, such that the marginal value of labor is not equalized between agriculture and non-agriculture and labor is misallocated.

To close the open economy, domestic sectoral output and foreign imports are combined via a constant elasticity of substitution aggregator into a sectoral composite good. This composite good is then used to satisfy all final consumption, intermediate inputs, and fixed investment costs. Domestic varieties not consumed at home are exported, facing constant-elasticity foreign demand, with a flexible exchange rate that clears balanced trade.

Within the agricultural sector, farms draw clearing cost to convert forest into pasture which captures variations in land scarcity and property rights without specifically modeling geographic regions. Upon observing the productivity and clearing cost draw, farmers choose whether to pay a fixed cost of adopting modern technology, how to allocate their land between crop cultivation and livestock, and how many additional hectares to deforest for pasture. A key feature of the model is that even high-productivity farms may find it optimal not to adopt the modern technology if their clearing cost is sufficiently low—a feature we observe directly in the data and our model matches as an untargeted moment. We calibrate the model to Brazilian microdata and show that the model can both rationalize our empirical findings and match a range of key untargeted moments capturing differences in land use and technology adoption between the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil. Our calibrated model

[15]The sample for this exercise consists of all farmers in the BCB payment data between 2010 and 2020 who appear in the rural credit system (SICOR from 2013 onward, RECOR from 2000 to 2012), merged with the same land-use outcomes from CAR and MapBiomas used in the main analysis. This is a broader sample than the export panel, as it does not condition on linkages to beef or soy exporters. We use doubly-robust inverse probability weighting with 1,000 bootstrap replications.

then allows us to decompose agricultural value added growth during the commodity boom and quantify the contributions of land expansion and technology adoption.

In a counterfactual exercise, we show that an environmental policy can increase welfare gains from trade without assuming environmental externalities such as carbon emissions, rainfall spillovers, or biodiversity losses that affect household utility or firm productivity. Instead, welfare gains arise from reducing the misallocation of labor induced by differences in sectoral markups. In our calibrated economy, the marginal value of labor is higher in non-agriculture, such that labor is misallocated towards agriculture. Moving from traditional production to modern input-intensive crop cultivation is labor sparing and therefore allows labor to move towards non-agriculture where its marginal value is higher. A tax on deforestation penalizes pasture expansion and induces producers to expand crop cultivation. Since modernization gains apply asymmetrically to crops, reallocating land towards crops directly raises the private return on technology investments and encourages labor-sparing modernization.

Importantly, in our calibrated model, an environmental tax must be sufficiently strong to increase welfare gains from trade. A moderate policy distorts land allocation without inducing sufficient modernization to offset the loss of agricultural labor productivity from restricting land expansion, causing welfare gains from trade to fall relative to the untaxed baseline. Only a sufficiently strong tax incentivizes producers to reallocate enough land into crops to justify the fixed investment in modern technology. A strong environmental policy consequently draws high-productivity pasture farms into modern agriculture and releases labor towards non-agriculture, reducing labor misallocation and raising welfare gains from trade.

### 10.1 The Economy

The economy is populated by a mass $N$ of households that supply one unit of labor inelastically. Production is organized across two sectors, agriculture denoted by $a$ and non-agriculture $n$, indexed by $s \in \{a, n\}$. In each sector the domestic good $Y_s$ is combined with an imported good $I_s$ through a constant elasticity of substitution (CES) aggregator to form the composite good $Q_s$ which is used for all final consumption and intermediate inputs.

$$Q_s = \left[\alpha_s^{\frac{1}{\sigma}} (Y_s)^{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma}} + (1-\alpha_s)^{\frac{1}{\sigma}} (I_s)^{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma}}\right]^{\frac{\sigma}{\sigma-1}}. \tag{13}$$

Here $\sigma$ is the elasticity of substitution between domestic and foreign goods, and $\alpha_s$ is a share parameter reflecting home bias. The optimal demands for foreign and domestic goods are

$$Y_s = \alpha_s \Big(\frac{P_{d,s}}{P_s}\Big)^{-\sigma} Q_s, \qquad I_s = (1-\alpha_s)\Big(\frac{\mathcal{H} P^*_{f,s}}{P_s}\Big)^{-\sigma} Q_s, \tag{14}$$

where $P_s$ is the CES price index of the composite good, combining the domestic producer price $P_{d,s}$, the exogenous world price of imports $P^*_{f,s}$, and the nominal exchange rate $\mathcal{H}$.

$$P_s = \left[\alpha_s P_{d,s}^{1-\sigma} + (1-\alpha_s)(\mathcal{H} P^*_{f,s})^{1-\sigma}\right]^{\frac{1}{1-\sigma}}. \tag{15}$$

We assume a representative household combines the two composite goods into final consumption $C$ through a Cobb-Douglas aggregator,

$$C = C_a^{\phi_a} C_n^{\phi_n} \qquad \text{where} \quad \phi_a + \phi_n = 1, \tag{16}$$

where $C_s$ is demand for the composite good $Q_s$. The ideal consumption price index is $P_c = P_a^{\phi_a} P_n^{\phi_n} / (\phi_a^{\phi_a} \phi_n^{\phi_n})$ and expenditure satisfies $P_s C_s = \phi_s P_c C$. The non-agricultural composite $Q_n$ also serves as the intermediate input in both sectors.

### 10.2 Domestic Production

Within each sector, a unit mass of potential entrants can create an establishment to produce differentiated varieties $j$. A non-agricultural establishment supplies a single variety $y_{jn}$, whereas each agricultural entrant produces a crop variety $y_j^c$ and a pasture variety $y_j^p$ (i.e., livestock). Intermediate varieties are then aggregated to form a domestic sectoral good using the following Dixit-Stiglitz aggregators with elasticity $\eta_s > 1$

$$Y_s = \begin{cases} \left( \int y_{jn}^{\frac{\eta_n - 1}{\eta_n}} \, dj \right)^{\frac{\eta_n}{\eta_n - 1}}, & s = n, \\ \left( \int \left[ \rho^{\frac{1}{\eta_a}} (y_j^c)^{\frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}} + (1-\rho)^{\frac{1}{\eta_a}} (y_j^p)^{\frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}} \right] dj \right)^{\frac{\eta_a}{\eta_a - 1}}, & s = a, \end{cases} \tag{17}$$

with the weight $\rho \in (0, 1)$. The price index for the domestically produced non-agricultural good $Y_n$ is $P_{d,n} = (\int p_{d,jn}^{1-\eta_n} \, dj)^{\frac{1}{1-\eta_n}}$ and $P_{d,a} = (\int [\rho \, (p_{d,j}^c)^{1-\eta_a} + (1-\rho) \, (p_{d,j}^p)^{1-\eta_a}] \, dj)^{\frac{1}{1-\eta_a}}$ for the agricultural good $Y_a$.

### 10.3 The Agricultural Sector

Within the agricultural sector, we assume that each potential agricultural firm owns a fixed plot of land of size $h$ that cannot be sold or rented and can be split between cultivating crops $l_c$ and pasture $l_p$ under the following binding owned-land aggregator[16]

$$\left[ l_c^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} + l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} \right]^{\frac{\varepsilon_h}{\varepsilon_h - 1}} \leq h \tag{18}$$

where $\varepsilon_h$ governs how easily a farmer can reallocate her plot between the two uses. Note that as $\varepsilon_h \to \infty$ the constraint collapses to $l_c + l_p \leq h$, in which case crop land and pasture are perfectly substitutable within the plot. Here we depart from the assumption of perfectly substitutable land uses within the owned plot that we use in our parsimonious framework in Section 3. Specifically, we allow $\varepsilon_h$ to be finite, so a plot split between the two uses leaves an area $v = h - l_c - l_p$ of the endowment vacant, which shrinks as the farmer concentrates the plot in one use. Our approach captures implicit gains from specialization, that can arise, for example from homogeneous land suitability within a plot

[16] Here we abstract from an endogenous market for land. Note that in the 2017 Agricultural Census, owned land makes up on average around 85 percent of farm area while rented land is below 9 percent. We show a more detailed split by state in the Appendix Figure H.3. Excluding outliers such as São Paulo, Rio Grande do Sul, Paraná, and the Distrito Federal, owned land makes up almost 90 percent of total agricultural land with the share of rented land under 7 percent.

or from use-specific managerial capacity and knowledge, which favor specialization (see e.g., Holmes & Lee 2012).[17] We plot the constraint for several values of $\varepsilon_h$ in Appendix Figure F.1.

We then allow farmers to deforest an area $d$ to increase their total pasture area $\bar{l}_p$ at an exogenous unit (hectare) cost $c > 0$, which each potential entrant draws together with its productivity before making any entry decision, from an independent distribution $G(c)$ over the support $[\underline{c}, \infty)$.[18] The farm-specific cost $c$ captures variation in land availability, property rights, and institutional constraints. Intuitively, a low draw for $c$ captures an environment where adjacent uncultivated land is abundant and property rights are weakly enforced. Conversely, a high draw for $c$ captures the constraints of densely settled regions where land is scarce and expansion is heavily regulated. Furthermore we assume that deforestation $d$ is paid in units of the non-agricultural composite $Q_n$ at price $P_n$, capturing the equipment and intermediate inputs required for land conversion (e.g., earthmoving equipment and contracted clearing services, transport, etc.).

The total land dedicated to pasture $\bar{l}_p$ for each farmer is then assumed to be a combination of the owned size $l_p$ and deforested land $d$:

$$\bar{l}_p = \left[ l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} + d^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} \right]^{\frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_p - 1}} \tag{19}$$

where $\varepsilon_p$ is the elasticity of substitution between owned and cleared land. Similarly to the binding land constraint, we assume that established pasture within the owned plot $l_p$ and newly deforested land $d$ are not perfectly substitutable captured by the elasticity $\varepsilon_p$, reflecting that agricultural land expansion cannot seamlessly replace established pasture without diminishing returns.

Each potential entrant draws an ex-ante productivity $z$ from a Pareto distribution $F(z)$ with tail parameter $\zeta > 0$. Having observed the pair $(z, c)$, a potential entrant becomes active by paying a fixed entry cost $\kappa_{ta}$ in units of labor. Each active farmer then produces a differentiated crop variety $y_j^c$ and a pasture variety $y_j^p$ using labor $(n_c, n_p)$, intermediate inputs $(x_c, x_p)$, and the respective land inputs $(l_c, \bar{l}_p)$ according to the following Cobb-Douglas technologies

$$y_j^c = z\, A_i\, l_c^{\gamma_c}\, x_c^{\nu_c}\, n_c^{1-\nu_c-\gamma_c}, \qquad y_j^p = z\, \bar{l}_p^{\gamma_p}\, x_p^{\nu_p}\, n_p^{1-\nu_p-\gamma_p}, \tag{20}$$

where $\gamma_c$ and $\gamma_p$ denote the output elasticities of land in crop and pasture production, and $\nu_c$ and $\nu_p$ the corresponding elasticities of intermediate inputs.

A farmer can upgrade their crop-technology $A_i$ from a traditional baseline $A_t$ to a modern level $A_m > A_t$ by purchasing $\kappa_{ma}$ units of the non-agricultural composite $Q_n$ at price $P_n$.

An active farmer then chooses prices $(p_d^c, p_d^p)$, labor $(n_c, n_p)$, intermediates $(x_c, x_p)$, the owned-land

[17] Holmes & Lee (2012) document that farmers overwhelmingly plant fields within a plot in the same use, far beyond what independent choices across fields would produce. They attribute the specialization to similar land quality across fields within a plot and to gains from concentration itself, such as indivisible equipment and knowledge specific to a single use.

[18] We specify and calibrate a parametric form for $G$ in Section 11.

split $(l_c, l_p)$, and deforestation $d$ to maximize joint operating profit,

$$\begin{aligned}
\pi^o_{i,a}(z,c) = \max_{p^c_d, p^p_d, n_c, n_p, x_c, x_p, l_c, l_p, d} \quad & \rho\, p^c_d \left(\frac{p^c_d}{P_{d,a}}\right)^{-\eta_a} Y_a + (1-\rho)\, p^p_d \left(\frac{p^p_d}{P_{d,a}}\right)^{-\eta_a} Y_a \\
& - P_n(x_c + x_p) - (n_c + n_p) - P_n c\, d - \tau\, d \\
\text{s.t.} \quad & z\, A_i\, l_c^{\gamma_c} x_c^{\nu_c} n_c^{1-\nu_c-\gamma_c} \geq \rho \left(\frac{p^c_d}{P_{d,a}}\right)^{-\eta_a} Y_a \\
& z\, \bar{l}_p^{\gamma_p} x_p^{\nu_p} n_p^{1-\nu_p-\gamma_p} \geq (1-\rho) \left(\frac{p^p_d}{P_{d,a}}\right)^{-\eta_a} Y_a \\
& \left[ l_c^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} + l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} \right]^{\frac{\varepsilon_h}{\varepsilon_h - 1}} \leq h \quad \text{and} \quad \bar{l}_p = \left[ l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} + d^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} \right]^{\frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_p - 1}}
\end{aligned} \tag{21}$$

where the wage $w = 1$ is the numeraire. We assume that deforestation is subject to a perfectly enforced tax $\tau$, and that all resulting revenues are rebated lump sum to the household. We think about $\tau$ as a strictly enforced environmental fine applied per hectare of newly cleared land. Since the government rebates all collected revenues directly to households, the tax operates purely as a financial penalty. The policy thus directly targets the deforestation margin and raises the hurdle for land expansion beyond the physical input cost.

The entry and modernization cutoffs, $z_{ta}(c)$ and $z_{ma}(c)$, are determined by evaluating operating profit. The thresholds solve the following indifference conditions:

$$\pi^o_t(z_{ta}(c), c) = \kappa_{ta}, \qquad \pi^o_m(z_{ma}(c), c) - \pi^o_t(z_{ma}(c), c) = P_n \kappa_{ma}. \tag{22}$$

The first condition defines the entry cutoff $z_{ta}(c)$, at which operating profit under the traditional technology covers the fixed entry cost. The second condition defines $z_{ma}(c)$, the productivity threshold at which adopting modern technology becomes profitable. At the adoption threshold, the increase in operating profit exactly covers the fixed adoption cost.

**Assumption 1.** *(i)* $\eta_a > 1, \quad \varepsilon_p > 1,$

*(ii)* $\gamma_c \leq \gamma_p,$

*(iii)* $\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) < \varepsilon_h - 1,$

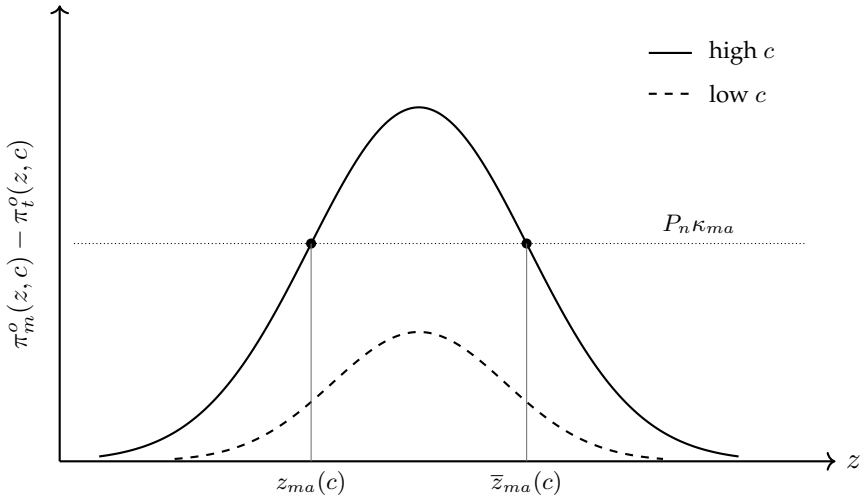
*(iv)* $\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h} + \frac{\gamma_c}{\varepsilon_p}(\eta_a - 1) > 1.$

Throughout the remainder of the model we will occasionally invoke Assumption 1. This is the equivalent set of parametric conditions to those in our parsimonious framework from Section 3. In the limit $\varepsilon_h \to \infty$, the plot constraint collapses to $l_c + l_p \leq h$, condition (iii) vanishes, and condition (iv) reduces to $\varepsilon_p < \gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)$, recovering the parametric restrictions of Proposition 1. With finite $\varepsilon_h$, the implicit gains from specialization within the owned plot provide an additional force toward pasture concentration for productive farms, relaxing the upper bound on $\varepsilon_p$ to $\varepsilon_h \gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)/(\varepsilon_h - 1)$. Condition (iii) then ensures that $\varepsilon_h$ is large enough for interior crop and pasture allocations.

**Lemma 1** (Hump-shaped modernization gain)**.** *Under Assumption 1, the gain from modernizing* $\pi_m^o(z,c) - \pi_t^o(z,c)$ *is hump-shaped in* $z$ *and vanishes as* $z \to \infty$*. The adoption set* $\{z : \pi_m^o - \pi_t^o \geq P_n \kappa_{ma}\}$ *is bounded at* $\overline{z}_{ma}(c) < \infty$*. The proof is in Appendix K.2.2.*

Next we show in Lemma 1 that under Assumption 1, the net gain from modernizing, $\pi_m^o - \pi_t^o$, does not rise monotonically with $z$, but is instead hump-shaped. Highly productive farms find it optimal to aggressively clear forest and shift their land allocation toward pasture. As the crop operation contracts for higher levels of $z$, the benefit of the crop-specific technology upgrade can fall below the fixed adoption cost. Note that a higher productivity draw is isomorphic to a proportional increase in foreign demand, meaning the same underlying mechanism as in our parsimonious model in Section 3 now governs the hump-shaped gain from modernizing. Lemma 1 implies that the modernization indifference condition yields a second, upper root, $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$. As a result, adoption is confined to an intermediate band $[z_{ma}(c), \overline{z}_{ma}(c)]$, where the most highly productive farms revert to the traditional technology. If $\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h} + \frac{\gamma_c}{\varepsilon_p}(\eta_a - 1) \leq 1$, the gain remains monotonically increasing in $z$ and $\overline{z}_{ma}(c) = \infty$, such that the model collapses to a single-threshold rule.

Figure 10: Gain from Modernization and Adoption Thresholds




*Notes:* The figure plots the gain from modernizing, $\pi_m^o(z,c) - \pi_t^o(z,c)$, across productivity $z$ for a high clearing cost (solid line) and a low clearing cost (dashed line) under Assumption 1. The horizontal dotted line represents the fixed cost $P_n \kappa_{ma}$. For the high clearing cost, the gain intersects the fixed cost twice, defining the finite band $[z_{ma}(c), \overline{z}_{ma}(c)]$. For the low clearing cost, the gain remains strictly below the fixed cost. If $\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h} + \frac{\gamma_c}{\varepsilon_p}(\eta_a - 1) \leq 1$, the gain would increase monotonically and $\overline{z}_{ma}(c) = \infty$.

In Figure 10, we plot the gain from modernizing against productivity $z$ at different clearing cost draws, illustrating two cases where farms optimally forgo modern technology even when they draw a high productivity $z$. When productivity exceeds the upper threshold $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$, the marginal value of pasture drives the farm to reallocate land away from crop production, which shrinks the relative scale of the crop operation and pushes the modernization gain below the fixed cost. Furthermore, if the clearing cost is low enough, the expected profit gain may remain strictly below the fixed cost across all productivity levels. Since a sufficiently low clearing cost induces a land expansion heavily

dominated by pasture, the crop operation never reaches the minimum scale required to justify the fixed adoption cost, regardless of the farm's productivity draw. Hence, modernisation fails to occur either because a farm's productivity exceeds the upper adoption threshold, or because the upgrade is strictly unprofitable at every productivity level when the clearing cost is sufficiently low.

The aggregate masses of active farms $e_a$ and modern farms $a_a$ are obtained by integrating these cutoffs over the clearing-cost distribution $G(c)$:

$$e_a = \int_0^\infty z_{ta}(c)^{-\zeta}\, G(dc), \qquad a_a = \int_0^\infty \left[z_{ma}(c)^{-\zeta} - \overline{z}_{ma}(c)^{-\zeta}\right] G(dc). \tag{23}$$

In the following Proposition 2 we formalize how the farm's land allocation and technology adoption thresholds respond to shocks in partial equilibrium. Taking aggregate demand and prices as given, we derive comparative statics for an increase in the agricultural price $P_{d,a}$, an increase in the fixed modernization cost $\kappa_{ma}$, and stricter environmental enforcement $\tau$.

**Proposition 2.** *Under Assumption 1, fix aggregate agricultural demand $Y_a$ and all prices, and let $s_c \equiv l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$.*

*(1)* (Extensification.) *A boom draws in entry, $\partial z_{ta}(c)/\partial P_{d,a} < 0$ for all $c$. If $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ there is a finite clearing-cost threshold $c^\star > 0$ at which the land-use response splits by the cost of clearing. If $c < c^\star$ the farm shifts its owned plot from crops to pasture, expands cleared land, and lowers its crop share,*

$$\frac{\partial l_c(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} < 0, \qquad \frac{\partial l_p(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial d(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial s_c(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} < 0.$$

*If $c > c^\star$ the farm instead shifts its owned plot toward crops,*

$$\frac{\partial l_c(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial l_p(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} < 0,$$

*raising the crop share of the owned plot; the total-area crop share $s_c$ carries no unconditional sign here, since cleared land may still expand near $c^\star$. If $\gamma_c = \gamma_p$ then $c^\star = \infty$ and the land-use response for $c < c^\star$ applies to all farms.*

*(2)* (De-modernization.) *The modern region is bounded above by a finite upper threshold $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$. A boom lowers this upper threshold, reverting the most productive modern farms to traditional methods, while entry at the floor leaves the modernization rate unchanged,*

$$\frac{\partial \overline{z}_{ma}(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} < 0, \qquad \frac{\partial z_{ma}(c)}{\partial P_{d,a}} < 0, \qquad \frac{\partial (a_a/e_a)}{\partial P_{d,a}} = 0 \qquad \forall c.$$

*(3)* (Cost of modernizing.) *A rise in the modernization cost $\kappa_{ma}$ leaves entry unchanged, raises the modernization floor, and sheds modern farms,*

$$\frac{\partial z_{ta}}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} = 0, \quad \frac{\partial z_{ma}}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} > 0, \quad \frac{\partial a_a}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} < 0, \quad \frac{\partial (a_a/e_a)}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} < 0.$$

*Farms that revert to traditional methods shift from crops to pasture and clear more land; all other farms are unchanged,*

$$\frac{\partial l_c}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} \le 0, \qquad \frac{\partial l_p}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} \ge 0, \qquad \frac{\partial d}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} \ge 0, \qquad \frac{\partial s_c}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} \le 0,$$

*with the strict signs exactly for the farms that revert.*

*(4)* (Environmental enforcement.) *A rise in the environmental policy $\tau$ pushes entry up and reduces cleared land,*

$$\frac{\partial z_{ta}}{\partial \tau} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial d}{\partial \tau} < 0,$$

*lowers the modernization floor $z_{ma}$, raises the upper threshold $\overline{z}_{ma}$, draws in modern farms, and tilts land toward crops,*

$$\frac{\partial z_{ma}}{\partial \tau} < 0, \quad \frac{\partial \overline{z}_{ma}}{\partial \tau} > 0, \quad \frac{\partial a_a}{\partial \tau} > 0, \quad \frac{\partial (a_a/e_a)}{\partial \tau} > 0, \quad \frac{\partial s_c}{\partial \tau} > 0,$$

*widening the modernization band from both ends.*

*The proof is in Appendix K.2.*

### 10.4 The Non-Agricultural Sector

For the non-agricultural sector we follow Buera & Trachter (2024). Specifically, we assume a unit mass of potential non-agricultural firms that draw an ex-ante productivity $z$ from the same Pareto distribution with shape parameter $\zeta$ as agricultural farms. If the firm chooses to produce and become active, the establishment supplies a differentiated variety and chooses between the same traditional and modern technology levels, $A_t$ and $A_m$. The establishment then draws an additional idiosyncratic ex-post productivity shock $e^{\omega}$, realized after the entry and adoption decisions but before the input choices. This shock is drawn from a log-normal distribution, $\omega \sim \mathcal{N}\big(-\frac{\eta_n-1}{2}\delta^2, \delta^2\big)$, normalized such that $\mathbb{E}[e^{(\eta_n-1)\omega}] = 1$.[19]

Production requires labor $n$ and an intermediate input $x$. Facing constant elasticity of substitution (CES) demand, the establishment chooses its price $p_d$ and input mix to maximize operating profit,

$$\begin{aligned} \pi^o_{i,n}(z,\omega) = \max_{p_d,x,n} \; & p_d \Big(\frac{p_d}{P_{d,n}}\Big)^{-\eta_n} Y_n - P_n\, x - n \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & z\, A_i\, e^{\omega}\, x^{\nu_n}\, n^{1-\nu_n} \geq \Big(\frac{p_d}{P_{d,n}}\Big)^{-\eta_n} Y_n. \end{aligned} \tag{24}$$

where $\nu_n$ denotes the output elasticity of the intermediate input. Because the production function exhibits constant returns to scale in variable inputs, the solution is a constant markup over marginal cost. Operating profit is thus given by

$$\pi^o_{i,n}(z,\omega) = \frac{e^{(\eta_n-1)\omega}}{\eta_n}\Big(\frac{\eta_n-1}{\eta_n}\Big)^{\eta_n-1} \frac{(A_i z)^{\eta_n-1} P_{d,n}^{\eta_n} Y_n}{\big[P_n^{\nu_n}/\big(\nu_n^{\nu_n}(1-\nu_n)^{1-\nu_n}\big)\big]^{\eta_n-1}}. \tag{25}$$

Note that the ex-post shock generates variation in establishment sizes within each technology class, while the normalization ensures that equilibrium aggregates remain unchanged. Consequently, the firm's ex-ante productivity draw $z$ determines entry and modernization decisions, characterized by a unique entry cutoff $z_{tn}$ and a unique modernization cutoff $z_{mn}$ (Buera & Trachter 2024). A potential firm pays a fixed entry cost $\kappa_{tn}$ in labor and is active for $z \geq z_{tn}$, using the traditional technology $A_t$.

[19] Similar to Buera & Trachter (2024), we include the ex-post shock to match the establishment size distribution in our calibration (Section 11.2).

An active firm can then adopt the modern technology $A_m$ by paying $P_n\kappa_{mn}$ units of the composite good $Q_n$, which is profitable for $z \geq z_{mn}$. The cutoffs are determined by the conditions $\pi^o_{t,n}(z_{tn}) = \kappa_{tn}$ and $\pi^o_{m,n}(z_{mn}) - \pi^o_{t,n}(z_{mn}) = P_n\kappa_{mn}$. The Pareto distribution of ex-ante productivity $z$ implies that the masses of active and modern firms are $e_n = z_{tn}^{-\zeta}$ and $a_n = z_{mn}^{-\zeta}$, respectively.

### 10.5 International Trade

Goods are traded with the rest of the world, and a flexible exchange rate clears the trade balance.

**Exports.** Foreign demand for the domestically produced good (exports, $E_s$) is a function of its price in foreign currency,

$$E_s = \Big(\frac{P_{d,s}}{\mathcal{H}}\Big)^{-\theta} \mathcal{D}^*_s, \tag{26}$$

where $\mathcal{H}$ is the nominal exchange rate, $\theta$ is the price elasticity of export demand, and $\mathcal{D}^*_s$ is a foreign demand shifter.

**Trade Balance.** The nominal exchange rate $\mathcal{H}$ adjusts so that the value of exports equals the value of imports in domestic currency. The equilibrium exchange rate solves:

$$\sum_s P_{d,s} E_s = \mathcal{H} \sum_s P^*_{f,s} I_s. \tag{27}$$

### 10.6 Market Clearing

The model is closed by market clearing for goods and labor and by the household budget constraint.

**Goods Market.** The non-agricultural composite serves consumption, intermediates, equipment, and clearing, and the agricultural composite serves consumption. Total supply of each domestic good equals domestic demand plus exports,

$$Y_n = \alpha_n \Big(\frac{P_{d,n}}{P_n}\Big)^{-\sigma} \Big[\phi_n \frac{P_c C}{P_n} + X_a + X_n + \kappa_{mn} a_n + \kappa_{ma} a_a + \mathcal{C}\Big] + E_n, \tag{28}$$

$$Y_a = \alpha_a \Big(\frac{P_{d,a}}{P_a}\Big)^{-\sigma} \phi_a \frac{P_c C}{P_a} + E_a, \tag{29}$$

where $N_n = \int_{z_{tn}}^{\infty} n(z)\, F(dz)$ and $X_n = \int_{z_{tn}}^{\infty} x(z)\, F(dz)$ in non-agriculture, while in agriculture the firm choices also depend on the clearing-cost draw and integrate over $G$,

$$N_a = \int_0^{\infty}\!\!\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} n(z,c)\, F(dz)\, G(dc), \quad X_a = \int_0^{\infty}\!\!\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} x(z,c)\, F(dz)\, G(dc), \quad D = \int_0^{\infty}\!\!\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} d(z,c)\, F(dz)\, G(dc),$$

with $n = n_c + n_p$, $x = x_c + x_p$, $D$ aggregate deforestation, and $\mathcal{C} = \int_0^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} c\, d(z,c)\, F(dz)\, G(dc)$ the aggregate real clearing bill, with the per-hectare cost $c$ varying by farm inside the integral.

**Imports.** Imports follow from CES demand for the imported component of each composite,

$$I_n = (1-\alpha_n)\Big(\frac{\mathcal{H}P^*_{f,n}}{P_n}\Big)^{-\sigma} Q_n, \qquad I_a = (1-\alpha_a)\Big(\frac{\mathcal{H}P^*_{f,a}}{P_a}\Big)^{-\sigma} Q_a, \tag{30}$$

where $Q_n = \phi_n P_c C/P_n + X_a + X_n + \kappa_{mn} a_n + \kappa_{ma} a_a + \mathcal{C}$ and $Q_a = \phi_a P_c C/P_a$ are the composite quantities demanded.

**Labor Market.** The total supply of labor $N$ is allocated to production and entry,

$$N = \sum_s N_s + \sum_s e_s \kappa_{ts}. \tag{31}$$

**Household Budget.** The household supplies labor to firms, receives profits, and collects the lump-sum transfer of the environmental tax revenue.

$$P_c C = N + \Pi_a + \Pi_n + \tau D, \tag{32}$$

where

$$\Pi_a = \int_0^\infty \int_{z_{ta}(c)}^\infty \pi^o_{i(z,c),a}(z,c)\, F(dz)\, G(dc) \;-\; \kappa_{ta}\, e_a \;-\; P_n \kappa_{ma}\, a_a, \tag{33}$$

$$\Pi_n = \int_{z_{tn}}^\infty \mathbb{E}_\omega\big[\pi^o_{i(z),n}(z,\omega)\big]\, F(dz) \;-\; \kappa_{tn}\, e_n \;-\; P_n \kappa_{mn}\, a_n. \tag{34}$$

The proceeds from the environmental tax $\tau D$ are rebated to the household as a lump-sum transfer.

## 11 Calibration

We calibrate the model parameters in two steps. First, we assign values to an external block of parameters based on standard values from the literature and aggregate data (see Table G.3 in Appendix G). Second, we jointly calibrate an internal block of parameters such that the model-implied moments match their empirical counterparts (see Table G.1 in Appendix G) and discuss untargeted moments.

The internally calibrated block consists of fifteen parameters: the agricultural production weight $\rho$, the land-use elasticities $(\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p)$, a mean, dispersion, and lower bound $(\bar{c}, \varepsilon, \underline{c})$ of the clearing cost distribution $G(c)$, the modern technology level $A_m$, the fixed costs $(\kappa_{tn}, \kappa_{mn}, \kappa_{ta}, \kappa_{ma})$, the Pareto tail parameter $\zeta$, the idiosyncratic shock dispersion $\delta$, and the foreign demand shifters $(\mathcal{D}^*_a, \mathcal{D}^*_n)$. We compute the model moments as aggregate expectations over the joint distribution of productivity $F(dz)$ and clearing costs $G(dc)$.

### 11.1 Externally Calibrated Parameters

We assign values to an external block of baseline parameters using aggregate data and the literature. Using the OECD Input-Output tables, we measure the sectoral consumption shares $\phi_a = 0.04$ and $\phi_n = 0.96$ as each sector's proportion of total household final consumption, and we calculate the

home bias parameters $\alpha_a = 0.96$ and $\alpha_n = 0.93$ as the domestic share of total sectoral expenditure. The non-agricultural intermediate input expenditure share $\nu_n = 0.54$ is derived from the labor share reported in the OECD System of National Accounts. For the agricultural production function, we set the intermediate input shares $\nu_c = 0.44$ and $\nu_p = 0.17$ and the land elasticity shares $\gamma_c = 0.50$ and $\gamma_p = 0.53$ to match the estimates from Pellegrina (2022). We set the elasticity of substitution between domestic and foreign goods $\sigma = 2$ following Feenstra et al. (2018), and the export elasticity $\theta = 5$ following Qiu et al. (2026). The elasticities of substitution between varieties are set to $\eta_a = 4.1$ in agriculture and $\eta_n = 3.2$ in non-agriculture, implying sectoral markups consistent with Heresi (2024). Finally, we normalize the total labor endowment $N$, the baseline traditional technology $A_t$, the common plot size $h$, and the foreign import prices $P^*_{f,a}$ and $P^*_{f,n}$ to one, and set the baseline environmental policy $\tau$ to zero.

### 11.2 Employment Size Distributions

We calibrate the parameters $\{A_m, \kappa_{tn}, \kappa_{mn}, \kappa_{ta}, \kappa_{ma}, \zeta, \delta\}$ by fitting model predictions for the firm employment distribution to microdata jointly across all sectors. We build on the insight of Buera et al. (2021) and Buera & Trachter (2024) that the cross-sectional distribution of employment identifies entry and adoption costs. The discrete decisions to enter the market and adopt modern technologies determine the share of employment mass across different firm sizes. We identify the fixed entry and adoption costs, along with the modern productivity premium and ex-post shock dispersions, by matching empirical employment shares across discrete size bins.

For the non-agricultural sectors, we compute employment shares across 21 bins per sector using Brazil's Relação Anual de Informações Sociais (RAIS), a registry covering formal workers. In agriculture however, RAIS would substantially understate the true farm size distribution because agricultural labor is highly informal. Therefore, we estimate the agricultural entry and adoption cost using the Censo Agropecuário 2017, which captures informal labor and reports establishment counts across six size buckets.

In the non-agricultural sector, employment is proportional to operating profit. Conditional on the ex-ante productivity $z$ and the ex-post shock $\omega$, the labor bill is

$$n_{i,n}(z,\omega) = e^{(\eta_n-1)\omega}\,\frac{(1-\nu_n)(\eta_n-1)}{\eta_n}\Big(\frac{\eta_n-1}{\eta_n}\Big)^{\eta_n-1}\frac{(A_i z)^{\eta_n-1}P_{d,n}^{\eta_n}Y_n}{\big[P_n^{\nu_n}/\big(\nu_n^{\nu_n}(1-\nu_n)^{1-\nu_n}\big)\big]^{\eta_n-1}}. \tag{35}$$

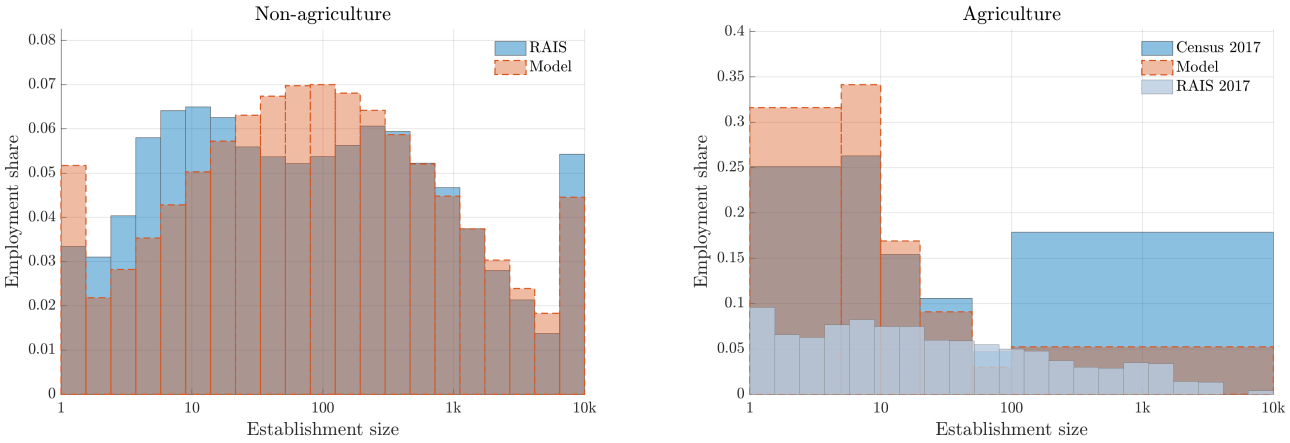
In the agricultural sector, the employment distribution is derived from the sum of crop and pasture labor inputs:

$$n_a(z,c) = \tfrac{\eta_a-1}{\eta_a}\big[(1-\nu_c-\gamma_c)\,p_d^c\,y^c + (1-\nu_p-\gamma_p)\,p_d^p\,y^p\big]. \tag{36}$$

We match the theoretical firm size distributions from both sectors directly to the empirical data to jointly identify the parameters $\{A_m, \kappa_{tn}, \kappa_{mn}, \kappa_{ta}, \kappa_{ma}, \zeta, \delta\}$. Here the sector specific fixed entry costs $\kappa_{tn}$ and $\kappa_{ta}$ determine the minimum size of an active firm and anchor the lower bounds of the respective employment distributions. Since the underlying productivity draws govern the proportion of larger firms, the common Pareto tail parameter $\zeta$ is identified from the decline in employment

shares across upper bins in both sectors. Note that adopting the modern technology increases a firm's labor demand, which implies the size difference between traditional and modern firms pins down the common modern premium $A_m$ along with the sector specific adoption costs $\kappa_{mn}$ and $\kappa_{ma}$. Finally, the ex-post shock $\omega$ disperses employment sizes within each non-agricultural technology class to yield a smooth theoretical distribution, so we identify the dispersion parameter $\delta$ by matching the model to the RAIS registry.

Figure 11: Employment size distributions in the model and in the data




*Notes.* Sectoral employment shares by establishment size (measured in workers, logarithmic scale). Left panel (Non-agriculture): Compares the fitted model (red) with the RAIS (blue) across 21 bins in 2003. Right panel (Agriculture): Compares the model (red) with the 2017 Censo Agropecuário across six bins and RAIS data from 2017.

In Figure 11 we compare the resulting employment shares in the model and in the data. Outside agriculture our model captures the wide middle of the size distribution together with the concentration of employment in very large establishments. In agriculture, the model is able to match the concentration of workers on small farms.

### 11.3 The Land-Use Elasticities: Identifying $\varepsilon_h$ and $\varepsilon_p$

The substitution elasticities $(\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p)$ govern the farm's reallocation of land between crops, pasture, and deforestation. We calibrate $(\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p)$ by matching the model's crop-share responses to a foreign-demand shock in the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil to the peak responses ($\tau = 4$) from our empirical specification (Table 1).

By construction, our model abstracts from explicit spatial variation, however the clearing cost draw $c$ introduces heterogeneity in the profitability of forest conversion and captures underlying differences in land abundance between the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil. We interpret low clearing cost draws as representing easier access to land for pasture expansion, as in the Legal Amazon. In the model, a lower clearing cost induces farmers to allocate more land to pasture and reduces the crop share $s_c \equiv l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$. We therefore exploit the relationship between crop shares and location in microdata from the CAR matched with land use data from MapBiomas to estimate each farmer's

probability of being located within the Legal Amazon. More specifically, we turn to microdata and estimate the conditional probability that a farm is located in the Legal Amazon given its crop share via a logistic regression,

$$\hat{\beta}(s_{c,i}) \;\equiv\; \widehat{\Pr}\big(j(i) \in \text{Legal Amazon} \,\big|\, s_{c,i}\big) \in [0,1], \tag{37}$$

and assign each simulated farm in the model a propensity $\beta(z,c) \equiv \hat{\beta}\big(s_c(z,c)\big)$. We estimate $\beta(z,c)$ with a cubic logistic regression on 6.7 million farms using our data from the CAR and MapBiomas.[20] Table G.2 in Appendix G reports the coefficients and in Figure 12 we plot the fitted curve. Our estimate suggests that farms without crop land are located within the Legal Amazon with a probability of roughly one third, which falls below five percent once crops cover a third of the farm. Hence, farms devoted mainly to pasture are far more likely to be located within the Legal Amazon.[21]

For any farm-level outcome $X(z,c)$, we then compute the regional conditional expectations by weighting the joint distribution of productivity and clearing costs by the estimated propensity $\hat{\beta}(s_{c,i})$, integrating over active farms with $z \geq z_{ta}(c)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\big[X \mid \text{Amazon}\big] &= \frac{\displaystyle\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} X\,\beta\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}{\displaystyle\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} \beta\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}, \\
\mathbb{E}\big[X \mid \text{non-Amazon}\big] &= \frac{\displaystyle\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} X\,(1-\beta)\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}{\displaystyle\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} (1-\beta)\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}.
\end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

A well-known challenge in mapping cross-sectional estimates to structural models is that regressions with time fixed effects absorb any general equilibrium response common to all units, recovering only relative effects across differentially exposed units (e.g., Nakamura & Steinsson 2014, Guren et al. 2021, Wolf 2023). In our setting, the year fixed effects in our baseline regression in equation (10) absorb any common adjustment in agricultural prices that the foreign-demand shock induces in general equilibrium. To construct model counterparts that are consistent with our estimation, we perturb $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ and re-solve for the new general equilibrium, then subtract the national average crop-share response from each region's response. Since the general-equilibrium price adjustment is common to every farm regardless of its clearing cost draw, the national average captures the same common component that the year fixed effects absorb in the empirical regression.[22] We identify $(\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p)$ by targeting the

[20] Specifically, we estimate $\hat{\beta}(s_{c,i}) = \Lambda\big(\beta_0 + \beta_1 s_{c,i} + \beta_2 s_{c,i}^2 + \beta_3 s_{c,i}^3\big)$ by maximum likelihood on $N = 6{,}729{,}685$ farming properties in the 2003 CAR cross section matched with land use data from MapBiomas, where $\Lambda(\cdot)$ denotes the logistic function and $s_{c,i} \equiv l_{c,i}/(l_{c,i} + l_{p,i} + d_i)$ is the crop share of farm $i$. Table G.2 reports the coefficients.

[21] In Appendix I we estimate an alternative specification $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ that also conditions on farming area, so that large pasture farms can reach Amazon probabilities above 70 percent. Identifying $\varepsilon_h$ and $\varepsilon_p$ using $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ leaves both elasticities and our qualitative conclusions virtually unchanged.

[22] Note that $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ enters the model only through the goods market clearing condition for $Y_a$, so a change in $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ is isomorphic to a change in $P_{d,a}$. The variation that survives demeaning is therefore the cross-sectional heterogeneity in the response of $l_c/(h+d)$ to the common change in $P_{d,a}$ across the joint distribution of $(z,c)$, which is governed by $(\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p)$.

Table 1: Land-use responses to foreign demand and the model fit

*Panel A. Empirical responses (area share, pp)*

| | Foreign demand | | Credit access |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dependent variable | Legal Amazon | Non-Amazon | ATT |
| Crop (soybean) | $-1.84^{***}$ | $0.37^{**}$ | $5.50^{***}$ |
| | $(0.29)$ | $(0.17)$ | $(1.25)$ |
| Pasture | $1.78^{***}$ | $-0.21^{**}$ | $-4.16^{***}$ |
| | $(0.32)$ | $(0.09)$ | $(1.00)$ |
| Forest | $-0.41^{***}$ | $0.05$ | $0.18$ |
| | $(0.13)$ | $(0.03)$ | $(0.24)$ |

*Panel B. Targeted moments (demeaned, pp)*

| | Data | Model |
|---|---|---|
| Crop-share response, Legal Amazon | $[-2.41,\ -1.27]$ | $-1.90$ |
| Crop-share response, Non-Amazon | $[+0.04,\ +0.70]$ | $+0.15$ |

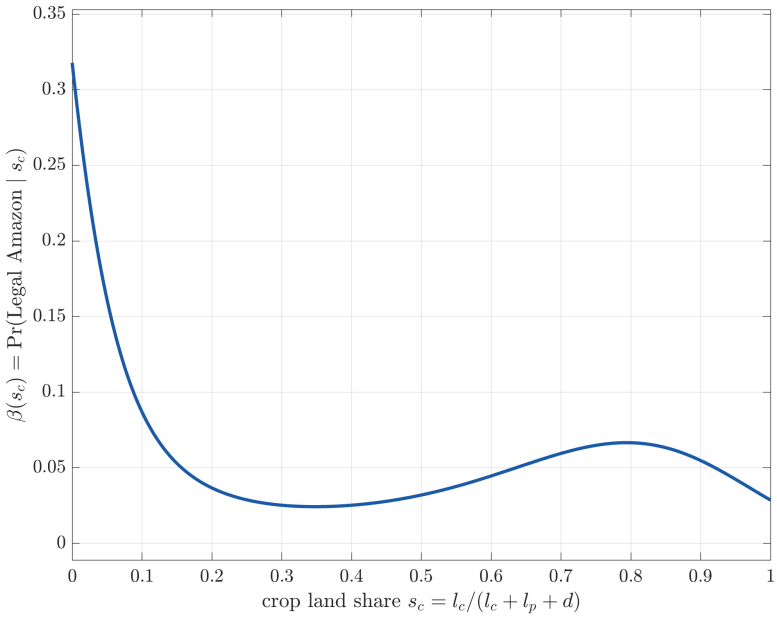
*Notes.* Panel A reports the peak response at horizon $\tau = 4$ from equation (10), estimated separately for the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil. The credit column reports the average treatment effect at $\tau = 4$ from our difference-in-differences specification. Standard errors in parentheses. $^{***}$, $^{**}$, and $^{*}$ denote significance at the 1, 5, and 10% levels. Panel B reports 95 percent confidence intervals from Panel A alongside the demeaned model counterpart, in percentage points (pp).

crop-share responses

$$\frac{\partial\,\mathbb{E}\big[l_c/(h+d)\,\big|\,\text{Amazon}\big]}{\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*} \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{\partial\,\mathbb{E}\big[l_c/(h+d)\,\big|\,\text{non-Amazon}\big]}{\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*}, \tag{39}$$

each expressed relative to the national average $\partial\,\mathbb{E}[l_c/(h+d)]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ (demeaned). We target $-1.84$ percentage points for the Legal Amazon and $+0.37$ for the rest of Brazil, matching the peak responses at horizon $\tau = 4$ from the separate Amazon and non-Amazon specifications. Panel B of Table 1 shows the model fit. In our calibration we pin down $\varepsilon_h = 3.10$ and $\varepsilon_p = 1.95$. The remaining demeaned responses (pasture, forest, and adoption expenditure) as well as the response to subsidized credit are untargeted moments reported in Table 2.

Figure 12: The probability of Amazon location as a function of the crop land share




*Notes.* The curve plots the fitted probability that a farm lies in the Legal Amazon conditional on its crop share of farm area, estimated by a cubic logistic regression on 6.7 million farms in the CAR matched with data from MapBiomas for 2003.

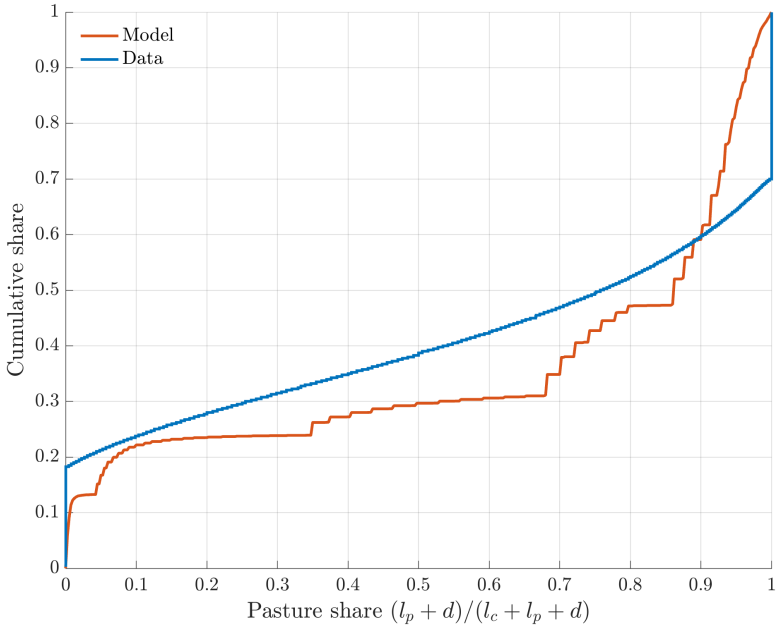
### 11.4 Remaining Internally Calibrated Parameters

The remaining internal parameters are jointly calibrated such that the model's implied moments match their empirical counterparts. The agricultural production weight $\rho$ is pinned down by matching the crop share of agricultural production value from FAO data, and the foreign demand shifters $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ and $\mathcal{D}_n^*$ target the sectoral export-to-consumption ratios from the OECD Input-Output tables.

In our model, clearing costs shape how farms use land. Farms facing low clearing costs expand pasture by converting forest, while farms facing high clearing costs allocate more of their owned land $h$ to crop cultivation. The empirical distribution of pasture shares across farms is therefore directly informative about the underlying distribution of clearing costs.

To match the model to the empirically observed pasture share distribution, we assume that clearing costs follow a shifted log-normal distribution, $\ln(c - \underline{c}) \sim \mathcal{N}(\ln \bar{c}, \varepsilon^2)$, defined by the parameters $(\bar{c}, \varepsilon, \underline{c})$. The log-normal functional form captures the two salient features of the land-use cross-section: i) a large mass of farms with moderate costs and ii) a long right tail of farms for which clearing is effectively prohibitive. The floor $\underline{c} > 0$ bounds costs away from zero, reflecting that even the most accessible forest requires machinery and fuel to convert. The lower bound $\underline{c}$ is also quantitatively necessary because without $\underline{c}$, farms drawing a very low clearing cost would deforest unrealistically large areas.

Figure 13: Cumulative distribution of pasture shares across farms




*Notes.* The figure plots the cumulative distribution of the pasture share of farm area in the model and in the 2003 CAR registry. The model distribution aggregates farm level shares over the calibrated joint distribution of productivity and clearing costs. The mean and the standard deviation of this distribution are targeted in the calibration, while the rest of the shape is left free.

The parameters $(\bar{c}, \varepsilon, \underline{c})$ are calibrated to match three moments: (i) the mean pasture share across farms, (ii) the standard deviation of pasture shares across farms, and (iii) the aggregate pasture-to-crop land ratio. We use the first two moments from the CAR matched with MapBiomas data from 2003 to inform $\bar{c}$ and $\varepsilon$. A higher level of clearing costs reduces the mean pasture share, while dispersion in clearing costs contributes to variation in pasture shares across farms. However, pasture shares provide limited information about the cost floor $\underline{c}$ when farms with low clearing costs allocate almost all farm area to pasture. Further reductions in clearing costs can substantially increase cleared area with little change in pasture shares, which are already close to one. We therefore also match the model's aggregate pasture-to-crop land ratio to MapBiomas data to inform $\underline{c}$. Unlike the mean pasture share across farms, the aggregate ratio reflects differences in farm size and is therefore sensitive to the large areas of pasture operated by farms with low clearing costs. In the data, the average farm has a pasture share of roughly $0.60$, whereas pasture accounts for approximately $0.80$ of aggregate farm area.

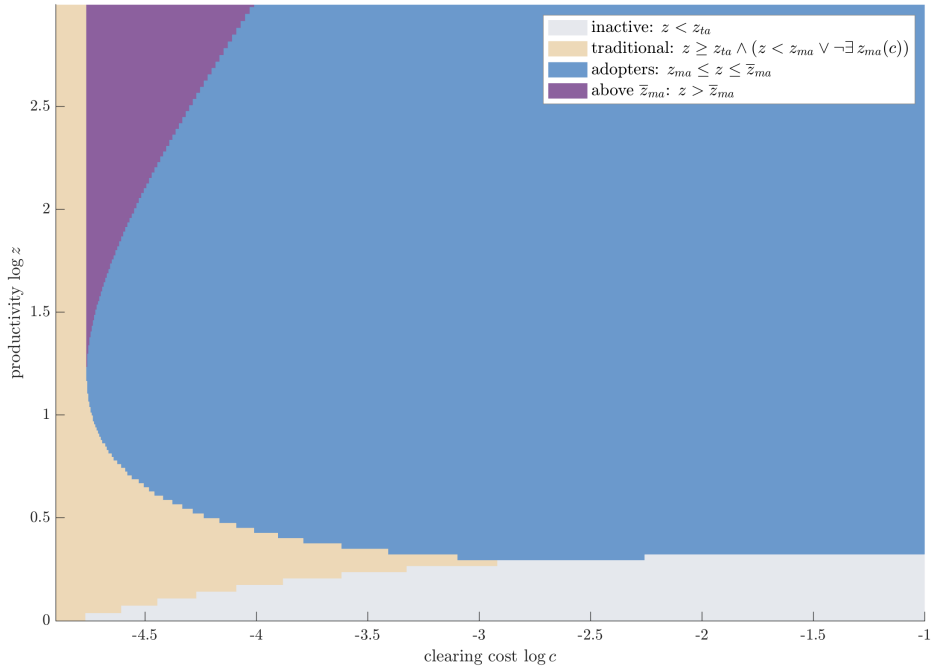
All parameters are estimated jointly, with model moments computed as aggregate expectations over the joint distribution of productivity and clearing costs. The mean pasture share pins down $\bar{c}$, its dispersion pins down $\varepsilon$, and the aggregate land ratio pins down $\underline{c}$. Figure 13 shows the resulting fit.

## 12 The Calibrated Economy and External Validity

Our model predicts that even highly productive farmers may optimally forgo modern technology when clearing costs are sufficiently low. Figure 14 shows entry and technology choices across

productivity and clearing cost draws $(z, c)$ in the calibrated model.

Figure 14: Technology choice across productivity and clearing draws




*Notes.* We partition the space of productivity $z$ and clearing cost $c$, both on logarithmic axes, into the regions implied by the calibrated thresholds. Farms below $z_{ta}(c)$ stay out of agriculture. Active farms adopt the modern technology inside the band $[z_{ma}(c), \overline{z}_{ma}(c)]$ and operate the traditional technology elsewhere, including where $z_{ma}(c)$ does not exist and no farm modernizes. Where $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$ does not exist the band is unbounded from above. In equilibrium 30 percent of active farms are modern.

Note that the x-axis in Figure 14 maps directly to our estimated probability of being located within the Legal Amazon through $\beta(z, c)$. Hence, for the sake of intuition, we can think of a lower clearing cost as equivalent to a higher probability of being in the Legal Amazon with a higher optimal share of pasture.

Farms that draw a low clearing cost (and thus are assigned a higher probability of being in the Amazon) face a lower entry threshold $z_{ta}(c)$ because access to inexpensive land raises expected profits, allowing less productive operations to cover the fixed entry cost. Thus, the least productive active farms in our economy are those with the highest probability of being in the Amazon. Overall, we show below that the probability weighted share of farms within the Amazon (around 9%) matches closely with what we observe in the data.

Once active, farms adopt the modern technology inside the band, $z_{ma}(c) \leq z \leq \overline{z}_{ma}(c)$, and stay traditional either if $z < z_{ma}(c)$, or when clearing costs are so low that $z_{ma}(c)$ simply does not exist (formally, we write $\neg\exists\, z_{ma}(c)$ in the figure's legend). For farms drawing low clearing costs, the marginal value of pasture drives a reallocation away from crops such that $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$ becomes finite. Farms drawing a productivity level $z$ that exceeds $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$ therefore forgo technology and operate under the traditional technology. Since we think of a lower clearing cost being equivalent to a higher

probability of being located within the Legal Amazon, the model implies a lower aggregate adoption rate within the Amazon and we show below that our calibration also closely matches the relative adoption rate as an untargeted empirical moment.

**Untargeted Moments.** Our model is able to match a range of key untargeted moments that we summarize in Table 2 which capture the difference in land use and technology adoption between the Legal Amazon and the rest of Brazil, and is also able to rationalize our empirical findings that we do not specifically target.

First, we examine in Panel A how our model divides land use between the Amazon and the rest of Brazil. Our calibration targets the distribution of pasture shares across individual farms, yet the model also closely matches the share of total farmland allocated to pasture within each region. Pasture represents the dominant farmland use across both regions, but the concentration is exceptionally high within the Amazon. Specifically, our model assigns 93 percent of Amazonian farmland to pasture, aligning closely with the 89 percent observed in the data. Furthermore, outside the Amazon, we match the empirical pasture share almost exactly. [23]

Second, we shift our focus in Panel A from intra-regional land allocation to the aggregate size of the Amazonian agricultural economy. Our model predicts that 9 percent of all farms locate within the Amazon and generate 13 percent of total agricultural value added, closely matching the observed data from the CAR and IBGE.[24] Furthermore, our model is able to track the concentrated nature of Amazonian agriculture, where fewer farms operate at a significantly larger size ($h + d$) and generate higher revenues, closely matching the observed farm revenues and size ratios in the data.

Third, we examine the level and regional heterogeneity of technology adoption in Panel A. To estimate an empirical counterpart for the model-implied share of farms operating modern technology, we proxy modern operations using national shares of establishments owning machinery, applying pesticides, and applying fertilizer from the 2006 Censo Agropecuário. For the non-agricultural sector, we exploit data from PINTEC and the World Bank Enterprise Survey to proxy the modern share through metrics like process innovation and fixed asset purchases.[25] Our model predicts 30 percent of farms and 40 percent of non-agricultural firms operate modern technology, which are within the ranges spanned by our empirical proxies. Importantly, our model implies that the share of Amazonian farms operating modern technology is 42 percent of the non-Amazonian share, compared with census

[23] We measure regional land use from MapBiomas land cover in 2003, aggregated within and outside the Legal Amazon.

[24] We take agricultural value added by state in 2003 from IBGE's municipal GDP accounts (PIB dos Municípios, SIDRA table 5938) and aggregate the nine Legal Amazon states, with Maranhão entering in proportion to its statutory municipalities' share of agricultural value added. Farm counts are from the Rural Environmental Registry (CAR).

[25] For farms, we use the 2006 Censo Agropecuário, extracting state-level counts of establishments owning machinery (including tractors, trucks, pickups, and trailers), applying pesticides, and applying fertilizer. Nationally, 10 percent of the 5.2 million establishments own machinery, 27 percent use pesticides, and 36 percent use fertilizer. To construct the regional ratio, we aggregate establishment counts across the nine Legal Amazon states and compare the totals against the remaining states, yielding an Amazon adoption rate of 0.39 times the non-Amazon share for machinery, 0.42 for pesticides, and 0.20 for fertilizer. For the non-agricultural sector, we capture the modern share using survey measures of firm sophistication. In PINTEC 2017, 39,329 of the 116,962 surveyed firms (34 percent) report implementing product or process innovations. In the World Bank Enterprise Survey for Brazil 2009, the survey-weighted share of firms offering formal worker training is 0.42, operating a website is 0.56, and purchasing fixed assets is 0.61.

ratios of 42 percent for pesticides, 39 percent for machinery, and 20 percent for fertilizer. Hence, the low technological modernization within the Legal Amazon—a central feature of our model—emerges as an endogenous prediction of the model that closely aligns with the observed data.

Table 2: Untargeted moments

| | Model counterpart | Model | Data | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Panel A. Cross-sectional moments* | | | | |
| *Land use* | | | | |
| Pasture share of farmland, Legal Amazon | $\frac{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(l_p+d)\,\beta\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(l_c+l_p+d)\,\beta\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}$ | 0.93 | 0.89 | MapBiomas |
| Pasture share of farmland, non-Amazon | $\frac{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(l_p+d)\,(1-\beta)\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(l_c+l_p+d)\,(1-\beta)\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}$ | 0.78 | 0.76 | MapBiomas |
| *The Amazon in the aggregate* | | | | |
| Share of farms in the Amazon | $\mathbb{E}[\,\beta\,]$ | 0.09 | 0.13 | CAR |
| Amazon share of agricultural value added | $\frac{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(p_d^c y_j^c + p_d^p y_j^p)\,\beta\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}{\int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty}(p_d^c y_j^c + p_d^p y_j^p)\,F(dz)\,G(dc)}$ | 0.13 | 0.17 | IBGE |
| Mean farm revenue, Amazon / non-Amazon | $\frac{\mathbb{E}[\,p_d^c y_j^c + p_d^p y_j^p \mid \text{Amazon}\,]}{\mathbb{E}[\,p_d^c y_j^c + p_d^p y_j^p \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]}$ | 1.43 | 1.28 | IBGE, CAR |
| Mean farm size, Amazon / non-Amazon | $\frac{\mathbb{E}[\,l_c + l_p + d \mid \text{Amazon}\,]}{\mathbb{E}[\,l_c + l_p + d \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]}$ | 1.73 | 1.94 | CAR |
| *Technology adoption* | | | | |
| Share of modern farms | $a_a/e_a$ | 0.30 | 0.10–0.36 | Censo Agropecuário |
| Share of modern non-agricultural firms | $a_n/e_n$ | 0.40 | 0.34–0.61 | PINTEC, Enterprise Survey |
| Adoption rate, Amazon / non-Amazon | $\frac{\Pr\,[\,z \in [z_{ma}(c), \overline{z}_{ma}(c)] \mid \text{Amazon}\,]}{\Pr\,[\,z \in [z_{ma}(c), \overline{z}_{ma}(c)] \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]}$ | 0.42 | 0.20–0.42 | Censo Agropecuário |
| *Panel B. Response to foreign demand (demeaned)* | | | | |
| *Legal Amazon* | | | | |
| Pasture share (pp) | $\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,(l_p+d)/(h+d) \mid \text{Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $+2.16$ | $[+1.15,\ +2.41]$ | Own estimate |
| Forest share (pp) | $-\,\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,d/(h+d) \mid \text{Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $-2.15$ | $[-0.67,\ -0.15]$ | Own estimate |
| Adoption expenditure (%) | $\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,\log(1+\mathbf{1}\{i=m\}\,P_n\kappa_{ma}) \mid \text{Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $-0.25$ | $[-0.45,\ -0.16]$ | Own estimate |
| *Non-Amazon* | | | | |
| Pasture share (pp) | $\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,(l_p+d)/(h+d) \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $-0.17$ | $[-0.39,\ -0.03]$ | Own estimate |
| Forest share (pp) | $-\,\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,d/(h+d) \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $+0.17$ | $[-0.01,\ +0.11]$ | Own estimate |
| Adoption expenditure (%) | $\partial\,\mathbb{E}[\,\log(1+\mathbf{1}\{i=m\}\,P_n\kappa_{ma}) \mid \text{non-Amazon}\,]/\partial \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$ | $+0.03$ | $[-0.05,\ +0.08]$ | Own estimate |
| *Panel C. Response to subsidized credit (PE)* | | | | |
| Crop share (pp) | $\Delta\,\mathbb{E}[\,s_c\,]\big\vert_{\kappa_{ma}\to 0.69\,\kappa_{ma}}$ | $+12.4$ | $[+4.20,\ +14.54]$ | Own estimate |
| Forest share (pp) | $-\,\Delta\,\mathbb{E}[\,d/(h+d)\,]\big\vert_{\kappa_{ma}\to 0.69\,\kappa_{ma}}$ | $+1.66$ | $[-2.04,\ +1.14]$ | Own estimate |

*Notes.* For any farm level outcome $X(z,c)$ we write $\mathbb{E}[X] = \int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} X\,F(dz)\,G(dc) \,/\, \int_{\underline{c}}^{\infty}\int_{z_{ta}(c)}^{\infty} F(dz)\,G(dc)$, and Amazon and non-Amazon following equation (38). In Panel A, we use MapBiomas land cover in 2003, aggregated within and outside the Legal Amazon. Farm counts and farm areas are from the 6.7 million farms in the 2003 Rural Environmental Registry (CAR), and agricultural value added by state from IBGE's municipal GDP accounts (PIB dos Municípios). To measure technology adoption, we exploit data from the 2006 Censo Agropecuário to calculate shares in pesticide use (0.27), tractor ownership (0.10), and fertilizer use (0.36), and ratios between the Amazon and non-Amazon (0.42, 0.39, and 0.20). For non-agricultural firms, we use innovation activity in PINTEC 2017 (0.34) and worker training (0.42), website use (0.56), and fixed asset purchases (0.61) in the World Bank Enterprise Survey Brazil 2009. In Panel B we report 95 percent confidence intervals of our own estimates ($\tau = 4$ for pasture and forest, $\tau = 7$ for *technology goods and services*), demeaned by the national average. In Panel C we report 95 percent confidence intervals of our own estimates ($\tau = 7$). To replicate the empirical estimates for the use of subsidized credit, we lower the fixed modernization cost $\kappa_{ma}$ by the average borrowing spread of 45 percent in Brazil (Cavalcanti et al. 2023) at fixed $(P_{d,a}, P_{d,n}, Y_a, Y_n, \mathcal{H})$ in partial equilibrium (PE).

Fourth, although our calibration targets only the demeaned crop-share responses, the model closely reproduces our farm-level empirical estimates of the reallocation from crops into pasture and the decline in adoption expenditure in the Legal Amazon. Outside the Amazon, land use and technology

spending are largely unresponsive to the demand shock in both the model and the data, a pattern the model attributes to heterogeneity in the cost of clearing forest. One caveat in our model is that deforestation is always an available margin to expand production, however in the data many farms may not have remaining forest on their plot, such that the model overpredicts the magnitude of the forest response relative to our empirical estimates. Note that we measure deforestation only within the registered farm boundary, so any clearing that farmers undertake outside their property is not captured in our empirical estimate on forest loss.

Fifth, in Panel C we examine how the model responds to subsidized credit. In the data, subsidized credit lowers the cost of financing technology investments, which in Brazil carry an average borrowing spread of 45 percent (Cavalcanti et al. 2023). In the model, we capture subsidized credit as a fall in the fixed modernization cost by the same factor, from $\kappa_{ma}$ to $\kappa_{ma}/1.45 \approx 0.69\,\kappa_{ma}$, and we hold $(P_{d,a}, P_{d,n}, Y_a, Y_n, \mathcal{H})$ fixed in partial equilibrium (PE) to account for the time fixed effects in our difference-in-differences specification that absorb any common price adjustment between treated and control farms. A lower modernization cost lowers the adoption cutoff $z_{ma}$, so more farms adopt the modern technology and move land out of pasture and into crops, and the model's crop share response lies inside the confidence interval of our difference-in-differences estimate. The new adopters also clear less forest, which raises the forest share, though the model overpredicts the magnitude relative to what we observe empirically.

Lastly, recall that we depart from a perfectly substitutable owned-plot allocation between pasture $l_p$ and crop cultivation $l_c$ such that there exists non-farmed vacant land $v = h - l_c - l_p > 0$ if a farmer does not specialize into one activity. This is a reduced-form modeling approach to capture implicit gains from specialization that the literature documents. In our calibrated model $\varepsilon_h = 3.1$ which implies that the share of vacant land inside the owned plot $v/h$ is roughly 28% if the farmer splits the owned-land equally into crops and pasture. In Appendix Figure F.2 we investigate this implication for more than 6 million properties in the CAR and show that in the median our model prediction about the size of vacant land within properties aligns with the data (a dimension we do not target).[26]

## 13 The Commodity Boom

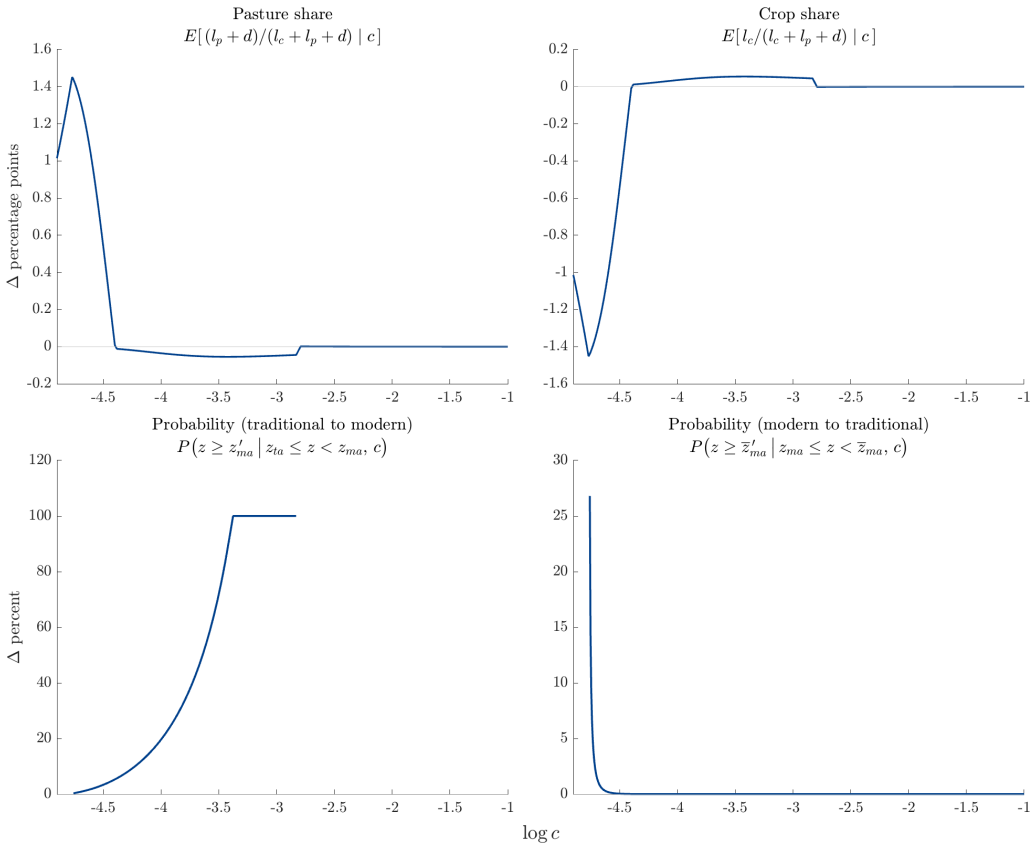
In this section, we use the calibrated model to study the commodity boom from two perspectives. First, we analyze the cross-sectional response of farms, focusing on how differences in the cost of land expansion shape adjustments in land use and technology adoption. Second, we extend the calibration over time to quantify the aggregate effects of the commodity boom and decompose agricultural value added growth into contributions from land, technology, and general equilibrium adjustments.

[26]We take this result with a grain of salt since vacant land may also arise from land characteristics such as unsuitable terrain, degraded land or legal forest reserve requirements which our model abstracts from. Nevertheless, our model is able to capture the distribution of both farmed and non-farmed areas within properties that we observe in Brazil.

### 13.1 The Commodity Boom in the Cross-Section

We start by using the calibrated model for 2003 to trace how an agricultural commodity boom changes the allocation of land and technology across the farm distribution. Specifically, we double foreign agricultural demand $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ and solve for the new equilibrium, allowing all prices, entry decisions, technology choices, and land allocations to adjust endogenously. While we derive the comparative statics in partial equilibrium in Proposition 2, we now show that the same forces govern the aggregate response in full general equilibrium. In Figure 15 we plot the resulting responses of land use and technology choice conditional on the clearing cost draw $c$.

Figure 15: Farm responses to a doubling of foreign agricultural demand




*Notes.* Each panel plots the response to a doubling of foreign agricultural demand $\mathcal{D}_a^*$, as a function of the log clearing cost. The upper panels show the percentage point change of the average pasture and crop share of farmed area. The lower panels show the percentage changes in transition probabilities: the probability that a farm traditional before the shock transitions to the modern technology, $P(z \geq z'_{ma} \mid z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}, c)$, and the probability that a farm modern before the shock reverts to the traditional technology, $P(z \geq \overline{z}'_{ma} \mid z_{ma} \leq z < \overline{z}_{ma}, c)$, where $z'_{ma}$ and $\overline{z}'_{ma}$ denote the post-shock modernization thresholds.

In the upper row of Figure 15 we plot the percentage point change of the average pasture and crop shares of farmed area conditional on the clearing cost, $\mathbb{E}[(l_p+d)/(l_c+l_p+d) \mid c]$ and $\mathbb{E}[l_c/(l_c+l_p+d) \mid c]$, across $\log c$. An increase in foreign demand $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ raises equilibrium prices. For farms with a low clearing cost $c$, the most profitable path to expansion is to clear new forest, which substitutes imperfectly for

established pasture and thereby raises the marginal value of operating owned pasture alongside the newly cleared land. Consequently, farms with low $c$ clear new forest and shift owned plots away from crops and into pasture, raising the average pasture share by up to 1.5 percentage points while the average crop share falls by the same amount. By contrast, for farms with a high clearing cost $c$, the land allocation is relatively unresponsive, because farms facing expensive clearing convert little forest. On the owned plot, the boom raises the return to crop land and the return to pasture land almost in proportion, as the two output elasticities of land are nearly identical, $\gamma_c = 0.50$ against $\gamma_p = 0.53$ (as per estimates from Pellegrina 2022). Given a high $c$, with relative returns essentially unchanged, farms scale up production without reallocating land within the owned plot.

The lower two panels plot the probability of switching technologies for a given clearing cost draw. The left panel shows the probability that a traditional farm before the shock, $z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}$, transitions to the modern technology after the shock, $P(z \geq z'_{ma} \mid z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}, c)$, where $z'_{ma}$ denotes the post-shock adoption threshold. The increase in foreign agricultural demand lowers all three thresholds, $z_{ta}(c)$, $z_{ma}(c)$, and $\overline{z}_{ma}(c)$. Here the probability of farms switching from traditional to modern increases with the clearing cost draw until farmers modernize with a probability of one. For clearing cost draws above around $\log c = -2.8$, the entry and adoption thresholds coincide $z_{ta}(c) = z_{ma}(c)$.

The right lower panel shows the probability that a modern farm before the shock, $z_{ma} \leq z < \overline{z}_{ma}$, reverts to the traditional technology, $P(z \geq \overline{z}'_{ma} \mid z_{ma} \leq z < \overline{z}_{ma}, c)$, where $\overline{z}'_{ma}$ denotes the post-shock upper threshold. Farms drawing very low clearing cost (around $\log c = -4.8$) then transition from modern to traditional with a probability of around 27%. Given our probability mapping $\beta$, farms in the Amazon reduce their spending into the modern technology as they reallocate land away from the capital-intensive crop activity and into land-intensive pasture.

### 13.2 The Commodity Boom over Time

Next, we extend the calibrated model over time to study how the commodity boom translates into growth in agricultural value added. Our framework abstracts from dynamic transitions, so we solve a separate equilibrium for each year, denoted by $t = 2000, \ldots, 2014$. Therefore we calibrate $(\mathcal{D}^*_{a,t}, \mathcal{D}^*_{n,t}, \rho_t)$ to match the real dollar values of soy, beef, and non-agricultural exports relative to the baseline calibration in 2003. The foreign demand shifters $\mathcal{D}^*_{a,t}$ and $\mathcal{D}^*_{n,t}$ determine the level of agricultural and non-agricultural export demand, while $\rho_t$ captures the composition of agricultural exports between soy and beef.[27] To see how $\rho_t$ maps into export composition, we denote by $\chi_t$ the crop expenditure share of the agricultural aggregate good $Y_a$:

$$\chi_t = \rho_t \int \left( \frac{p^c_{d,j}}{P_{d,a,t}} \right)^{1-\eta_a} dj. \tag{40}$$

[27] Our model aggregates crops and livestock into a single domestically produced agricultural good $Y_a$ through the CES aggregator in equation (17). Agricultural output $Y_a$ is therefore sold both in the domestic market and abroad. This means that one caveat of calibrating $\rho_t$ over time to match the export composition between beef and soy is that we also change the composition of domestic demand.

Agricultural exports in foreign currency are $P_{d,a,t}E_{a,t}/\mathcal{H}_t$ and the crop expenditure share $\chi_t$ allocates agricultural export value between crops and livestock, which we map to soy and beef in the data. We target the following three export moments in each year:

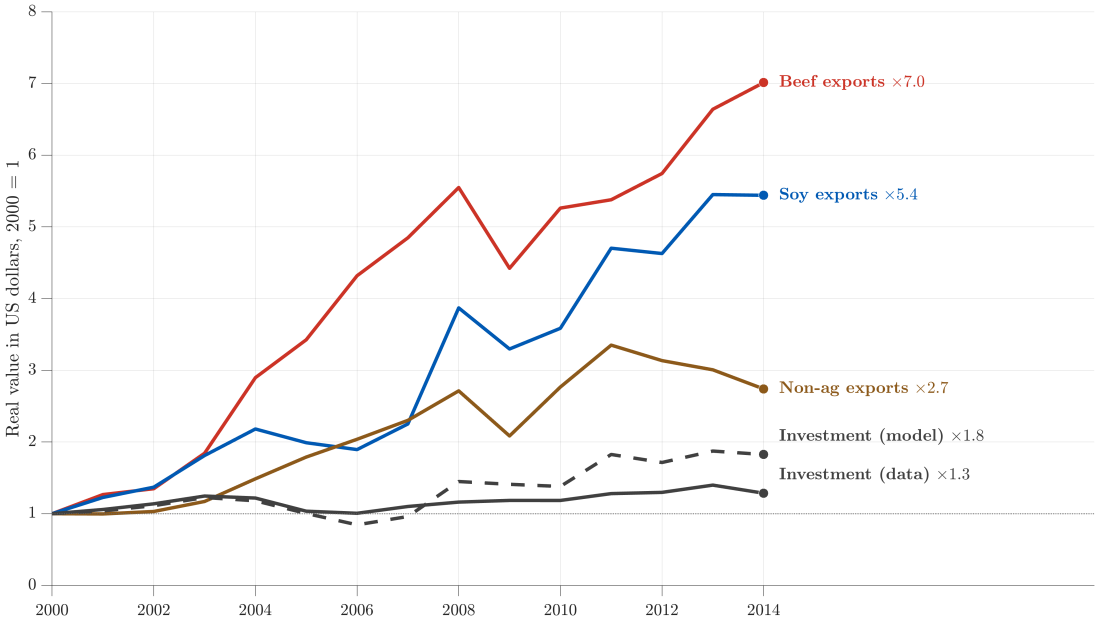
$$\frac{\chi_t P_{d,a,t}E_{a,t}/\mathcal{H}_t}{\chi_{2003}P_{d,a,2003}E_{a,2003}/\mathcal{H}_{2003}} = \frac{\text{Exports}_t^{\text{soy}}}{\text{Exports}_{2003}^{\text{soy}}} \tag{41}$$

$$\frac{(1-\chi_t)P_{d,a,t}E_{a,t}/\mathcal{H}_t}{(1-\chi_{2003})P_{d,a,2003}E_{a,2003}/\mathcal{H}_{2003}} = \frac{\text{Exports}_t^{\text{beef}}}{\text{Exports}_{2003}^{\text{beef}}} \tag{42}$$

$$\frac{P_{d,n,t}E_{n,t}/\mathcal{H}_t}{P_{d,n,2003}E_{n,2003}/\mathcal{H}_{2003}} = \frac{\text{Exports}_t^{n}}{\text{Exports}_{2003}^{n}} \tag{43}$$

where $\text{Exports}_t^{\text{soy}}$, $\text{Exports}_t^{\text{beef}}$, and $\text{Exports}_t^{n}$ are data on Brazil's exports of soy, of beef, and of all non-agricultural goods in year $t$, in constant 2003 dollars.

Figure 16: The export boom through the model, 2000–2014




*Notes.* All series are normalized to one in 2000. Soy, beef, and non-agricultural exports in constant 2003 dollars are matched to their model counterparts $\chi_t P_{d,a,t}E_{a,t}/\mathcal{H}_t$, $(1-\chi_t)P_{d,a,t}E_{a,t}/\mathcal{H}_t$, and $P_{d,n,t}E_{n,t}/\mathcal{H}_t$ respectively. Agricultural investment $P_n a_a \kappa_{ma}/P_c$ in the model is untargeted. In the data investment is measured by gross fixed capital formation in agriculture from FAOSTAT at constant prices. Soy and beef exports targets are from FAOSTAT, and the non-agricultural export target is from the OECD Inter-Country Input-Output tables.

Figure 16 then shows the targeted paths of real soy, beef, and non-agricultural exports, together with the untargeted model-implied path of agricultural investment, $P_n a_a \kappa_{ma}/P_c$, and its empirical counterpart between 2000 and 2014. The boom draws predominantly traditional entrants into agriculture, while some highly productive modern farms with low clearing costs revert to traditional production. Agricultural production therefore expands with only limited growth in technology investment, consistent with the responses characterized in Proposition 2. Model-implied investment rises by a factor of 1.8 between 2000 and 2014, compared with 1.3 in the data, so the model somewhat

overstates the increase in agricultural investment. The remaining difference may reflect investment margins and adjustment frictions outside the model, as well as differences between the model measure of technology investment and gross fixed capital formation in the data. We compare the model-implied real exchange rate appreciation $\mathcal{H}/P_c$ with the data in Appendix J, which also delivers a close fit.

**Growth Decomposition.** We denote agricultural value added in year $t$ as $VA_{a,t}$ which is farm revenue minus spending on intermediate inputs:

$$VA_{a,t} \;=\; P_{d,a,t}\, Y_{a,t} \;-\; P_{n,t}\, X_{a,t}, \tag{44}$$

and real agricultural value added is $VA_{a,t}/P_{c,t}$. We then decompose the growth of real agricultural value added between 2000 and year $t$ by either fixing the choice variables of farms (e.g., cleared land at $d_{t=2000}$) or equilibrium prices (the domestic prices $P_{d,a}$ and $P_{d,n}$ and the exchange rate $\mathcal{H}$) at the year 2000 value, and back out each contribution by subtracting the resulting real agricultural value added from baseline real agricultural value added. Here we define an incumbent farm as a farm active in 2000 and in year $t$, and an entrant farm as a farm active in year $t$ and not in 2000. We decompose growth into eight contributions, (i) to (viii):

(i) *Technology adoption:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with $A_{i,t=2000}$ fixed for incumbent farms and the traditional level of technology for entrant farms.

(ii) *Deforestation:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with $d_{t=2000}$ fixed for incumbent farms and $d = 0$ for entrant farms.

(iii) *Owned plot reallocation:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with the owned plot land allocation $(l_{c,t=2000}, l_{p,t=2000})$ fixed for incumbent farms.

(iv) *Owned land brought into production:* real agricultural value added of entrant farms in year $t$ with the traditional level of technology and $d = 0$ fixed.

(v) *Intermediates and labor:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with $(x_{c,t=2000}, x_{p,t=2000})$ and $(n_{c,t=2000}, n_{p,t=2000})$ fixed for incumbent farms.

(vi) *Domestic prices:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with $P_{d,a,t=2000}$ and $P_{d,n,t=2000}$ fixed.

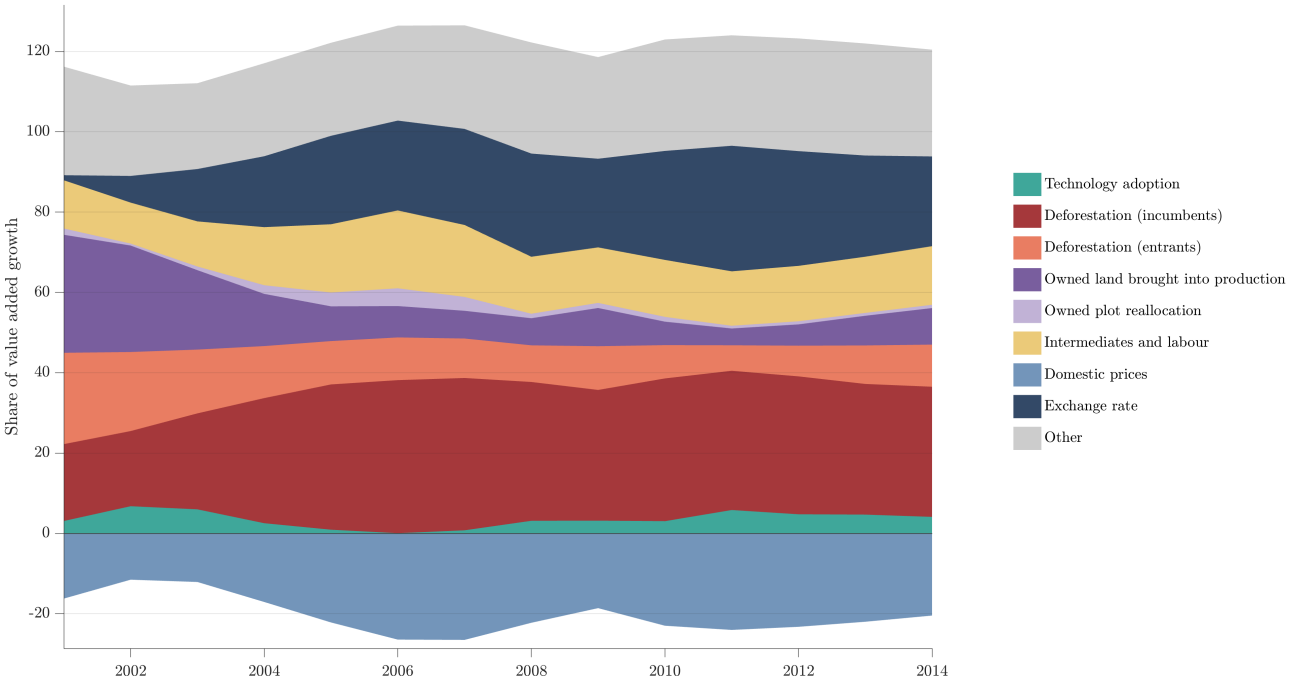
(vii) *Exchange rate:* real agricultural value added in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with $\mathcal{H}_{t=2000}$ fixed.

(viii) *Other:* the growth of real agricultural value added minus contributions (i) to (vii), which arises due to interaction between the different margins.

In Figure 17, we show the decomposition of real agricultural value added growth into percentage shares. Deforestation is the largest contributor to the growth in real agricultural value added, accounting for around 43 percent on average, while technology adoption contributes less than 10 percent.

Together with owned land brought into production and the reallocation of the owned plot, changes in land use account for around 56 percent of value added growth. Our model therefore suggests that the commodity boom raises agricultural value added primarily through the expansion and reallocation of land rather than through improvements in technology adoption. Changes in domestic prices reduce real agricultural value added, while the exchange rate appreciation lowers the domestic price of imported goods and thereby price of imported intermediate and technology goods. The appreciation also lowers the consumer price index used to deflate agricultural value added. The domestic price and exchange rate contributions largely offset each other, leaving only a small net contribution from general equilibrium price changes. The remaining growth is accounted for by changes in intermediates and labor and by the interaction between the different components of the decomposition which we capture as a residual.

Figure 17: Sources of agricultural value added growth, 2000–2014




*Notes.* The figure plots each contribution as a percent of the growth of real agricultural value added of the same year. A contribution is real agricultural value added $VA_{a,t}/P_{c,t}$ in year $t$ minus real agricultural value added with one of the following margins fixed at the value in the year 2000: *Technology adoption* fixes the level of technology, *Deforestation* fixes cleared land, *Owned plot reallocation* fixes $(l_c, l_p)$, *Intermediates and labor* fixes $(x_c, x_p, n_c, n_p)$, *Domestic prices* fixes $(P_{d,a}, P_{d,n})$, and *Exchange rate* fixes $\mathcal{H}$. An incumbent farm is defined as active in year $t$ and in 2000, and an entrant farm is defined as active in year $t$ and not in 2000. *Deforestation* is calculated separately for the two groups, where *Deforestation (entrants)* fixes $d = 0$, and *Owned land brought into production* is real agricultural value added of entrant farms with the traditional level of technology and $d = 0$ fixed. *Other* is calculated as the residual. Within a year the bands add to 100 percent of agricultural value added growth.

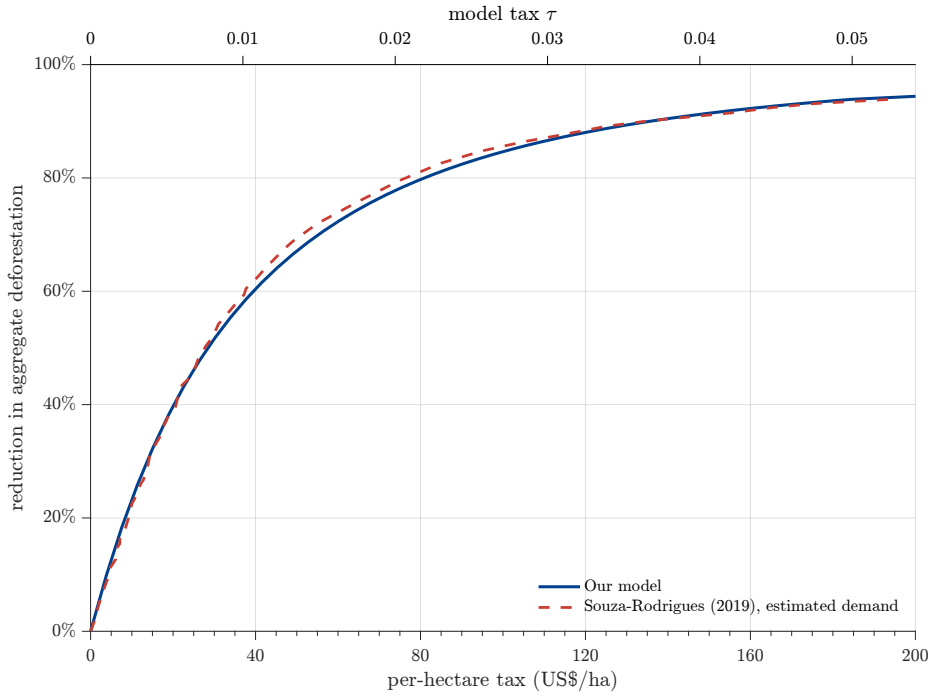
## 14 Environmental Policy & Welfare Gains from Trade

In this section, we show that an environmental policy can increase the welfare gains from trade by incentivizing farms to adopt modern technology through the reallocation into capital-intensive crops

and away from land-intensive pasture. An environmental policy raises the cost of clearing land and distorts the land expansion margin, but also encourages high-productivity pasture farms to expand crop cultivation and adopt modern technology. In general equilibrium, the shift towards modern crop production releases labor towards non-agriculture, where the marginal value of labor is higher due to differences in sectoral markups. A sufficiently strong policy can therefore increase the welfare gains from trade by reducing the misallocation of labor towards agriculture, even though the policy also restricts land expansion. In the following counterfactual exercise, we increase the environmental policy $\tau$ from zero and solve for a new general equilibrium at each level of the policy.

### 14.1 Effect of the Deforestation Tax

Figure 18: The environmental policy and the estimate of Souza-Rodrigues (2019)



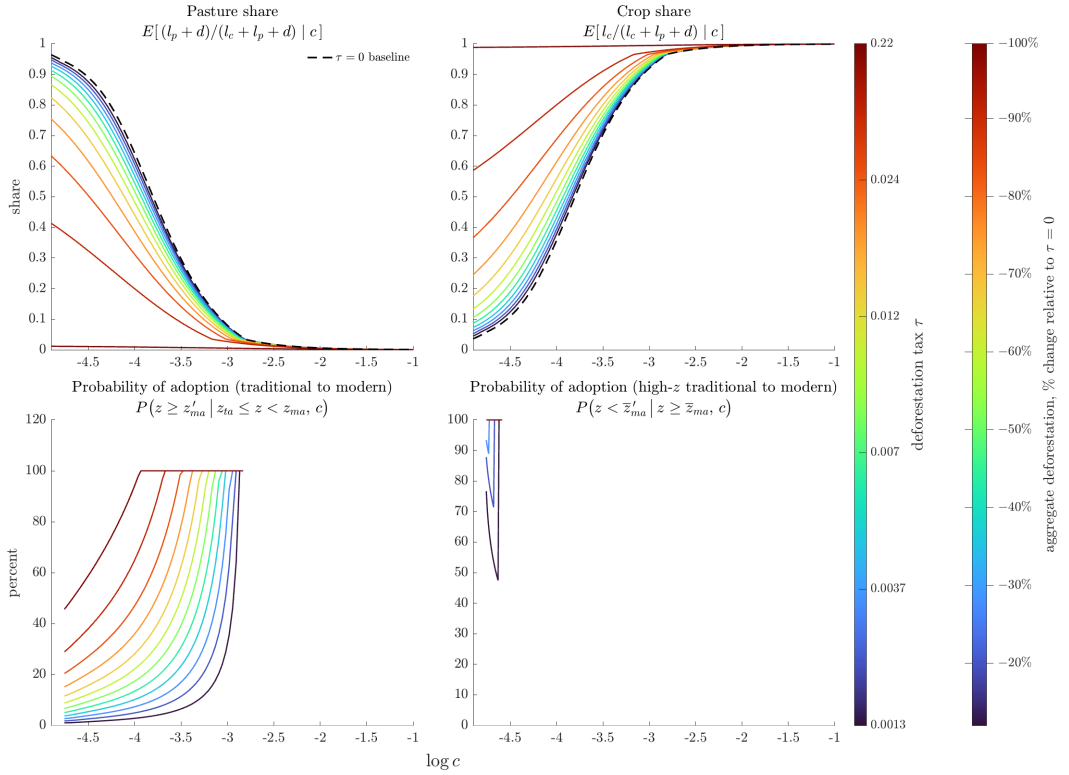

*Notes.* The solid curve is the reduction in aggregate deforestation in our calibrated model against the deforestation tax, shown in 2006 dollars on the lower axis and in the model's units $\tau$ on the upper axis. The dashed curve is the estimated demand for agricultural land from Souza-Rodrigues (2019) (Figure 4) and expressed as a reduction from its untaxed level.

We first evaluate how our deforestation tax $\tau$ affects aggregate deforestation. We use data on agricultural value added per hectare, which implies that one unit of $\tau$ is roughly US$3,700 per hectare in 2006 dollars.[28] In Figure 18 we then plot the percentage reduction in aggregate deforestation $D$ resulting from an increase in $\tau$ in our calibrated model. Our estimate aligns closely with Souza-Rodrigues

[28]We pin down a value of $\tau$ through the ratio of agricultural value added per hectare in the data to agricultural value added per hectare in the model. In the model this is sales net of intermediate inputs over the land in use, $[(p_d^c y^c + p_d^p y^p) - P_n(x_c + x_p)]/(l_c + l_p + d) = 0.0678$, aggregated across active farms. In the data it is Brazilian agricultural value added over agricultural land, about R$464 per hectare in 2003. One unit of $\tau$ is therefore worth $464/0.0678 \approx$ R$6,845 per hectare in

(2019), who finds that a perfectly enforced tax of US$42.5 per hectare raises private forest cover in the Amazon from 44 to 80 percent, a fall of roughly 64 percent in the land under agriculture. At that same tax our model eliminates 62 percent of deforestation. A tax of about US$28 per hectare lowers aggregate deforestation by half, US$136 per hectare by ninety percent, and US$490 per hectare by ninety-nine percent.

Figure 19: Farm responses to the environmental policy




*Notes.* Each panel plots the level of a conditional moment of the farm distribution as a function of the log clearing cost. Each curve corresponds to one level of the deforestation tax, and the dashed curve in the top row is the untaxed baseline. The left color bar reports the tax and the right color bar the respective reduction in aggregate deforestation. The top row shows the average pasture and crop shares of farm area. The bottom row shows, in percent, two transition probabilities: the probability that a farm traditional at $\tau = 0$ transitions to the modern technology, $P(z \geq z'_{ma} \mid z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}, c)$, and the probability that a farm above the modernization band transitions to the modern technology, $P(z < \overline{z}'_{ma} \mid z \geq \overline{z}_{ma}, c)$, where $z'_{ma}$ and $\overline{z}'_{ma}$ denote the values of the two modernization thresholds under the deforestation tax $\tau > 0$.

Next, we evaluate how the deforestation tax changes land use and the technology choice across the distribution of clearing costs in Figure 19, where we plot the average pasture and crop shares, $\mathbb{E}[(l_p + d)/(l_c + l_p + d) \mid c]$ and $\mathbb{E}[l_c/(l_c + l_p + d) \mid c]$, the probability that a traditional farm in the baseline economy with $\tau = 0$ transitions to the modern technology, $P(z \geq z'_{ma} \mid z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}, c)$

2003 reais, which we restate in 2006 reais with the Brazilian consumer price index and convert at the 2006 exchange rate to about US$3,700 per hectare. Data on value added comes from the IBGE Contas Regionais, SIDRA table 5938 and land from MapBiomas Brazil Collection 10.

after being taxed $\tau > 0$, and equivalently, the probability that a farm above the modernization band at baseline, $z \geq \overline{z}_{ma}$, transitions to the modern technology, $P(z < \overline{z}'_{ma} \mid z \geq \overline{z}_{ma}, c)$ after the tax, where $z'_{ma}$ and $\overline{z}'_{ma}$ denote the modernization thresholds under the deforestation tax. Each curve is drawn at a given tax $\tau$ and the dashed curve in the upper panels is the untaxed baseline.

The tax raises the cost of clearing forest and reshapes land use and technology choices for farms with a low clearing cost. The deforestation tax effectively taxes pasture expansion such that owned land reallocates into crop cultivation. Under a perfectly enforced no-deforestation policy, the pasture share falls to nearly zero at every clearing cost. A farm with a high clearing cost already allocates almost all owned land to crop cultivation and thus does not respond to the tax. Since the returns to modernizing accrue to crops, the tax then pushes traditional farms across the adoption threshold such that the probability of switching from the traditional to the modern technology (i.e., $P(z \geq z'_{ma} \mid z_{ta} \leq z < z_{ma}, c)$) rises. Equivalently, the deforestation tax causes a rise in $\overline{z}'_{ma}(c)$, such that even the highly productive (high $z$) pasture farms that draw the lowest clearing costs optimally start to modernize.

Note that the responses are not proportional. A tax large enough to remove 90 percent of aggregate deforestation still leaves a farm with the lowest clearing cost draw allocating almost half of farm area in pasture, with a probability of switching from traditional to modern of only one third. The largest changes in land use and technology arrive with the final tenth of forest saved, which pushes the pasture share on the cheapest land from almost one half to essentially zero and raises the probability of adoption on the cheapest land to one half.

**The Gains from Trade**

We define the welfare gains from agricultural trade, $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$, as the response of aggregate consumption to foreign demand, evaluated at tax $\tau$:

$$\mathcal{G}(\tau) = \left. \frac{\Delta \ln C}{\Delta \ln \mathcal{D}_a^*} \right|_\tau \tag{45}$$

In other words, we compute $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ by doubling $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ at each level of the tax and solving for the new equilibrium. $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ then captures the welfare improvement when foreign demand for agricultural goods rises, accounting for adjustments of labor, prices, entry, technology, and land use. In Figure 20 we plot the change relative to the untaxed baseline economy where $\tau = 0$, given by $\left[\mathcal{G}(\tau)/\mathcal{G}(0) - 1\right]$, against the reduction in aggregate deforestation $D$ generated by $\tau$.

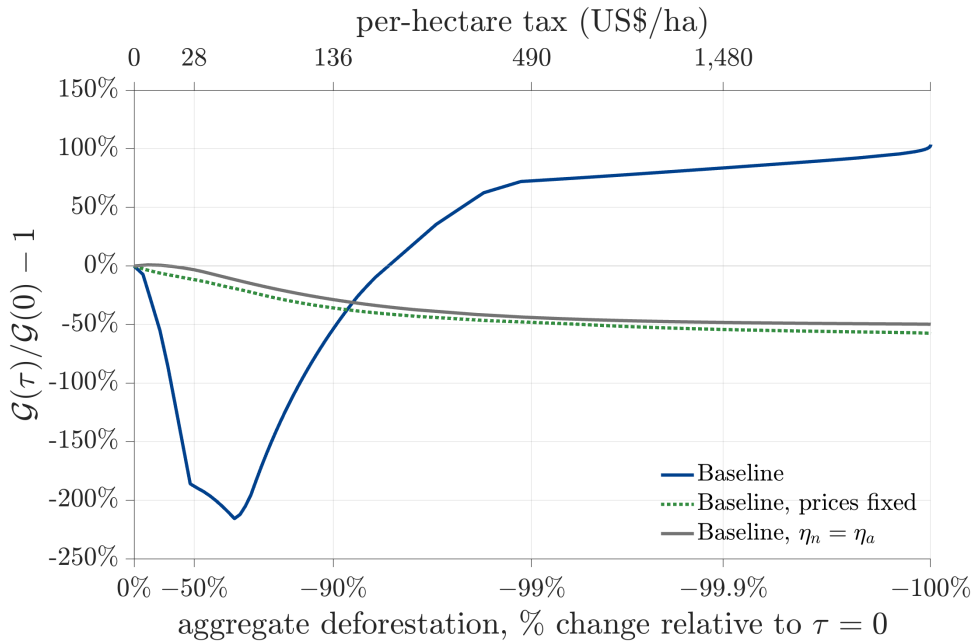
In Figure 20 we show that a perfectly enforced no-deforestation tax of around US$700 per hectare increases the welfare gains from trade by more than 75 percent. Importantly, welfare gains from trade only materialize for a sufficiently strong tax above US$200 per hectare which reduces deforestation by more than 90%. Below a roughly 90% reduction in deforestation, the tax merely distorts land allocation such that the welfare gains from trade fall.

However, once the tax is sufficiently strong to incentivize farms to move into modern crop cultivation and upgrade their technology from $A_t$ to $A_m$, labor moves to the non-agricultural sector where the marginal value of labor is higher. Note that in our model labor is inherently misallocated towards agriculture due to markup distortions, so moving labor towards its more productive use generates a

welfare gain. Here $\eta_a > \eta_n$, such that the markup, and hence the marginal value of labor, is higher in non-agriculture. Aligned with much of the development literature, our calibration also implies that moving from traditional production to modern input-intensive crop cultivation is labor saving (note that the labor elasticity is $1 - \nu_c - \gamma_c = 0.06$ in crop production, compared with $1 - \nu_p - \gamma_p = 0.30$ in pasture production, which means that reallocating land away from pasture is labor-sparing). In other words, farmers do not internalize that the labor they demand would be more productive outside agriculture, which means that a tax that incentivizes labor-saving modernization can increase the welfare gains from trade, even though the tax also distorts farmers' land allocation.

To illustrate this, in Figure 20 we also plot the change in the welfare gains from trade under two counterfactual economies where (i) prices are fixed and (ii) there is no differential in the marginal value of labor, such that $\eta_a = \eta_n$. In both cases, the welfare gains from trade decline relative to the respective untaxed baseline at every positive tax shown.

Figure 20: Environmental policy and the gains from trade



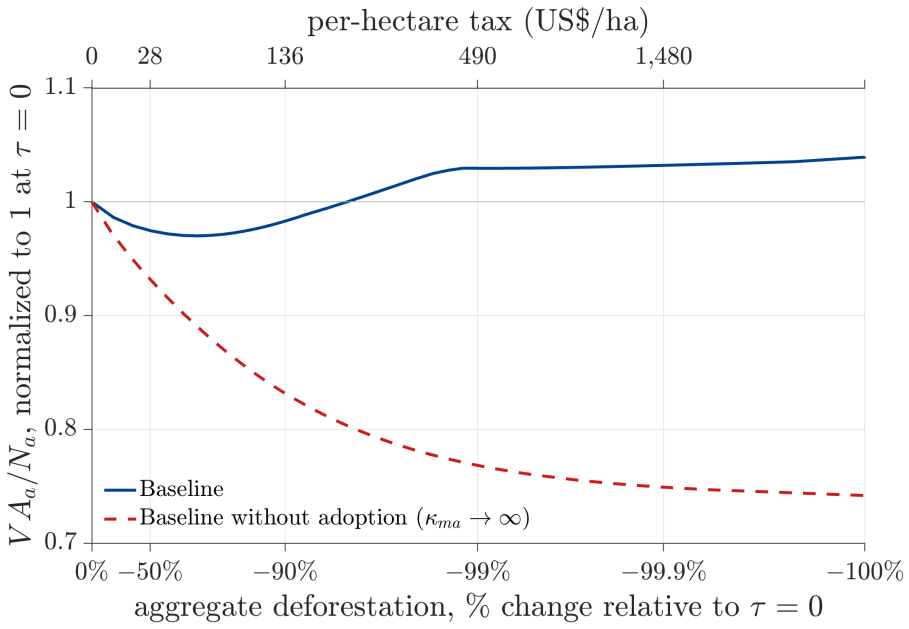

*Notes.* The vertical axis shows the change in the gains from trade $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ relative to the untaxed baseline, where $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ is defined in equation (45) and computed by doubling $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ at every level of $\tau$. The lower horizontal axis converts each tax into the change in aggregate deforestation on a logarithmic scale, and the upper horizontal axis reports the corresponding per-hectare tax in 2006 US dollars. We compare the calibrated economy with two counterfactual scenarios: (i) partial equilibrium with prices $\{P_{d,a}, P_{d,n}, \mathcal{H}, P_a, P_n, P_c\}$ fixed at the untaxed equilibrium and (ii) an economy without differences in the marginal value of labor, where $\eta_n = \eta_a = 4.1$.

The reduction in labor misallocation induced by a sufficiently strong deforestation tax is also reflected in an increase in agricultural labor productivity. In Figure 21, we plot the change in agricultural value added per worker relative to the untaxed baseline, along with a counterfactual where the fixed cost of technology adoption $\kappa_{ma}$ is prohibitively high.

Under a moderate tax, restricting land expansion lowers agricultural labor productivity. However, once the tax is sufficiently strong, farmers expand crop cultivation and adopt modern technology, such that agricultural production becomes less labor-intensive and labor moves towards non-agriculture. Agricultural labor productivity consequently rises above the untaxed baseline. In a counterfactual economy without adoption, the tax restricts land expansion but cannot induce the same shift towards modern, labor-saving production and reduce misallocation. Agricultural labor productivity therefore falls below the untaxed baseline at every tax level.

At a tax of around US$700 per hectare, agricultural labor productivity rises by around 3 percent, compared with a decline of about a quarter in the counterfactual without allowing adoption. In other words, the comparison shows why technology adoption matters for the welfare effects of forest protection: adoption allows the tax to encourage labor-saving agricultural production and support the reallocation of labor towards its more productive use outside agriculture.

Figure 21: Environmental policy and agricultural labor productivity




*Notes.* The vertical axis reports agricultural labor productivity $VA_a/N_a$, normalized to one in the untaxed equilibrium of each economy, where $VA_a$ is agricultural value added $P_{d,a}Y_a - P_nX_a$ and $N_a$ is agricultural employment including the labor used for entry. The lower horizontal axis reports the reduction in aggregate deforestation, and the upper axis reports the tax per hectare in 2006 US dollars. The figure compares our baseline calibrated economy with a counterfactual in which the fixed adoption cost is prohibitively high ($\kappa_{ma} \to \infty$), such that all farms remain traditional.

Our findings connect forest protection to the role of agricultural modernization for economic development and structural transformation. Increases in agricultural productivity allow labor to move into other sectors of the economy (Johnston & Mellor 1961, Gollin et al. 2002). In our setting, access to uncultivated land discourages modernization by allowing farmers to meet higher foreign demand through pasture expansion, reinforcing the misallocation of labor towards agriculture. The availability

of additional land therefore affects development through both the incentives to adopt technology and the allocation of labor across sectors. A sufficiently strong deforestation tax changes those incentives and encourages modern crop cultivation, releasing labor towards non-agriculture where its marginal value is higher. Forest protection can consequently increase the welfare gains from agricultural trade even without accounting for the environmental benefits of conservation.

## 15 Conclusion

In this paper, we ask how agricultural trade shapes farmers' decisions over technology adoption and land use. We combine confidential records on the near universe of cross-bank electronic transfers with geo-referenced farm boundaries and satellite imagery, which allows us to observe both land use changes and input purchases at the farm level during the commodity boom in Brazil. Using a shift-share shock based on destination-country import demand, we find that farmers in the Amazon meet higher foreign demand by reallocating land from capital-intensive soybean toward land-intensive pasture. The reallocation shrinks the area under modern cultivation, such that spending on machinery and technology falls and forest is cleared to make room for additional pasture. Outside the Legal Amazon, we find that exporters pass through significantly less foreign demand to farmers, and we consequently find limited changes in land allocation or technology spending. In a complementary difference-in-differences design, we then show that access to rural credit pushes farmers in the opposite direction, raising spending on modern inputs and shifting land out of pasture and into soybean, encouraging modernization.

We show that our empirical observations emerge naturally from the asymmetric use of land and technology across agricultural activities. In a simple parsimonious model, we assume that crops and pasture differ in their underlying use of technology and land such that the returns to adopting modern technology accrue solely to crop cultivation, while only pasture can replace forest, as freshly deforested land is largely unsuitable for immediate crop cultivation. Land is also inherently heterogeneous in our framework, as a farmer cannot substitute freely between the established owned plot and newly deforested pasture. Cleared forest therefore substitutes only in part for owned pasture, such that an additional deforested hectare raises the value of the owned pasture operated alongside the newly cleared land. Owned pasture in turn competes with land dedicated to crops. A farmer who deforests consequently specializes into pasture, and for a sufficiently low clearing cost, the crop operation remains too small to justify technology investments.

We embed this mechanism into a general equilibrium model in which every farmer draws a productivity and a cost of converting forest into pasture. The clearing cost draw captures variation in land scarcity and property rights, and allows us to abstract from explicit spatial units. In equilibrium, even highly productive farmers may optimally forgo modern technology and expand pasture, in line with what we observe in the data. We calibrate the model to Brazilian data from 2003, drawing on granular microdata, aggregate statistics, and our own empirical estimates. The calibrated model rationalizes our empirical findings on land allocation and technology spending and reproduces untargeted differences in land use, farm scale, and modernization between the Legal Amazon and

the rest of Brazil. We then decompose agricultural value added growth during the commodity boom. Changes in land use accounted for around 56 percent of growth, with deforestation alone accounting for around 43 percent, while technology adoption contributed less than 10 percent.

In a counterfactual exercise, we show that a sufficiently strong deforestation tax can increase the welfare gains from agricultural trade without assuming carbon externalities, biodiversity losses, or climatic changes that affect firm productivity or household utility. In our calibrated model, differences in sectoral markups distort the allocation of labor towards agriculture, where the marginal value of labor is lower than in non-agriculture. A deforestation tax distorts the land expansion margin but also incentivizes farmers to reallocate owned land from pasture toward crops, raising the return on technology investments. A sufficiently strong tax encourages high-productivity pasture farms to adopt modern, labor-sparing crop technology, allowing labor to move towards its more productive use outside agriculture. Welfare gains from reducing labor misallocation can then outweigh the losses from restricting land expansion. Our calibrated model suggests that a perfectly enforced no-deforestation tax of around US$700 per hectare raises the welfare gains from trade by more than 75 percent. Raising the welfare gains from trade above the untaxed baseline requires a tax exceeding approximately US$200 per hectare, enough to reduce aggregate deforestation by more than 90 percent.

# A Appendix: Shift-Share Diagnostics

This appendix reports diagnostics for the shift-share instrument constructed in Section 5, following the framework of Borusyak et al. (2025).

Table A.1 summarizes the properties of the demand shock for the combined instrument as well as for the separate beef and soy instruments. The combined instrument draws on 143 destination countries. The effective number of independent demand shocks, computed as the inverse Herfindahl index of the importance weights $(\sum_c S_c^2)^{-1}$, is 8.79, indicating that the identifying variation is not driven by a single destination. The largest importance weight falls on China at 29.1%, reflecting its dominant role in global demand for both beef and soybeans. The next four destinations by importance weight are Russia (8.5%), Hong Kong (7.7%), Iran (7.0%), and the Netherlands (5.7%). For the separate instruments, the effective number of shocks is 8.66 for beef and 4.37 for soy. The soy instrument is more concentrated, with China alone accounting for 45.8% of the importance weight, reflecting the outsized role of Chinese soybean imports during the sample period.

The concentration of importance weights on China raises the question of whether our results are driven by a single demand shifter. We address this concern directly through the leave-one-destination-out exercise reported in Appendix E, which shows that dropping China (or any other top-5 destination) and reweighting the remaining shares does not materially change our estimates. The identifying variation in Chinese demand for beef and soybeans is plausibly driven by structural income growth and dietary transition rather than by conditions in Brazilian agriculture, supporting the exogeneity of this dominant shift.

Table A.1: Shift-Share Diagnostics

| | **Combined** | **Beef** | **Soy** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Number of destination countries ($C$) | 143 | 129 | 76 |
| Effective number of shifts, $(\sum S_c^2)^{-1}$ | 8.79 | 8.66 | 4.37 |
| Largest importance weight ($S_c$) | 0.291 | 0.204 | 0.458 |
| $\Delta z_{it}$ Mean | $-0.016$ | 0.004 | $-0.005$ |
| $\Delta z_{it}$ Std. Dev. | 0.422 | 0.253 | 0.337 |
| $\Delta \ln g_{ct}^k$ Mean (weighted by $S_c$) | 0.102 | $-0.006$ | 0.065 |
| $\Delta \ln g_{ct}^k$ Std. Dev. (weighted by $S_c$) | 0.483 | 0.861 | 0.503 |
| Observations | 283,356 | 123,867 | 170,328 |
| Unique farmers | 108,942 | 44,660 | 64,051 |
| *Top 5 Destinations (by $S_c$)* | | | |
| 1 | China (29.1%) | Hong Kong (20.4%) | China (45.8%) |
| 2 | Russia (8.5%) | Russia (19.6%) | Netherlands (8.1%) |
| 3 | Hong Kong (7.7%) | Iran (13.7%) | France (5.1%) |
| 4 | Iran (7.0%) | Egypt (10.0%) | Thailand (5.0%) |
| 5 | Netherlands (5.7%) | Venezuela (3.3%) | Spain (4.1%) |

*Notes:* The table reports shift-share diagnostics following Borusyak et al. (2025). Importance weights $S_c$ measure the contribution of each destination to the overall variance of the instrument, computed as the weighted average of farmer-level exposure to each destination. The effective number of shifts is the inverse Herfindahl index of these weights. The combined instrument pools beef and soy as described in equation (9). The separate beef and soy instruments use product-specific shares $s_{ic}^k$. Sample restricted to the regression sample (non-missing leads, lags, and controls).

Table A.2 reports the distribution of initial years $t_0$ at which farmer-exporter weights $w_{ix}$ are fixed. About a quarter of farmers enter the sample in 2010, with the remainder distributed across subsequent years. Table A.3 reports the corresponding distribution of $t_0'$ for exporter-destination shares $s_{xc}^k$. For beef, 97 out of 418 exporter-destination pairs (23%) have their shares fixed in 2010, with the rest spread across later years. For soy, the distribution is more uniform, with 261 out of 1,153 pairs (23%) fixed in 2010. We verify in Appendix E that restricting the sample to farmers entering in 2010 does not change our results.

Table A.2: Distribution of Initial Years: Farmer-Exporter Weights ($w_{ix}$)

| Year | Farmers | Percent | Cumulative |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2010 | 33,110 | 25.8 | 25.8 |
| 2011 | 11,805 | 9.2 | 35.0 |
| 2012 | 10,372 | 8.1 | 43.1 |
| 2013 | 9,528 | 7.4 | 50.5 |
| 2014 | 9,122 | 7.1 | 57.6 |
| 2015 | 8,318 | 6.5 | 64.1 |
| 2016 | 8,666 | 6.8 | 70.9 |
| 2017 | 9,792 | 7.6 | 78.5 |
| 2018 | 6,076 | 4.7 | 83.3 |
| 2019 | 12,313 | 9.6 | 92.9 |
| 2020 | 9,170 | 7.2 | 100.0 |
| Total | 128,272 | 100.0 | |

*Notes:* The table reports the distribution of the initial year $t_0$ at which each farmer's exporter weights $w_{ix}$ are fixed. $t_0$ is defined as the first year farmer $i$ appears in the payment data.

Table A.3: Distribution of Initial Years: Exporter-Destination Shares ($s_{xc}^k$)

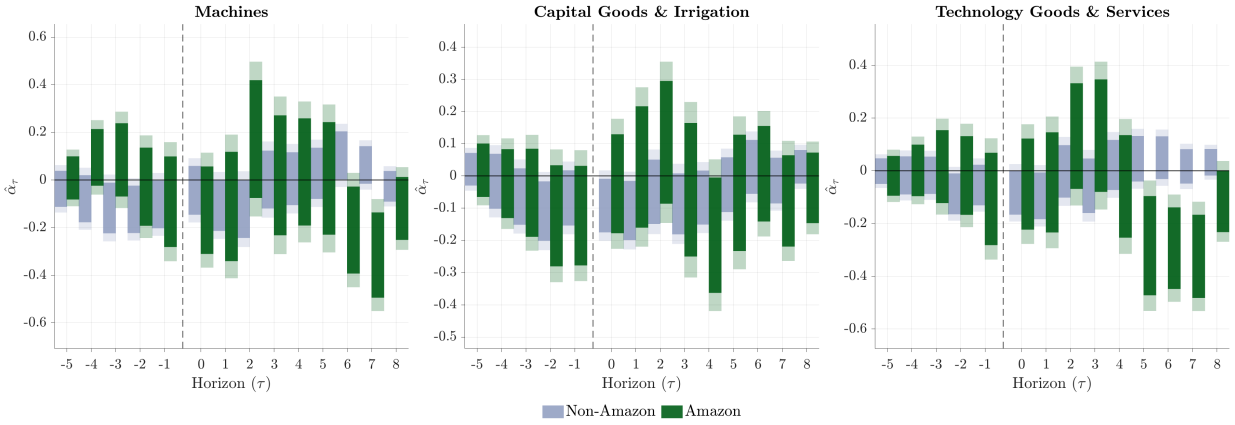
| | **Beef** | | **Soy** | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Year | Exporters | Percent | Exporters | Percent |
| 2010 | 97 | 23.2 | 261 | 22.6 |
| 2011 | 38 | 9.1 | 127 | 11.0 |
| 2012 | 29 | 6.9 | 93 | 8.1 |
| 2013 | 24 | 5.7 | 115 | 10.0 |
| 2014 | 18 | 4.3 | 92 | 8.0 |
| 2015 | 31 | 7.4 | 98 | 8.5 |
| 2016 | 23 | 5.5 | 75 | 6.5 |
| 2017 | 40 | 9.6 | 94 | 8.2 |
| 2018 | | | 54 | 4.7 |
| 2019 | 74 | 17.7 | 77 | 6.7 |
| 2020 | 44 | 10.5 | 67 | 5.8 |
| Total | 418 | 100.0 | 1,153 | 100.0 |

*Notes:* The table reports the distribution of the initial year $t_0'$ at which each exporter's destination shares $s_{xc}^k$ are fixed, separately for beef and soy. $t_0'$ is defined as the first year the exporter appears in the TRASE data. Beef data excludes 2018 (not available in TRASE).

## B Appendix: Alternative Outcome Transformations

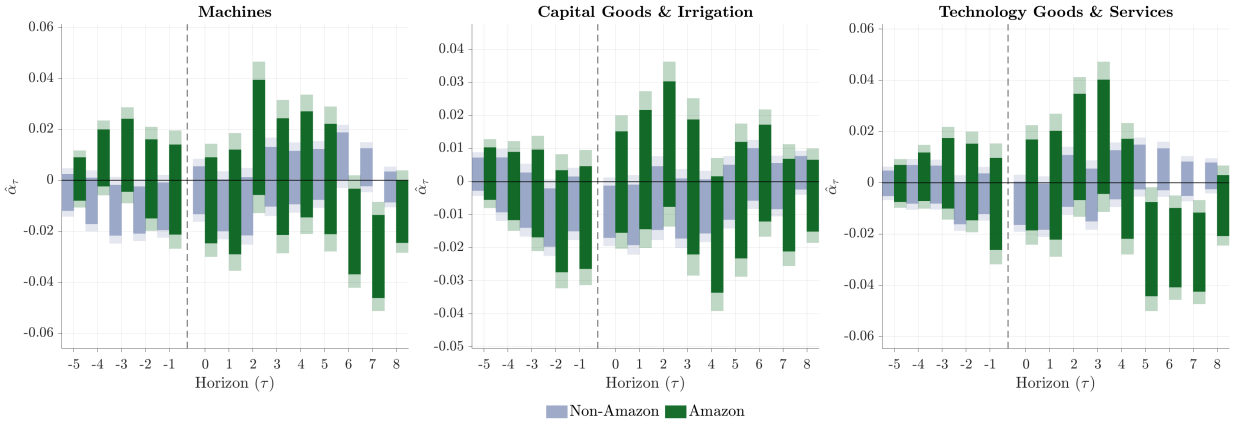
The main text reports spending outcomes using $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ as the baseline transformation. This appendix verifies that our spending results are robust to alternative approaches to handling the mass of zeros in farm-level investment. Figure B.1 reports event study estimates using the inverse hyperbolic sine transformation $\ln(Y_{it} + \sqrt{Y_{it}^2 + 1})$, which has similar properties to $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ but is exactly invariant to the units of measurement (Burbidge et al. 1988). Figure B.2 uses an extensive margin dummy $\mathbb{1}[Y_{it} > 0]$, which isolates the effect of the demand shock on the probability that a farmer makes any purchase in a given category, abstracting from the intensive margin. Figure B.3 uses $\log(1 + N_{it})$ where $N_{it}$ is the number of distinct suppliers in each category, measuring changes in the breadth of the sourcing base rather than the value of payments. In all cases, we estimate equation (10) with the same controls and sample splits as in the baseline.

Figure B.1: Inverse Hyperbolic Sine Transformation



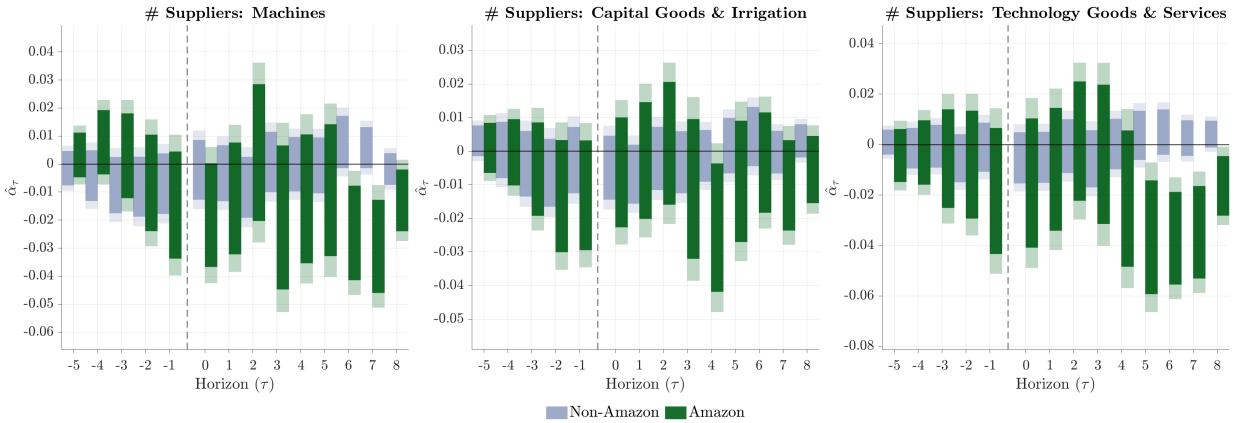

*Notes:* Each panel plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is the inverse hyperbolic sine $\ln(Y_{it} + \sqrt{Y_{it}^2 + 1})$ of total annual spending in each category. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

Figure B.2: Extensive Margin Dummies




*Notes:* Each panel plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is an extensive margin dummy $\mathbb{1}[Y_{it} > 0]$, isolating the effect on the probability that a farmer makes any purchase in a given category. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

Figure B.3: Supplier Counts

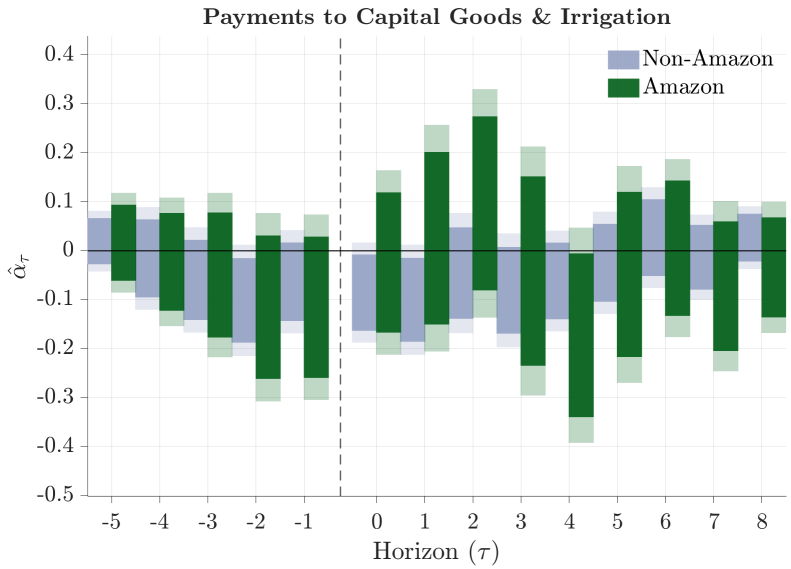



*Notes:* Each panel plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is $\log(1 + N_{it})$ where $N_{it}$ is the number of suppliers in each category, measuring changes in the breadth of the sourcing base. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

# C Appendix: Capital Goods & Irrigation

The main text reports baseline spending results for Machines and Technology Goods & Services. Figure C.1 reports the corresponding event study for Capital Goods & Irrigation, the third spending category described in Section 5. The specification is identical to that in Figure 6.

Figure C.1: Agricultural Export Demand and Capital Goods & Irrigation Spending




*Notes:* The figure plots the estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The outcome is $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ where $Y_{it}$ is total annual spending on suppliers classified under Capital Goods & Irrigation (see Appendix Table E.1). Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level.

## D Appendix: Separate Beef and Soy Shocks

The baseline specification in Section 5 pools beef and soy into a single demand shock $\Delta z_{it}$. This appendix decomposes the instrument into separate product-specific shocks to verify that both commodities contribute to the patterns documented in the main text. For each product $k \in \{\text{beef}, \text{soy}\}$, we construct the product-specific shock

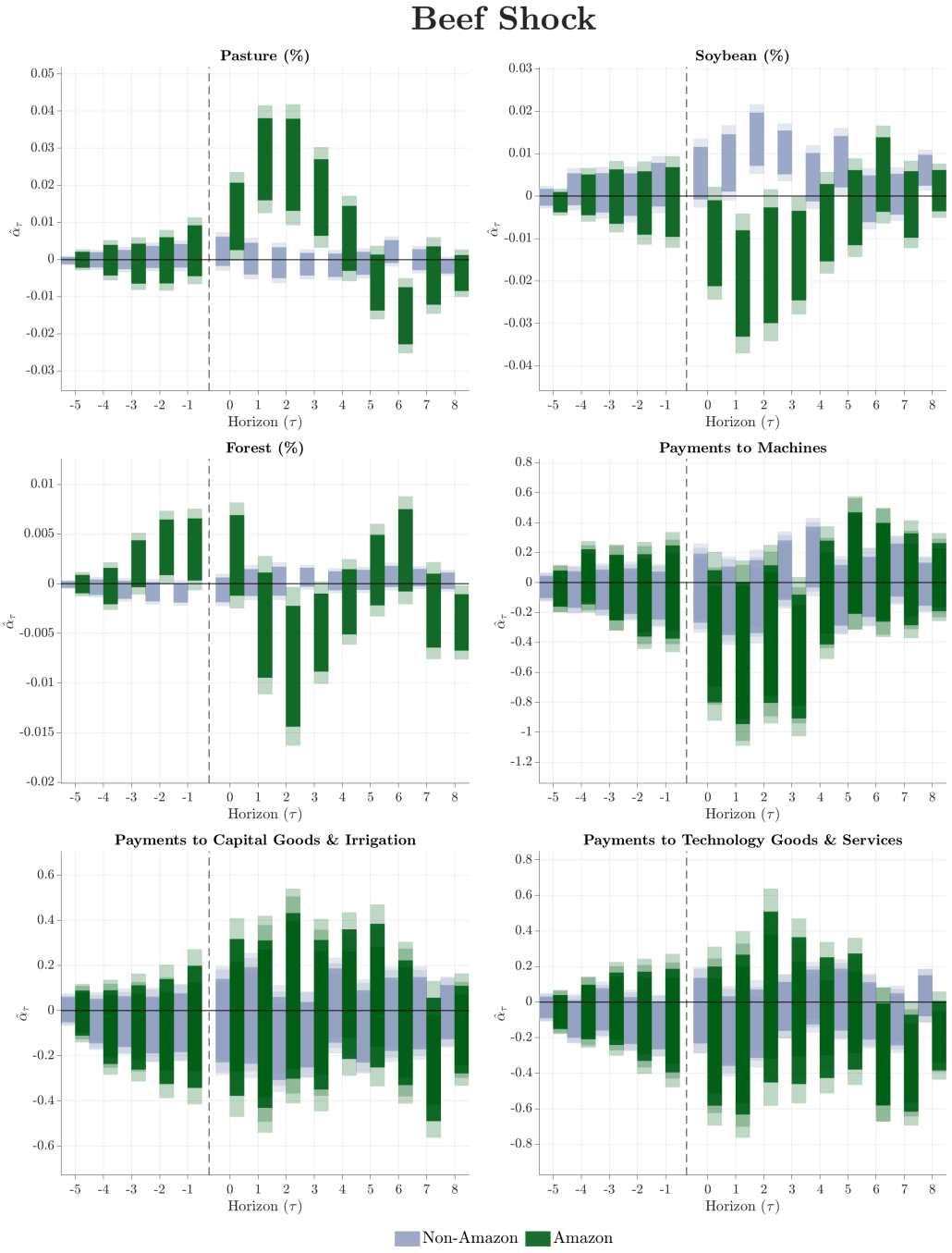
$$\Delta z_{it}^k = \sum_c s_{ic}^k \cdot \Delta \ln g_{ct}^k \tag{46}$$

where the farmer-destination shares $s_{ic}^k$ are the same as those used in the baseline (equation (8)), but now each product enters as a separate regressor rather than being summed. We estimate equation (10) replacing $\Delta z_{it}$ with $\Delta z_{it}^k$ and restricting the sample to farmers linked to at least one exporter of product $k$. The absorbed controls include farmer and year fixed effects, the sum of product-specific shares $\bar{s}_i^k = \sum_c s_{ic}^k$ interacted with year fixed effects (to control for incomplete shares), and municipality-level log land-use controls for land-use outcomes.[29]

Figures D.1 and D.2 report the results. The beef shock generates a pattern consistent with the baseline, with pasture expansion, soybean contraction, and spending declines concentrated in the Amazon. The soy shock generates qualitatively similar effects, confirming that our baseline findings are not driven by the composition of the pooled instrument.

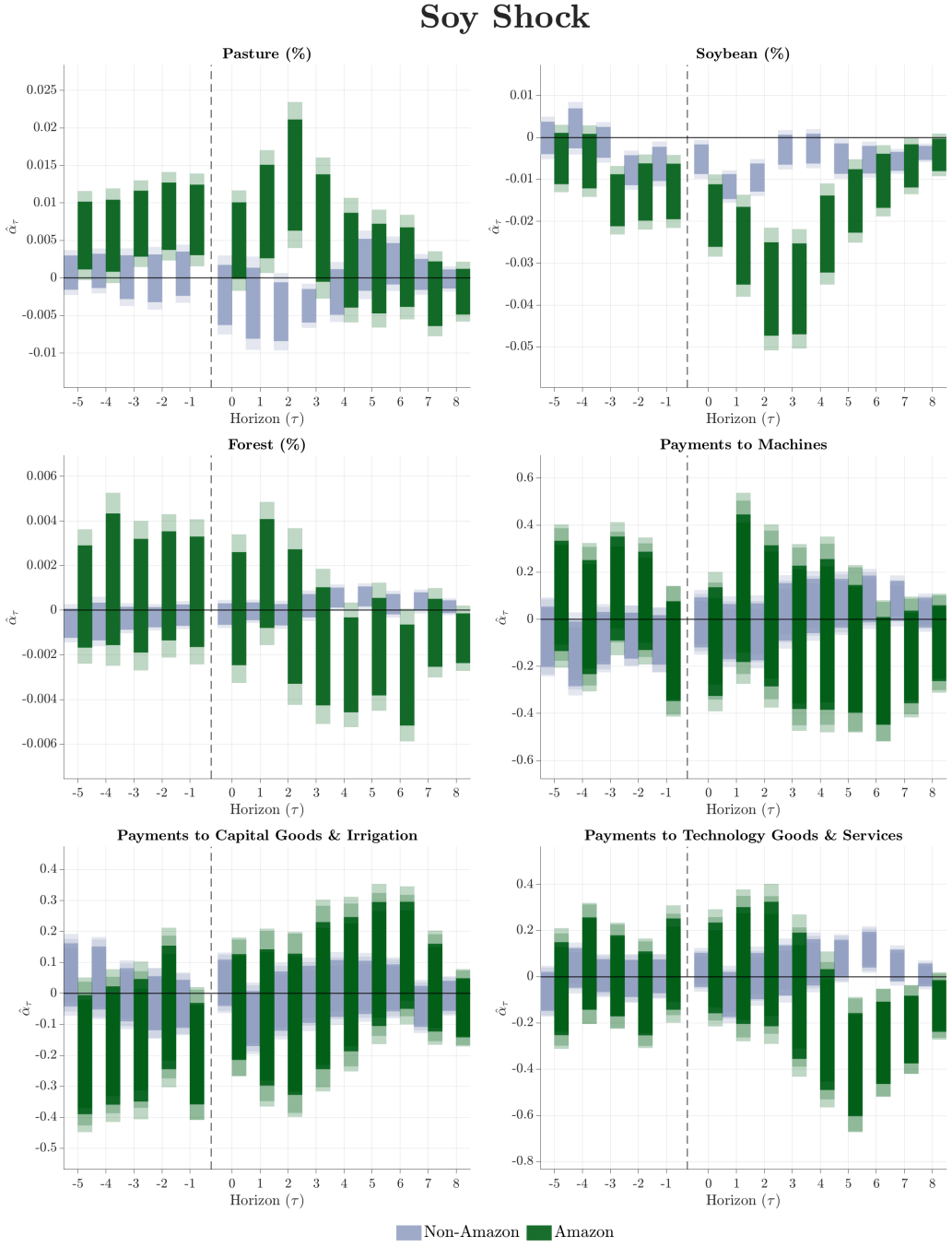
[29] Municipality-level controls are the log of total municipal area under forest, pasture, and soybean. These absorb local trends in land use that may be correlated with the product-specific shock. We also estimate variants with and without initial product-specific land shares interacted with year fixed effects (pasture share at $t_0$ for beef, soybean share at $t_0$ for soy).

Figure D.1: Separate Beef Shock




*Notes:* The figure plots the estimated coefficients from the separate beef shock specification for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The sample is restricted to farmers linked to at least one beef exporter. Panels report effects on land-use shares (pasture, soybean, forest) and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending outcomes (machines, capital goods, technology). Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level. Controls include municipality-level log land use for land-use outcomes.

Figure D.2: Separate Soy Shock



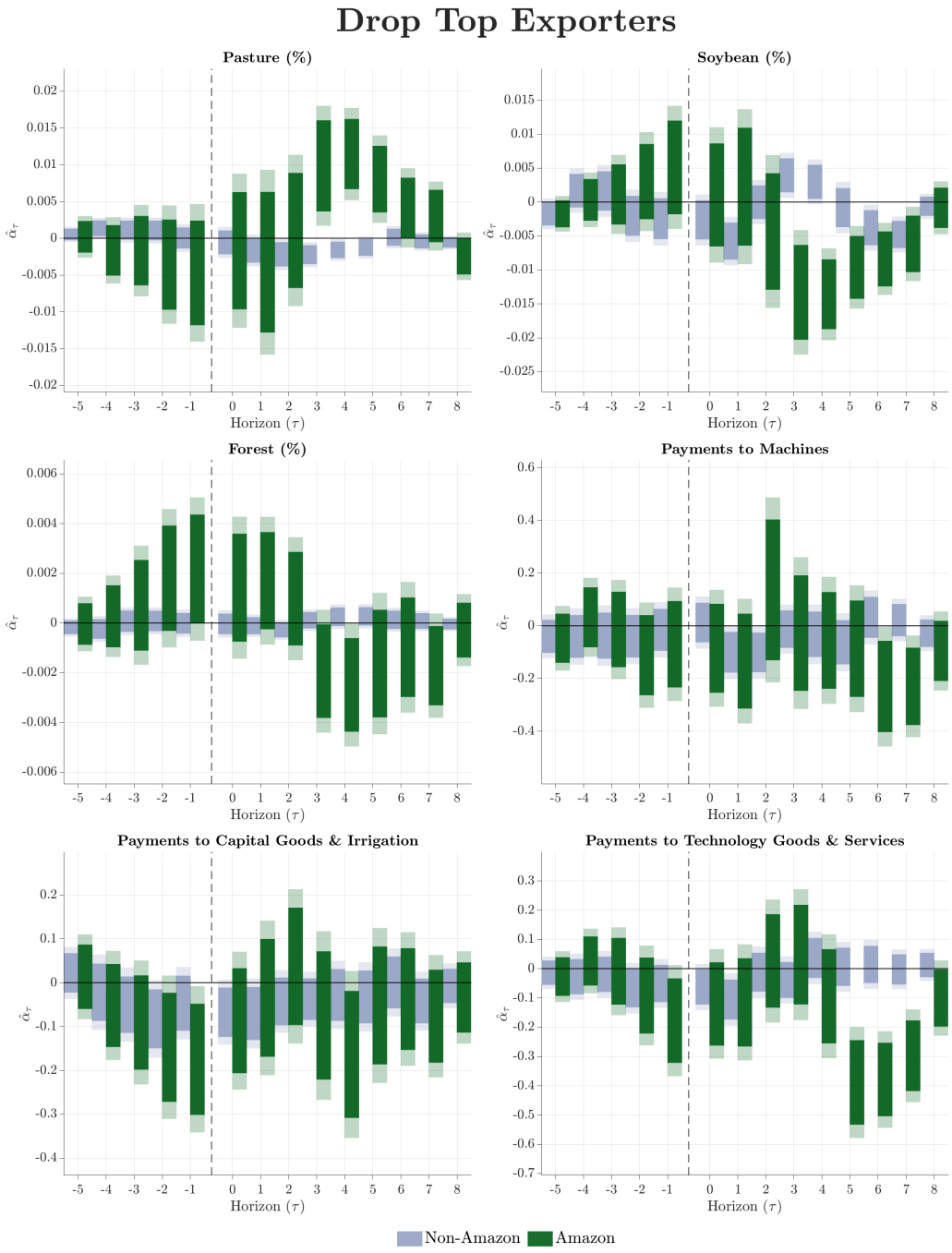

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients from the separate soy shock specification for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, separately for farmers in the Legal Amazon (green) and outside it (blue). The sample is restricted to farmers linked to at least one soy exporter. Panels report effects on land-use shares (pasture, soybean, forest) and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending outcomes (machines, capital goods, technology). Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals and shaded areas denote 99% confidence intervals, based on standard errors clustered at the farmer level. Controls include municipality-level log land use for land-use outcomes.

## E Appendix: Sample and Specification Robustness

This appendix examines the robustness of our baseline results to a range of sample restrictions, alternative specifications, and instrument modifications. In each exercise, we re-estimate equation (10) and report event study coefficients for the six main outcomes (pasture share, soybean share, forest share, machines, capital goods, and technology spending), separately for the Amazon and non-Amazon subsamples. Each figure replicates Figure 6 under the modified specification.

**Dropping Top Exporters.** We drop the three largest exporters by average yearly FOB value and recompute farmer-exporter weights $w_{ix}$ and the demand shock $\Delta z_{it}$ from scratch using the remaining exporters. This exercise tests whether our results are sensitive to the concentration of the export sector in a small number of firms such as JBS, Cargill, and Bunge. Figure E.1 reports the results.

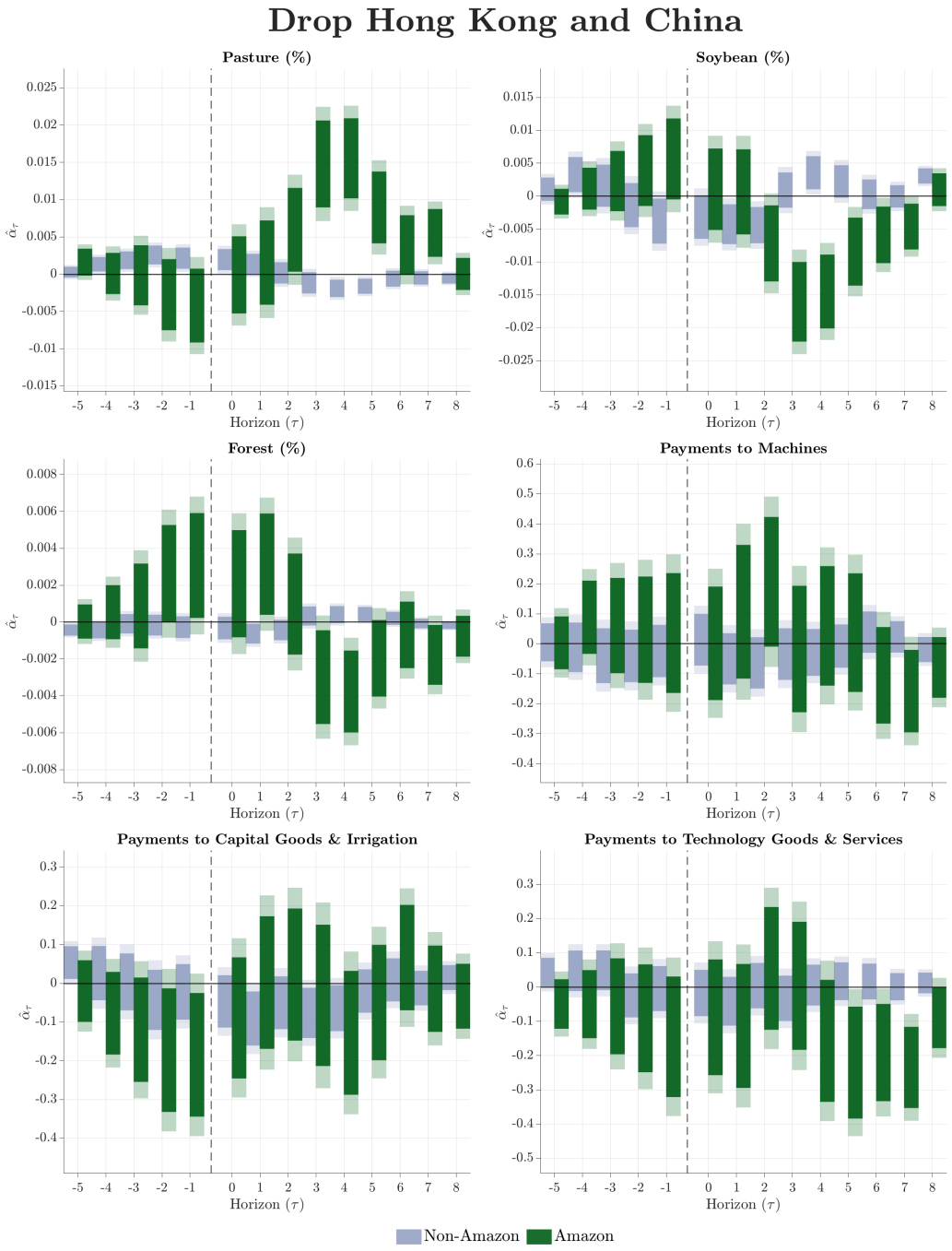
Figure E.1: Robustness: Dropping Top 3 Exporters




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping the three largest exporters by average yearly FOB and recomputing farmer-exporter weights and demand shocks from scratch. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Dropping Key Destinations.** We drop Hong Kong from beef destinations and China from soy destinations, then jointly reweight the remaining shares $s_{ic}^k$ across both products so that $\sum_{k,c} s_{ic}^k = 1$ for each farmer. Because shares sum to one after reweighting, the incomplete share control $\bar{s}_i \times \delta_t$ is absorbed by the year fixed effects and is dropped from the specification. Figure E.2 reports the results.

Figure E.2: Robustness: Dropping Key Destinations

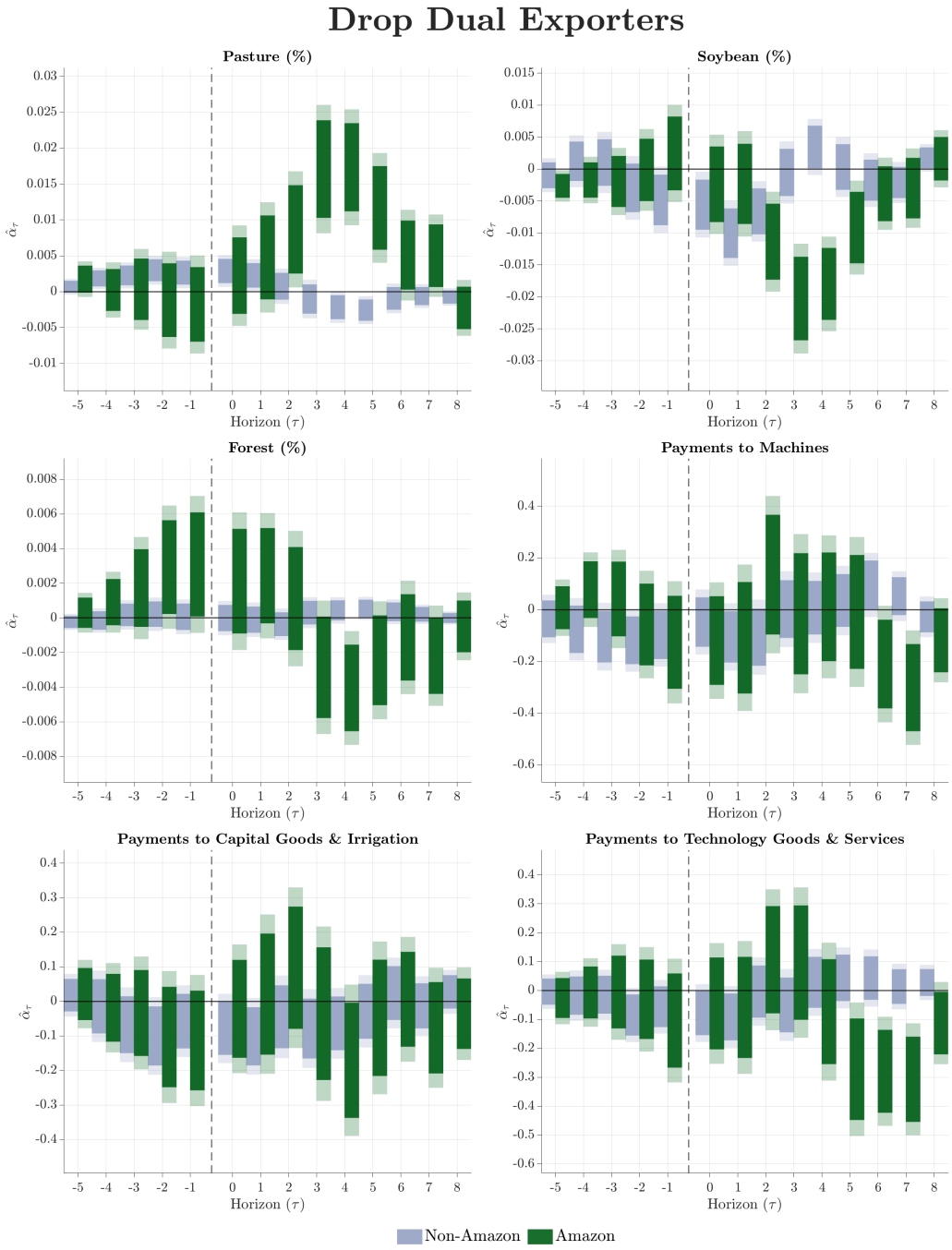



*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping Hong Kong from beef and China from soy destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Dropping Dual Exporters.** We remove all farmers connected to exporters that handle both beef and soy in any given year, recompute farmer-exporter weights $w_{ix}$ from scratch using the remaining exporters, and jointly reweight destination shares so that $\sum_{k,c} s_{ic}^k = 1$. The incomplete share control is dropped after reweighting. In our sample, only 35 out of 4,066 exporter-year observations involve

dual-commodity exporters (23 unique firms out of 1,325), so this restriction results in a modest sample reduction of 3.9 percent on the beef side and 1.9 percent on the soy side. Figure E.3 reports the results.

Figure E.3: Robustness: Dropping Dual Exporters

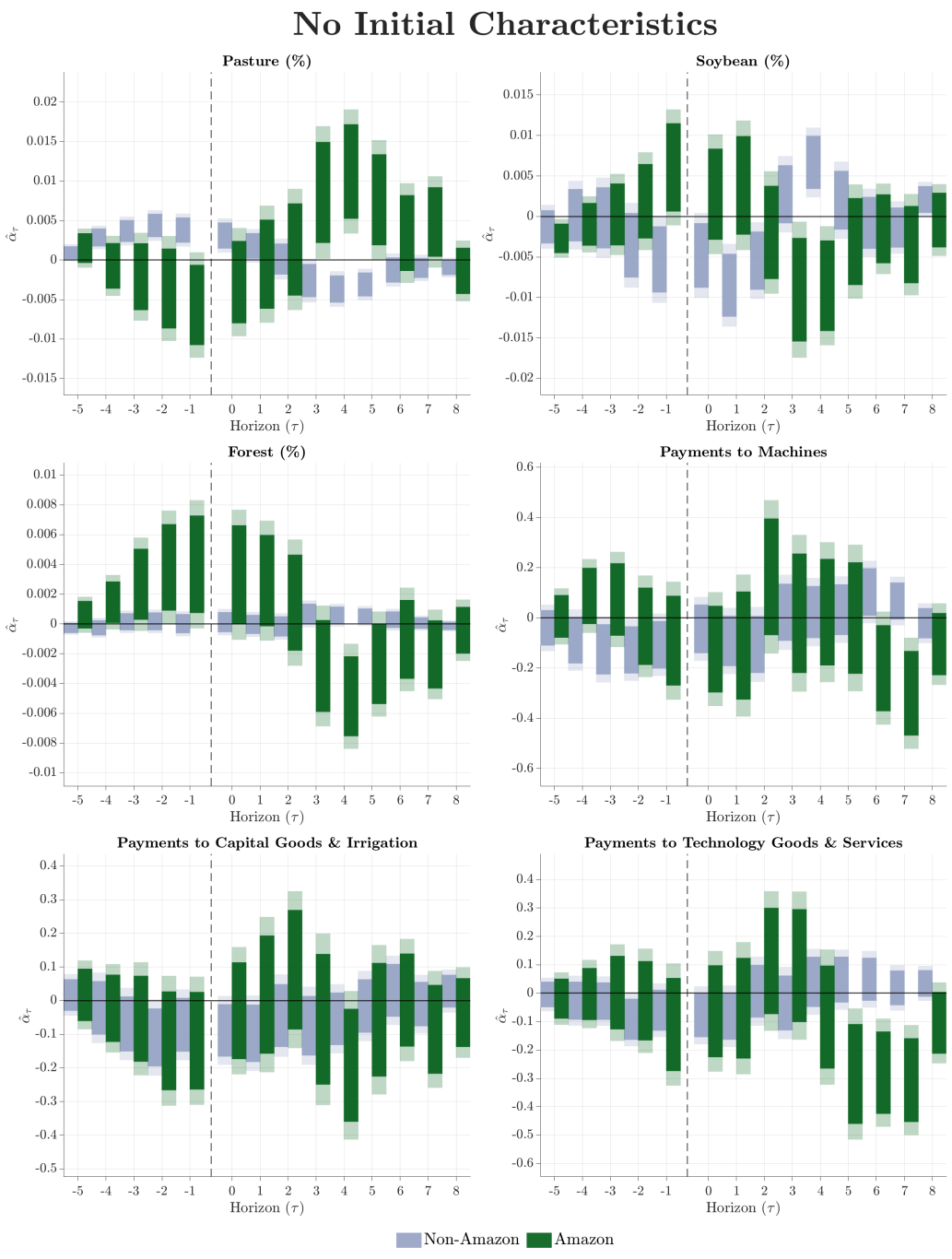



*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after removing farmers connected to exporters that handle both beef and soy in any given year. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Alternative Initial Characteristics.** Our baseline absorbs both the initial forest share and the initial soybean share of farmer $i$'s property area, each separately interacted with year fixed effects, to control

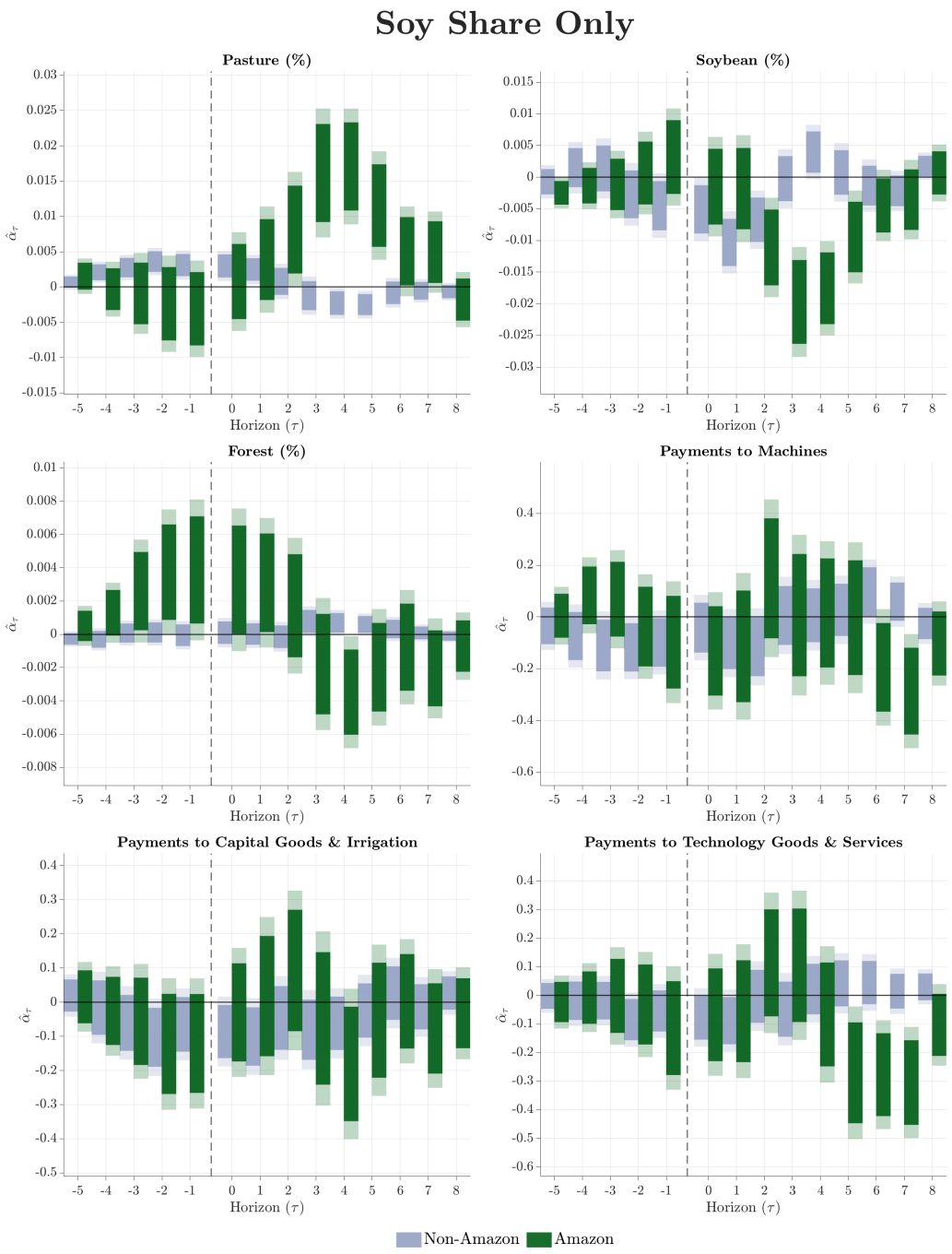
for differential trends correlated with initial land composition. Figures E.4–E.7 report four alternatives that deviate from this baseline: (a) no initial land-use characteristic, (b) initial soybean share only $\times \delta_t$, (c) initial pasture share only $\times \delta_t$, and (d) initial forest share only $\times \delta_t$.

Figure E.4: Robustness: No Initial Characteristic



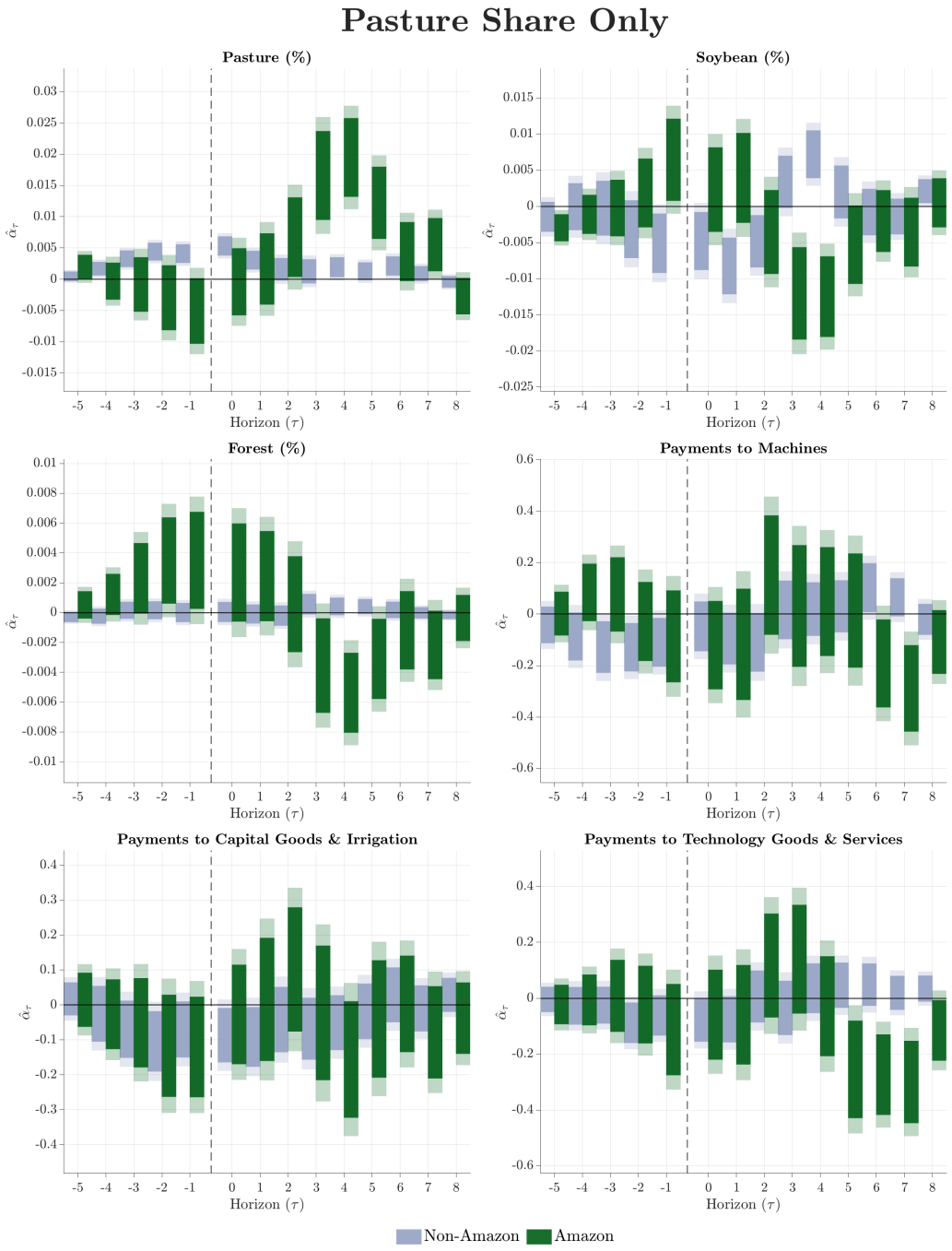

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ without absorbing any initial land-use characteristic interacted with year fixed effects. Absorbed controls include farmer FE, year FE, coverage $\bar{s}_i \times$ year, and beef share $\times$ year. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.5: Robustness: Initial Soybean Share Only



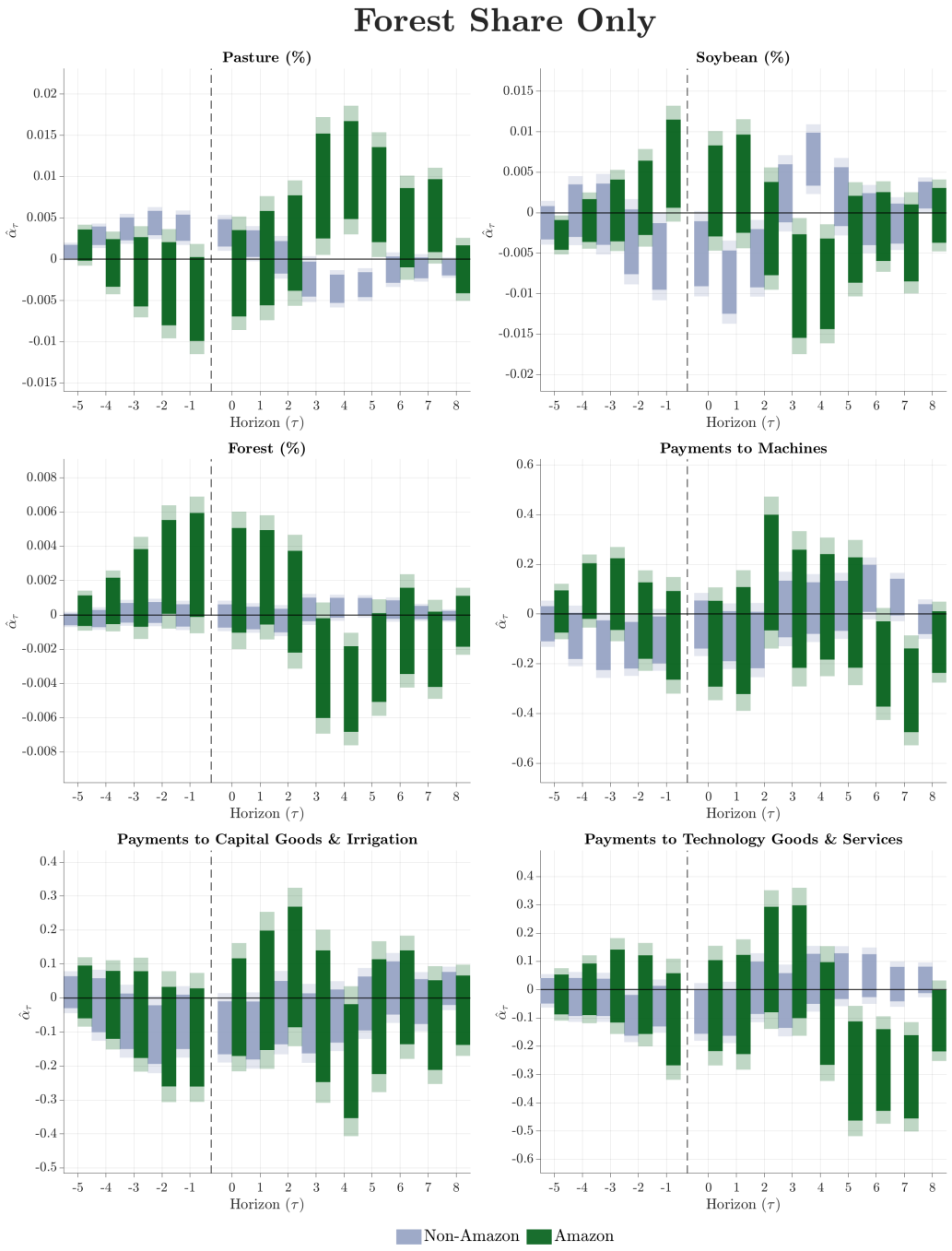

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, dropping the initial forest share from the baseline absorb specification and retaining only initial soybean share interacted with year fixed effects. Absorbed controls include farmer FE, year FE, coverage $\bar{s}_i \times$ year, beef share $\times$ year, and Soybean share$_{t_0} \times$ year. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.6: Robustness: Initial Pasture Share Only




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, replacing the baseline initial forest and soybean shares with initial pasture share only interacted with year fixed effects. Absorbed controls include farmer FE, year FE, coverage $\bar{s}_i \times$ year, beef share $\times$ year, and Pasture share$_{t_0} \times$ year. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

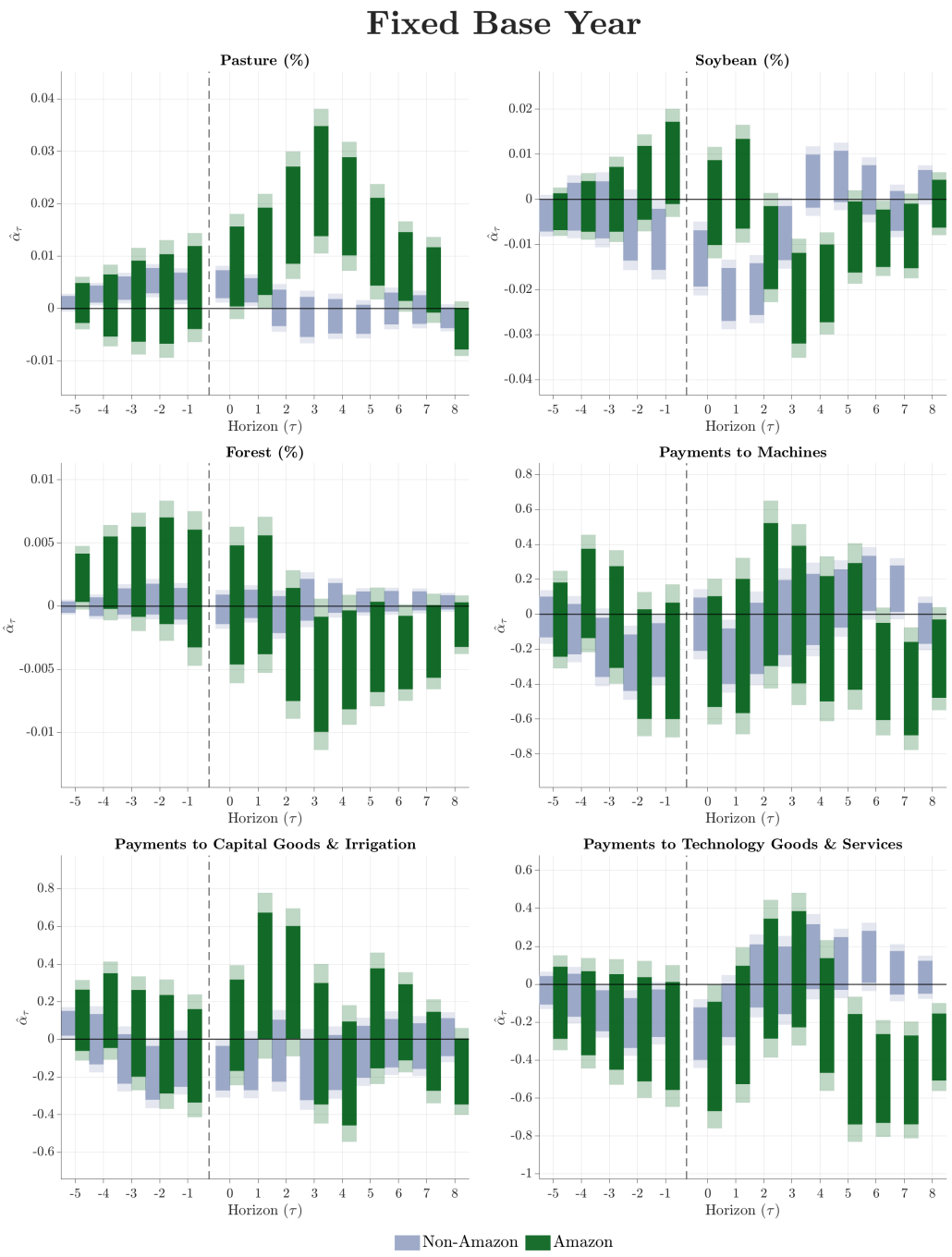
Figure E.7: Robustness: Initial Forest Share Only




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, dropping the initial soybean share from the baseline absorb specification and retaining only initial forest share interacted with year fixed effects. Absorbed controls include farmer FE, year FE, coverage $\bar{s}_i \times$ year, beef share $\times$ year, and Forest share$_{t_0} \times$ year. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Fixed Baseline Year.** We restrict the sample to farmers whose first year in the data is 2010, so that $t_0 = 2010$ for all farmers and the initial weights $w_{ix}$ and shares $s_{ic}^k$ are measured at the same point in time. This eliminates variation arising from staggered entry and rolling baseline years. Figure E.8 reports the results.

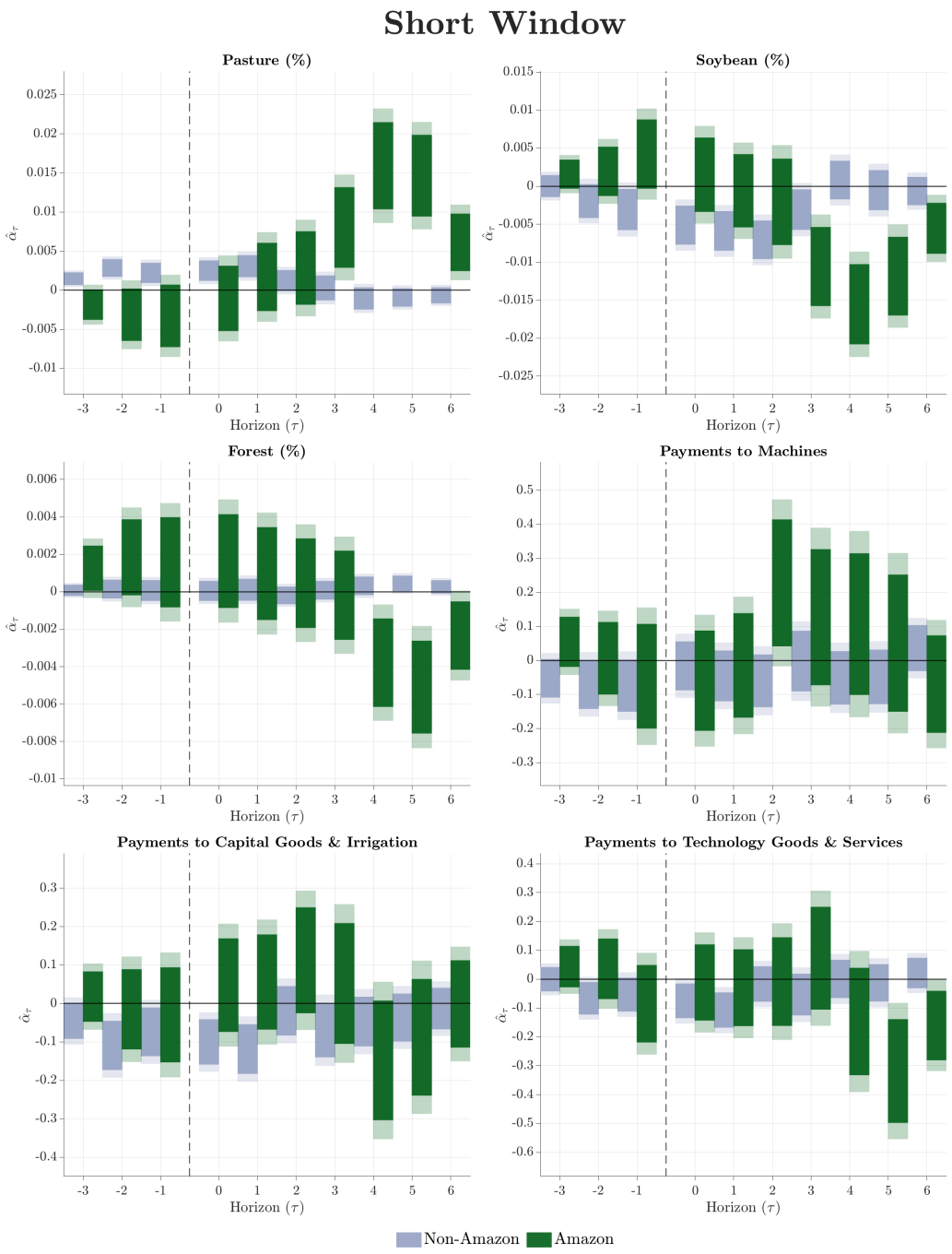
Figure E.8: Robustness: Fixed Baseline Year ($t_0 = 2010$)




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$, restricting the sample to farmers whose first year in the data is 2010 so that all initial weights and shares are measured at the same point in time. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Shorter Event Window.** We re-estimate equation (10) using an event window of $\tau = -3$ to $+6$ instead of $\tau = -5$ to $+8$. This tests whether our results are sensitive to the inclusion of distant leads and lags, which impose stronger sample balance requirements. Figure E.9 reports the results.

Figure E.9: Robustness: Shorter Event Window ($\tau = -3$ to $+6$)

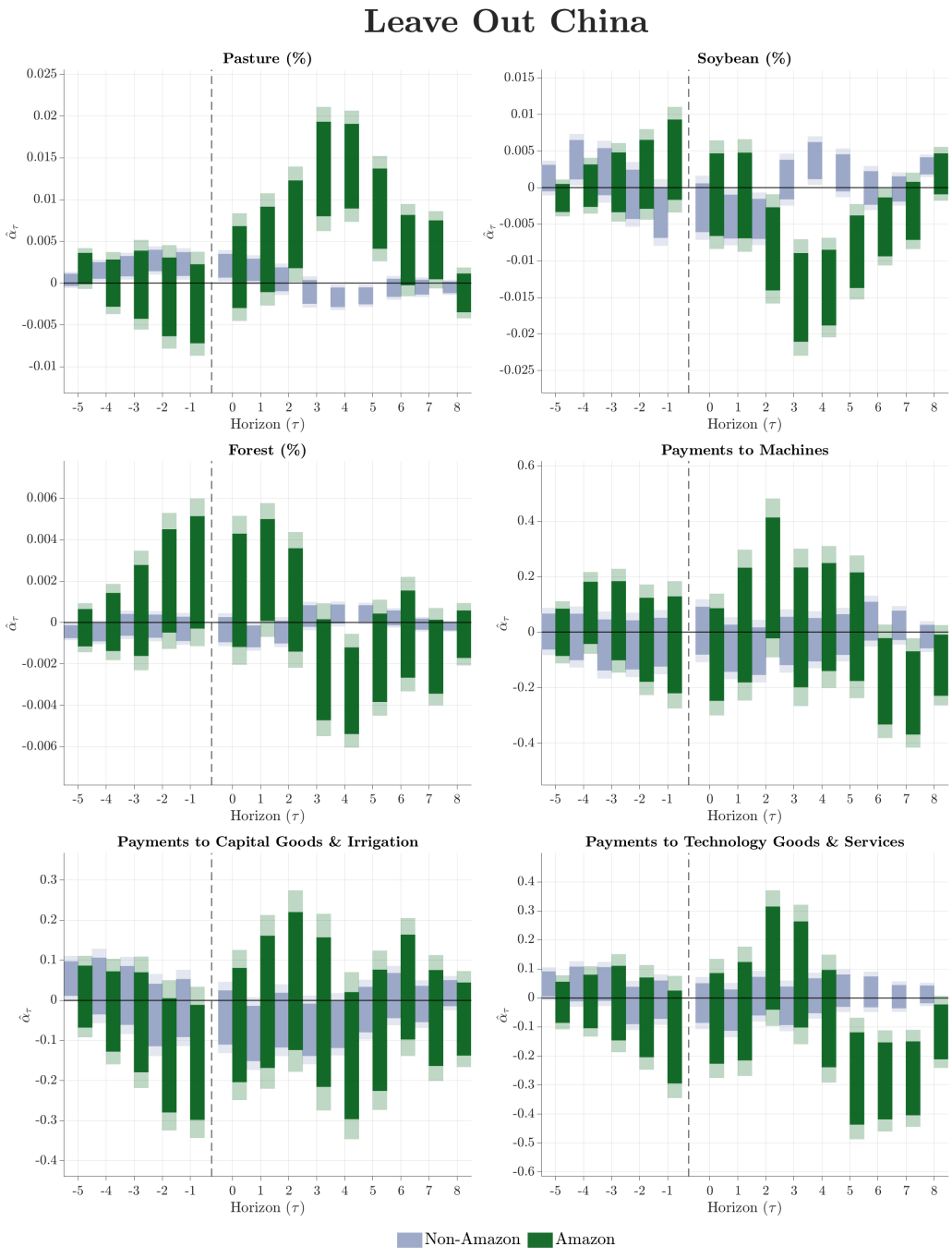



*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) with a shorter event window of $\tau = -3, \ldots, +6$ instead of the baseline $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Leave-One-Destination-Out.** We drop each of the five largest destinations by importance weight $S_c$ one at a time (China, Russia, Hong Kong, Iran, the Netherlands), jointly reweight the remaining shares $s_{ic}^k$ across both products so that $\sum_{k,c} s_{ic}^k = 1$, recompute $\Delta z_{it}$, and re-estimate. As in the destination-drop exercise above, the incomplete share control is dropped after reweighting. Figures E.10–E.14 report each variant. This exercise directly addresses the concern raised in Appendix A that the

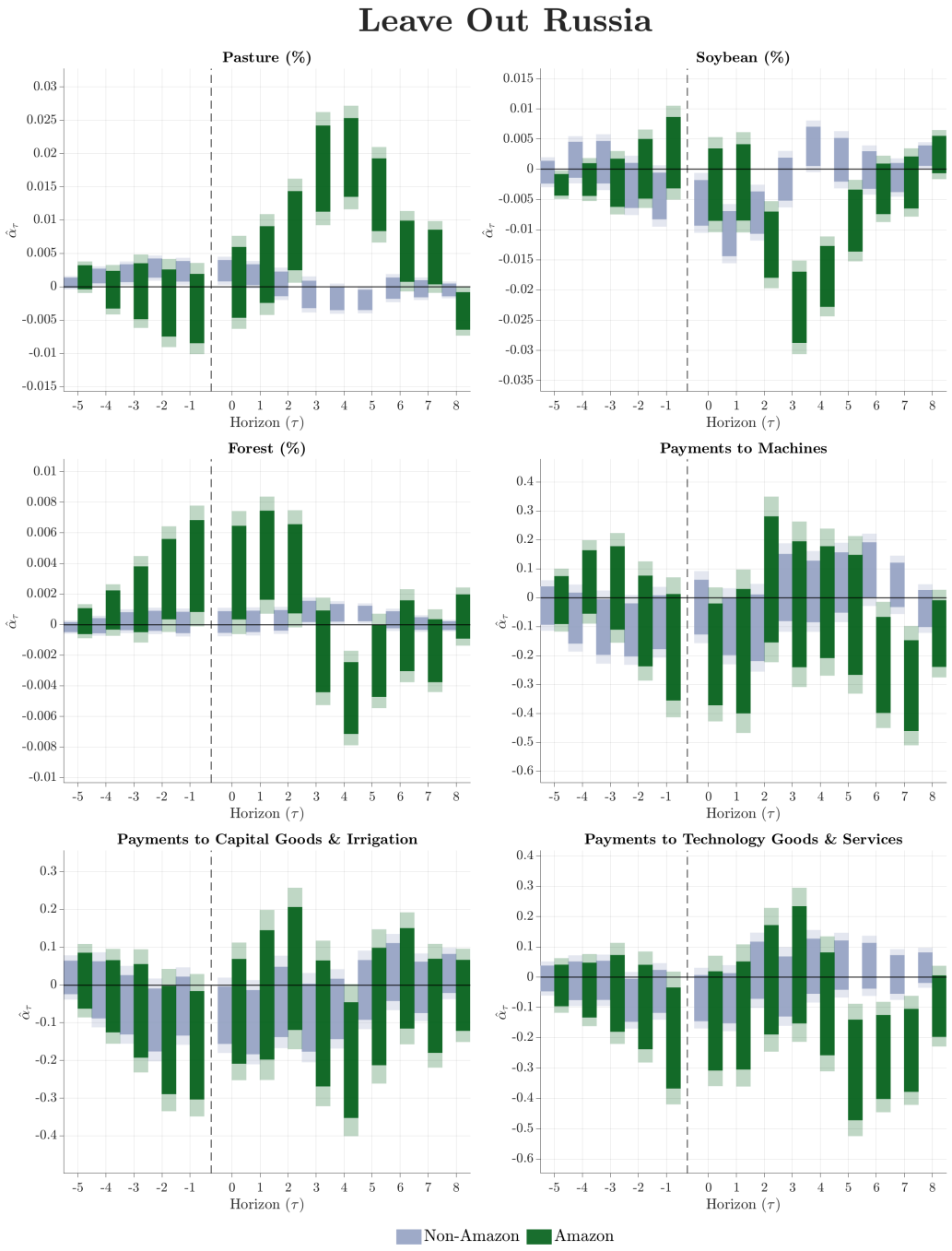
instrument may be driven by a small number of dominant demand shifters.

Figure E.10: Leave-One-Out: Dropping China



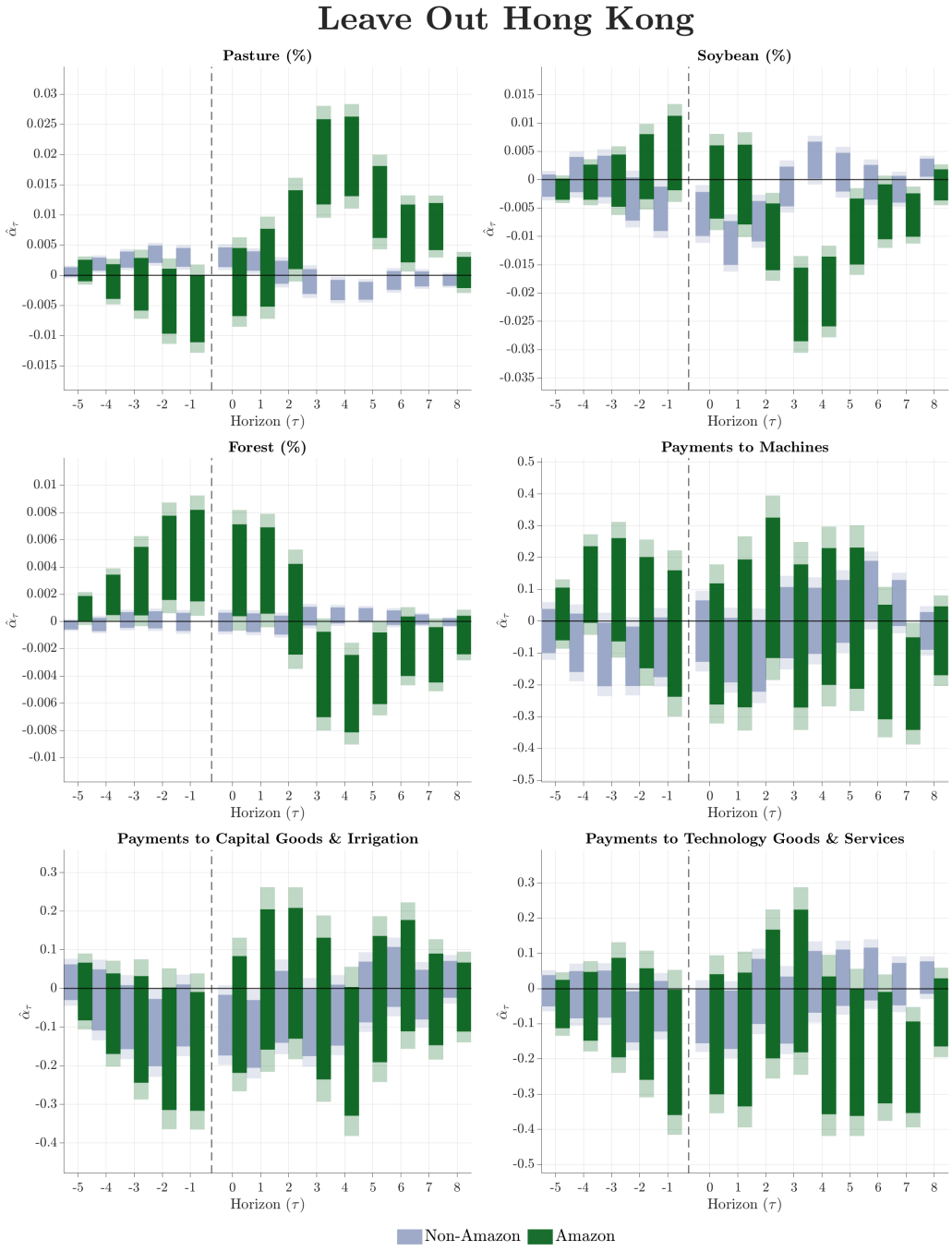

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping China from all destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1+Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.11: Leave-One-Out: Dropping Russia



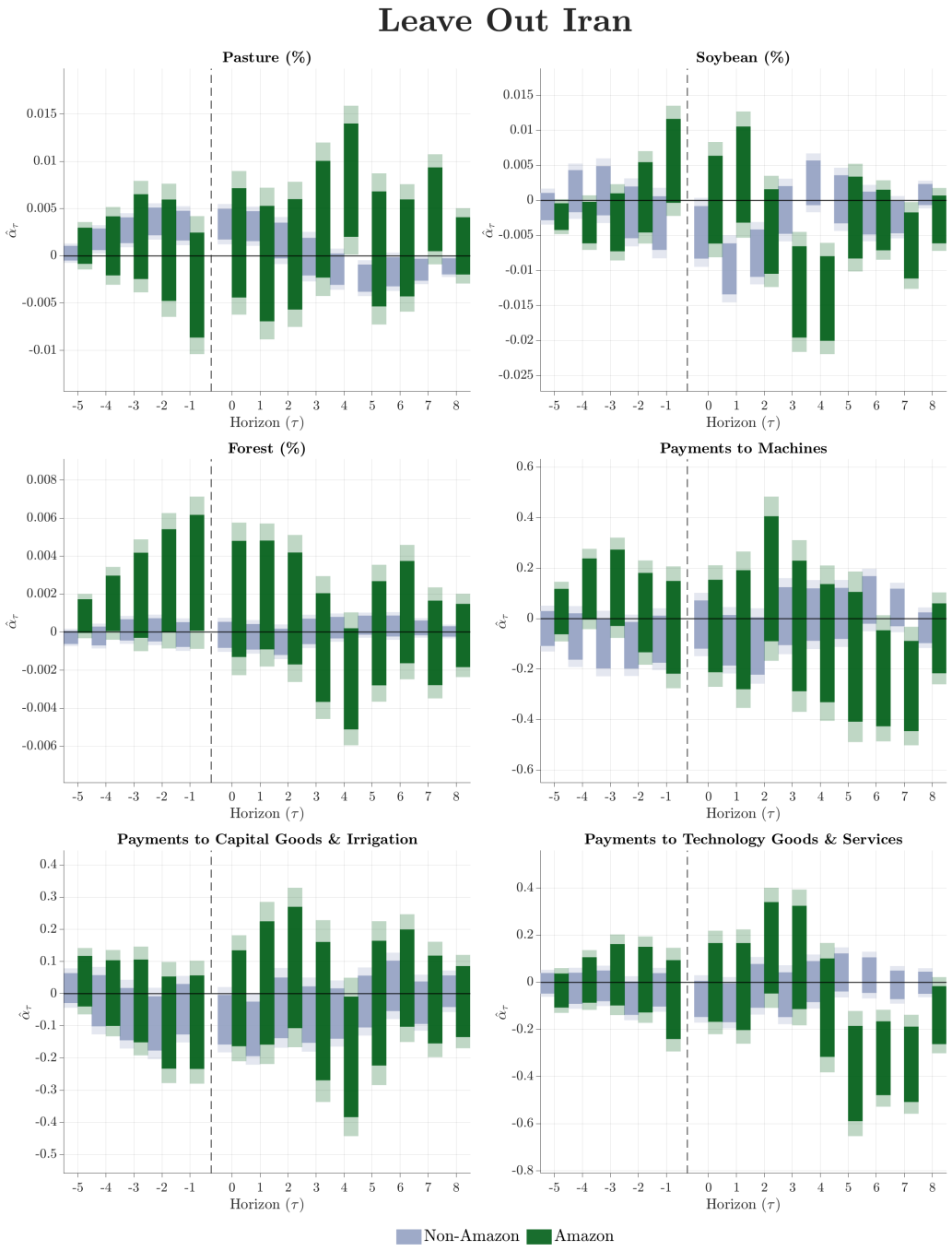

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping Russia from all destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1+Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.12: Leave-One-Out: Dropping Hong Kong



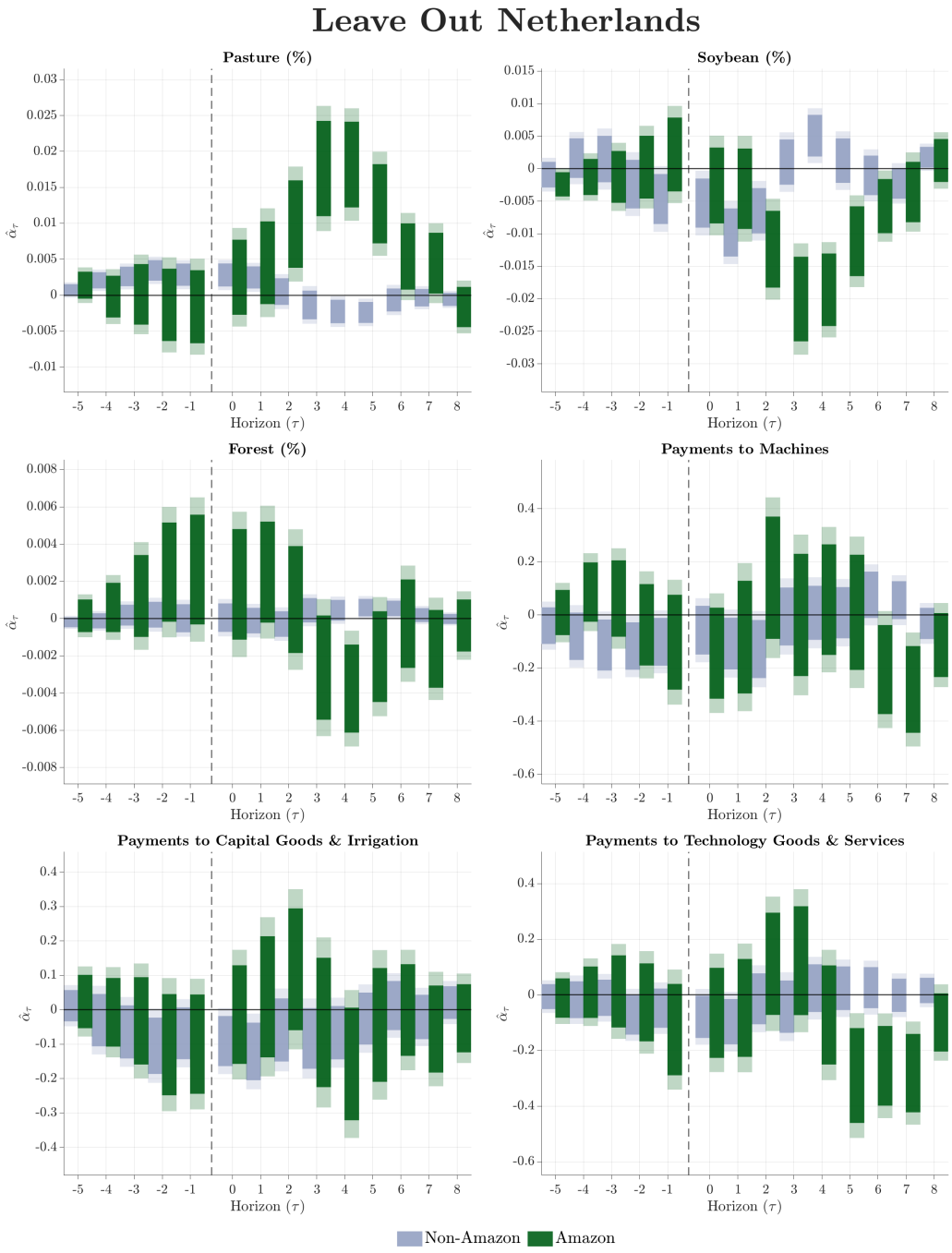

*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping Hong Kong from all destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1+Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.13: Leave-One-Out: Dropping Iran




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping Iran from all destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

Figure E.14: Leave-One-Out: Dropping Netherlands

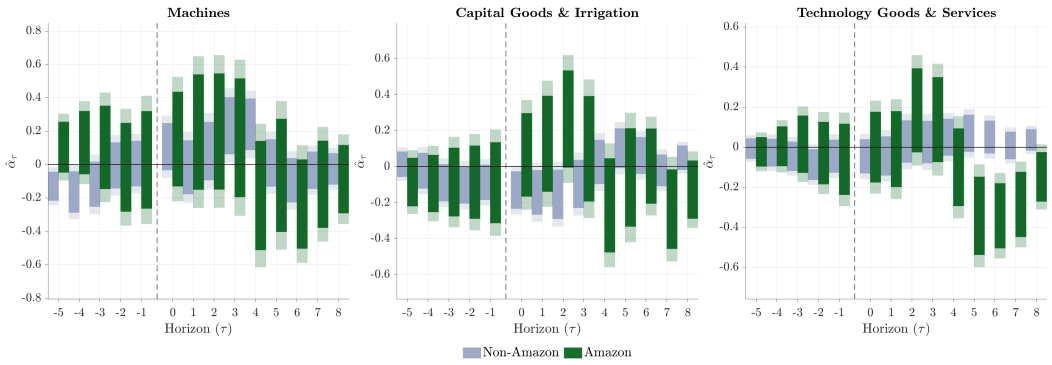



*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ after dropping the Netherlands from all destination shares and reweighting remaining shares to sum to one. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on land-use shares and $\log(1+Y_{it})$ spending. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level.

**Classification Robustness.** Our baseline classification of upstream suppliers into machines, capital goods and irrigation, and technology goods and services relies on specific cnae codes as documented in Table E.1. To assess the sensitivity of our results to these definitions, we estimate two alternative classifications. The *broader* classification expands each category to include additional supplier types

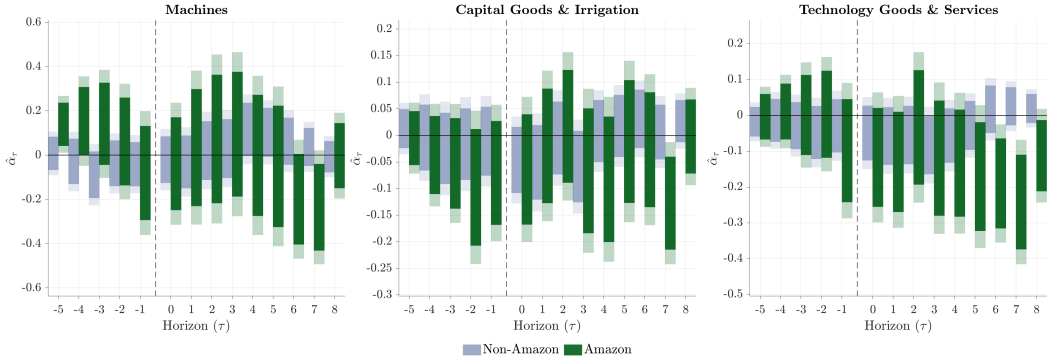
that plausibly relate to farm investment. For machines, we add wholesale trade in agricultural machinery (cnae 4661-3), wholesale of earthmoving equipment (cnae 4662-1), vehicle commerce and repair (Division 45), and rental of agricultural equipment (cnae 7731-4). For capital goods, we add construction services (Divisions 41–43) and wholesale of electrical materials (cnae 4673-7). For technology, we add agricultural pest control (cnae 0161-0/01) and land preparation services (cnae 0161-0/03). The *narrower* classification restricts each category to the most tightly defined codes. For machines, we retain only agricultural tractors and machinery (cnae group 283), wholesale of agricultural machines (cnae 4661-3), and agricultural machinery repair (cnae 3314-7/11, 3314-7/12), dropping vehicles and earthmoving equipment. For capital goods, we retain only irrigation works (cnae 4222-7), irrigation equipment manufacturing (cnae 2832-1), hydraulic and pneumatic equipment (cnae 2812-7, 2813-5), and electrical machinery (Division 27). For technology, we retain only IT services (Divisions 62–63), R&D (Division 72), and agronomic consulting (cnae 7490-1/03), dropping engineering services and electronics manufacturing. Figures E.15 and E.16 report the results.

Figure E.15: Robustness: Broader Supplier Classification




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ using the broader cnae-based classification of spending categories documented in Table E.2. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending in each category. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level. Land-use outcomes are unaffected by supplier reclassification and are omitted.

Figure E.16: Robustness: Narrower Supplier Classification




*Notes:* The figure plots estimated coefficients $\{\hat{\alpha}_\tau\}$ from equation (10) for $\tau = -5, \ldots, +8$ using the narrower cnae-based classification of spending categories documented in Table E.3. Green bars denote Amazon, blue bars denote non-Amazon. Panels report effects on $\log(1 + Y_{it})$ spending in each category. Solid bars denote 95% confidence intervals, shaded areas 99%, clustered at the farmer level. Land-use outcomes are unaffected by supplier reclassification and are omitted.

Table E.1: Baseline Classification of Spending Categories by cnae Code

| Category | cnae Code | Description (Portuguese) | English |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Panel A: Machines* | | | |
| | 2831-3/00 | Fab. de tratores agrícolas | Agricultural tractors |
| | 2833-0/00 | Fab. de máq. para agricultura e pecuária | Ag. machinery (excl. irrigation) |
| | 2853-4/00 | Fab. de tratores, exceto agrícolas | Non-agricultural tractors |
| | 2854-2/00 | Fab. de máq. para terraplenagem | Earthmoving equipment |
| | 2910-7/01 | Fab. de automóveis e utilitários | Automobiles and utility vehicles |
| | 2920-4/01 | Fab. de caminhões e ônibus | Trucks and buses |
| | 2930-1/01 | Fab. de cabines e reboques | Trailers and semi-trailers |
| | 3314-7/11 | Manut. de máq. para agricultura | Repair of ag. machinery |
| | 3314-7/12 | Manut. de tratores agrícolas | Repair of ag. tractors |
| *Panel B: Capital Goods & Irrigation* | | | |
| | 4222-7/02 | Obras de irrigação | Irrigation works |
| | Division 27 | Máq., aparelhos e mat. elétricos | Electrical machinery and apparatus |
| | Division 30 | Outros equip. de transporte | Other transport equipment |
| | Div. 28 remainder | Máq. e equipamentos (excl. Machines) | General/special machinery (residual) |
| | Div. 29 remainder | Veículos automotores (excl. Machines) | Motor vehicles and parts (residual) |
| *Panel C: Technology Goods & Services* | | | |
| | Division 26 | Equip. de informática e eletrônicos | Computing and electronic equipment |
| | Division 62 | Serviços de tecnologia da informação | IT services |
| | Division 63 | Serviços de informação | Information services |
| | 7112-0/00 | Serviços de engenharia | Engineering services |
| | 7119-7 | Atividades técnicas de engenharia | Technical engineering activities |
| | 7120-1/00 | Testes e análises técnicas | Testing and technical analysis |
| | 7490-1/03 | Consultoria agronômica | Agronomic consulting |
| | Division 72 | Pesquisa e desenvolvimento científico | Scientific R&D |

*Notes:* The table reports the baseline mapping from cnae codes to the three spending categories used in the empirical analysis. "Division" refers to the 2-digit cnae division (all subclasses included). "Remainder" indicates all subclasses within the division not already classified under Machines. The cnae classification follows *Classificação Nacional de Atividades Econômicas* version 2.3. We verify robustness to broader and narrower definitions of these categories (see text).

Tables E.2 and E.3 document the broader and narrower classification variants used in Figures E.15 and E.16. The broader classification adds wholesale and rental of agricultural machinery, vehicle commerce and repair, construction services, and agricultural pest control. The narrower classification restricts machines to cnae group 283 (agricultural tractors and machinery only), drops most of the capital goods residual categories, and removes electronics manufacturing and engineering services from technology.

Table E.2: Broader Classification of Spending Categories by cnae Code

| Category | cnae Code | English |
|---|---|---|
| *Panel A: Machines (Broader)* | | |
| | *All baseline codes* | *See Table E.1* |
| | 4661-3/00 | Wholesale of agricultural machinery |
| | 4662-1/00 | Wholesale of earthmoving equipment |
| | Division 45 | Vehicle commerce and repair |
| | 7731-4/00 | Rental of agricultural equipment |
| *Panel B: Capital Goods & Irrigation (Broader)* | | |
| | *All baseline codes* | *See Table E.1* |
| | Divisions 41–43 | Construction services |
| | 4673-7/00 | Wholesale of electrical materials |
| *Panel C: Technology Goods & Services (Broader)* | | |
| | *All baseline codes* | *See Table E.1* |

*Notes:* The table reports additional cnae codes included in the broader classification relative to the baseline (Table E.1). Technology Goods & Services is unchanged from baseline in the broader variant. Categories are mutually exclusive and assigned in the order Machines, Capital Goods, Technology.

Table E.3: Narrower Classification of Spending Categories by cnae Code

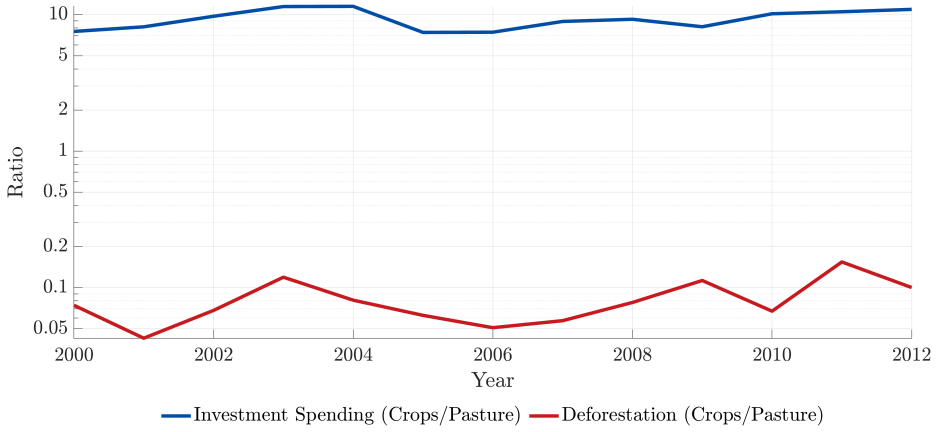
| Category | cnae Code | English |
|---|---|---|
| *Panel A: Machines (Narrower)* | | |
| | Group 283 | Agricultural tractors and machinery |
| | 4661-3/00 | Wholesale of agricultural machinery |
| | 3314-7/11 | Repair of agricultural machinery |
| | 3314-7/12 | Repair of agricultural tractors |
| *Panel B: Capital Goods & Irrigation (Narrower)* | | |
| | 4222-7/02 | Irrigation works |
| | 2832-1/00 | Irrigation equipment manufacturing |
| | 2812-7/00 | Hydraulic equipment |
| | 2813-5/00 | Pneumatic equipment |
| | Division 27 | Electrical machinery and apparatus |
| *Panel C: Technology Goods & Services (Narrower)* | | |
| | Divisions 62–63 | IT and information services |
| | Division 72 | Scientific R&D |
| | 7490-1/03 | Agronomic consulting |

*Notes:* The table reports the restricted set of cnae codes included in the narrower classification. Relative to the baseline (Table E.1), Machines drops vehicles, earthmoving equipment, and non-agricultural tractors. Capital Goods drops Divisions 28–30 residuals and retains only irrigation and electrical equipment. Technology drops Division 26 (electronics manufacturing) and engineering services (cnae 7112, 7119, 7120).

# F Appendix: Additional Descriptives

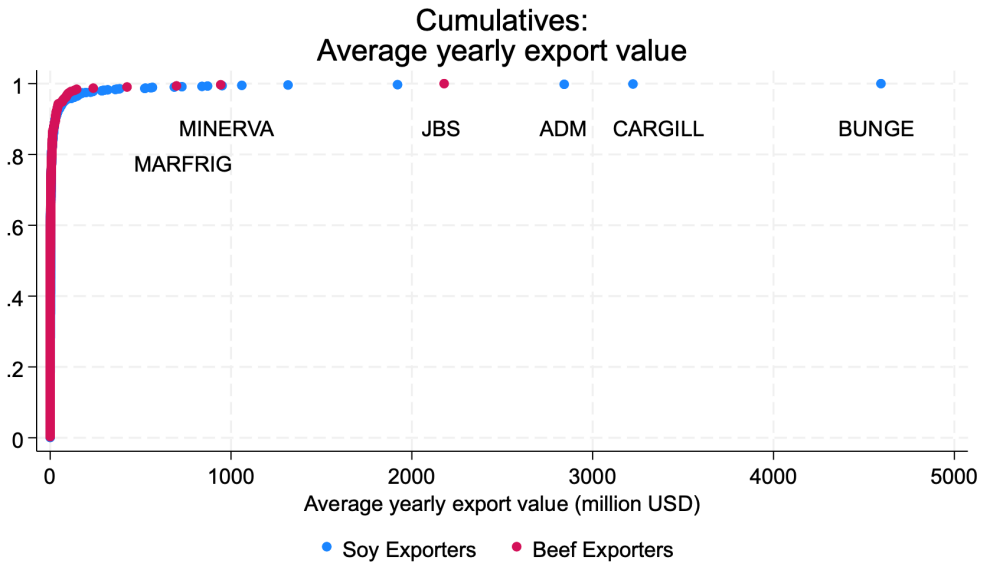
This appendix provides additional descriptive evidence on the sample used in the main analysis.

Figure F.1: Investment and Deforestation for Crops Relative to Pasture, 2000–2012




*Notes.* The blue line plots the ratio of crop to pasture investment spending and the red line plots the ratio of forest converted to cropland to forest converted to pasture, for Brazil over 2000 to 2012 (log scale). Investment spending is computed from the Investment Absorption Matrices (Miguez & Freitas 2021) in constant 2003 US dollars, excluding spending on crops, forestry products, and live animals. Forest conversion is measured as the area of native forest transitioning to cropland and to pasture between consecutive years in the MapBiomas land cover series, Collection 10.

Figure F.2: Cumulative Distribution of Average Yearly Export Value by Sector




*Notes:* The figure displays the cumulative distribution function (CDF) of average yearly export values (in million USD) for soy and beef exporting firms. For the agricultural sectors, the labels identify the top three exporters: Bunge, Cargill, and ADM for soy; and JBS, Minerva, and Marfrig for beef.

Table F.1: Summary Statistics: Amazon vs. Non-Amazon

| | Legal Amazon | | | | Outside Amazon | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean | SD | Min | Max | Mean | SD | Min | Max |
| *Trade & Transactions* | | | | | | | | |
| Export Value (mil. USD) | 2,881 | 3,121 | 0 | 28,318 | 1,863 | 2,594 | 0 | 28,795 |
| Payments to Suppliers (mil. USD) | 0.40 | 5.70 | 0 | 664 | 0.73 | 15.98 | 0 | 2,972 |
| # Suppliers per Farmer | 10.2 | 48.9 | 1 | 5,125 | 13.1 | 132.8 | 1 | 12,157 |
| # Exporters per Farmer | 1.80 | 1.34 | 1 | 25 | 1.51 | 1.15 | 1 | 37 |
| Beef Export Exposure | 0.590 | 0.483 | 0 | 1 | 0.310 | 0.453 | 0 | 1 |
| Soy Export Exposure | 0.410 | 0.483 | 0 | 1 | 0.690 | 0.453 | 0 | 1 |
| *Land Use* | | | | | | | | |
| Forest Share | 0.191 | 0.185 | 0 | 0.95 | 0.108 | 0.110 | 0 | 0.94 |
| Pasture Share | 0.464 | 0.346 | 0 | 1.00 | 0.211 | 0.276 | 0 | 1.00 |
| Soybean Share | 0.202 | 0.293 | 0 | 1.00 | 0.336 | 0.317 | 0 | 1.00 |
| Total Area (ha) | 3,065 | 8,356 | 0.09 | 345,555 | 1,758 | 4,513 | 0.09 | 171,162 |
| # Properties per Farmer | 2.74 | 3.04 | 1 | 56 | 3.59 | 4.08 | 1 | 130 |
| *Spending (Real USD / ha)* | | | | | | | | |
| Machines | 14.2 | 1,075 | 0 | 234,057 | 165.9 | 21,939 | 0 | 8,983,155 |
| Capital Goods & Irrigation | 13.1 | 1,369 | 0 | 315,317 | 135.2 | 7,586 | 0 | 2,010,281 |
| Technology Goods & Services | 11.8 | 1,219 | 0 | 350,587 | 107.2 | 7,684 | 0 | 1,602,507 |
| *Instrument* | | | | | | | | |
| Share Coverage ($\bar{s}_i$) | 1.000 | 0.003 | 0.260 | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.009 | 0.001 | 1.000 |
| Observations | | 99,499 | | | | 252,541 | | |
| Unique Farmers | | 30,295 | | | | 98,009 | | |

*Notes:* The table reports summary statistics at the farmer-year level over 2010–2020. Farmers are classified as Legal Amazon if more than 50% of their CAR properties fall within the Legal Amazon boundary. *Export Value* is the total export value (in millions of USD) of all exporters the farmer is linked to through payment records. *Payments to Suppliers* is the total value of outgoing payments from the farmer to upstream input suppliers. # *Suppliers* and # *Exporters* count the unique upstream suppliers receiving payments from the farmer and the distinct export firms the farmer sells to, respectively. *Beef* and *Soy Export Exposure* are the shares of the farmer's total export exposure that flow through beef and soy exporters, respectively, and sum to one. Land use variables are computed by aggregating annual satellite imagery from MapBiomas (30×30 meter resolution) across all CAR properties associated with a given farmer, and dividing by the farmer's total registered property area. Each share therefore reflects the farmer's overall land allocation across all properties operated in a given year. Spending variables are total annual payments to suppliers in each category, converted to real USD using the BRL/USD exchange rate, and divided by total CAR property area in hectares. *Share Coverage* ($\bar{s}_i$) is the sum of farmer $i$'s destination shares $\sum_{k,c} s^k_{ic}$; a value below one indicates that some of the farmer's export exposure flows through destinations for which FAO import data is unavailable, so that the demand shock is constructed from an incomplete set of destination weights. The mean is effectively one, but the minimum of 0.001 outside the Amazon shows that a small number of farmers have very low coverage, which we control for by absorbing $\bar{s}_i \times$ year fixed effects in the regression.

Table F.2 reports summary statistics split by whether the farmer is linked to beef or soy exporters. The two commodities display the expected differences in land use composition. Farms linked to beef exporters allocate on average 52% of their property area to pasture and 9% to soybean, while farms linked to soy exporters allocate 14% to pasture and 42% to soybean. Beef-linked farms are exposed to lower total export values (reflecting the smaller scale of beef exporters relative to soy) and are connected to fewer exporters on average. Spending per hectare on machines, capital goods, and technology services is broadly similar across the two groups in levels, though soy-linked farmers spend somewhat more on machinery.

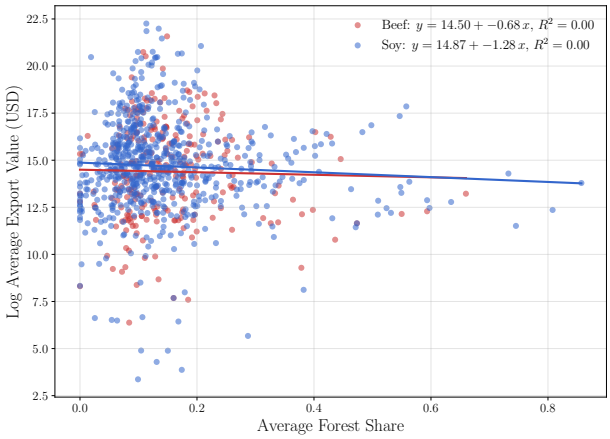
Table F.2: Summary Statistics: Beef vs. Soy

| | Beef | | | | Soy | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Mean | SD | Min | Max | Mean | SD | Min | Max |
| *Trade & Transactions* | | | | | | | | |
| Export Value (mil. USD) | 1,217 | 1,288 | 0 | 6,576 | 2,487 | 3,122 | 0 | 28,795 |
| Payments to Suppliers (mil. USD) | 0.69 | 14.5 | 0 | 1,814 | 0.88 | 16.9 | 0 | 2,972 |
| # Suppliers per Farmer | 13.4 | 144.0 | 1 | 12,157 | 15.4 | 139.2 | 1 | 12,157 |
| # Exporters per Farmer | 1.33 | 0.66 | 1 | 10 | 1.60 | 1.27 | 1 | 35 |
| *Land Use* | | | | | | | | |
| Forest Share | 0.143 | 0.156 | 0 | 0.95 | 0.125 | 0.129 | 0 | 0.95 |
| Pasture Share | 0.519 | 0.323 | 0 | 1.00 | 0.136 | 0.201 | 0 | 1.00 |
| Soybean Share | 0.090 | 0.197 | 0 | 1.00 | 0.424 | 0.304 | 0 | 1.00 |
| Total Area (ha) | 2,178 | 5,796 | 0.09 | 345,549 | 2,340 | 6,502 | 0.09 | 345,555 |
| # Properties per Farmer | 2.51 | 2.82 | 1 | 56 | 3.93 | 4.31 | 1 | 130 |
| *Spending (Real USD / ha)* | | | | | | | | |
| Machines | 106.2 | 15,401 | 0 | 5,707,565 | 172.4 | 22,755 | 0 | 8,983,155 |
| Capital Goods & Irrigation | 139.4 | 8,807 | 0 | 2,010,281 | 140.9 | 7,874 | 0 | 2,010,281 |
| Technology Goods & Services | 95.7 | 7,278 | 0 | 1,419,847 | 116.4 | 7,998 | 0 | 1,602,507 |
| Observations | 142,389 | | | | 234,455 | | | |
| Unique Farmers | 59,524 | | | | 85,472 | | | |

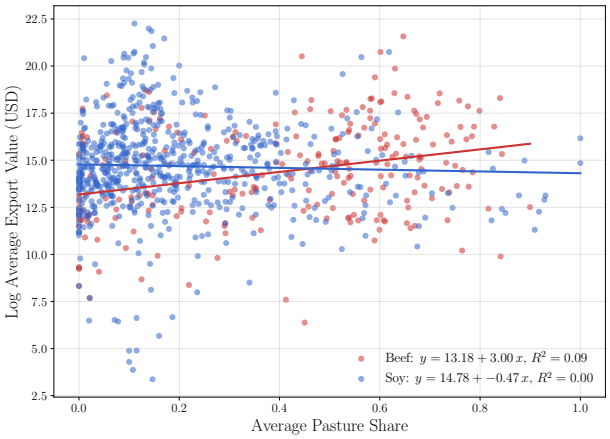
*Notes:* The table reports summary statistics at the farmer-year level over 2010–2020, split by whether the farmer is linked to at least one beef or soy exporter through payment records. Farmers linked to both appear in both columns. *Export Value* is the total export value (in millions of USD) of all exporters the farmer is linked to. Land use variables are computed by aggregating annual satellite imagery from MapBiomas across all CAR properties a farmer operates, divided by total registered property area. Spending variables are total annual payments to suppliers in each category, converted to real USD and divided by total property area in hectares.

Figure F.3 plots each exporter's average export value against the average land composition of its connected farmers. In contrast to the log-linear relationship between export value and the number of connected properties documented in the main text (Figure 4), there is no systematic correlation between exporter size and the average forest share, pasture share, or soybean share of connected farmers. The $R^2$ is essentially zero in all three panels. This pattern implies that larger exporters are not systematically connected to farmers with different land use characteristics, reducing the concern that exporter-level demand variation might be confounded with pre-existing differences in how farmers allocate their land.

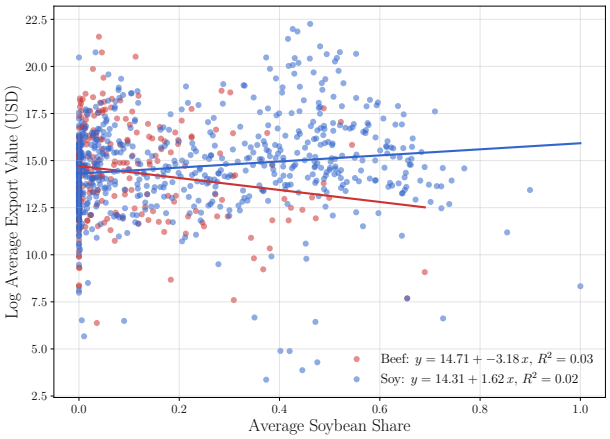
Figure F.3: Exporter Size and Average Land Composition of Connected Farmers




(a) Forest Share




(b) Pasture Share

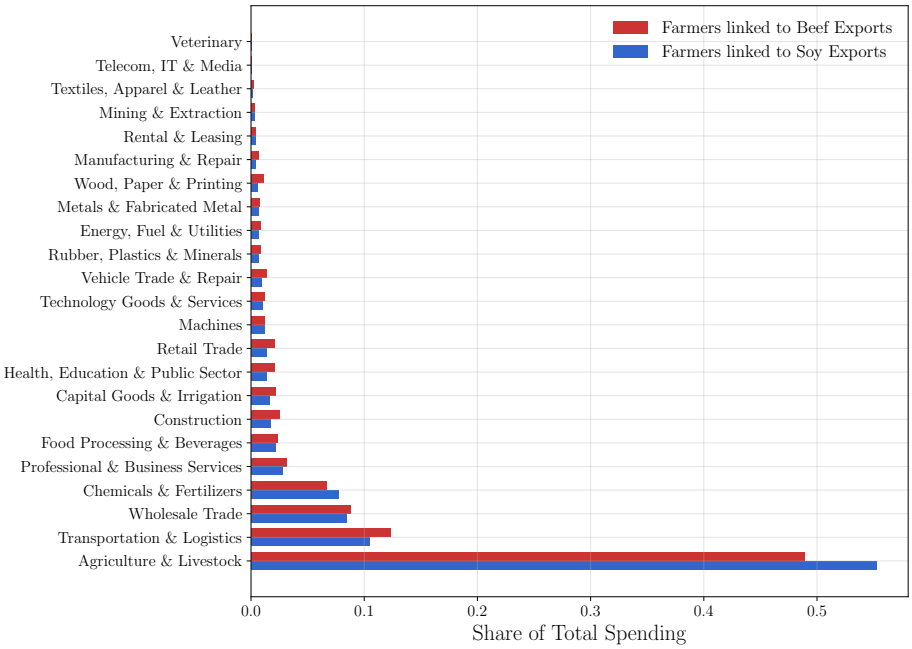



(c) Soybean Share

*Notes:* Each panel plots an exporter's log average yearly export value (USD) against the average land use share of its connected farmers between 2010 and 2020. Red dots represent beef exporters and blue dots represent soy exporters. The lines show linear fits with reported $R^2$. In all three panels, the $R^2$ is essentially zero, indicating no systematic correlation between exporter size and the land composition of connected farmers.

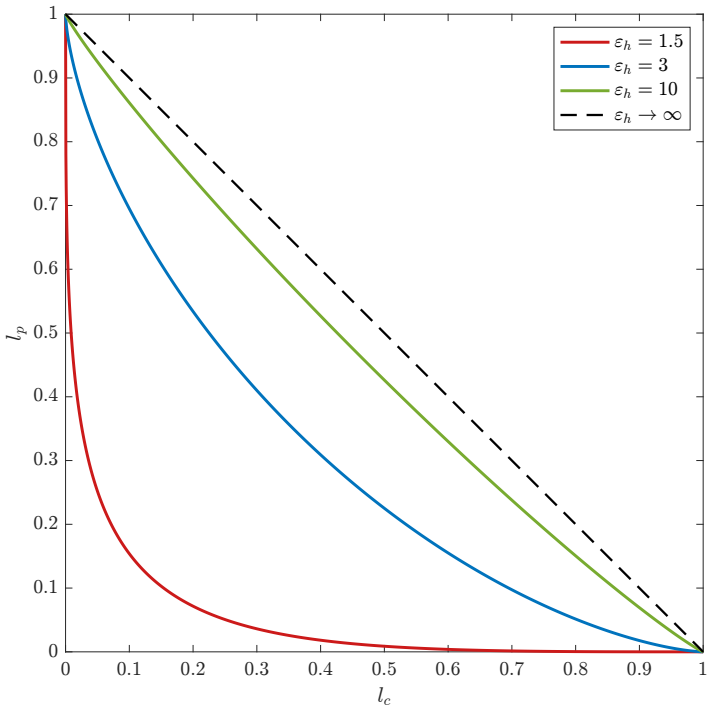
Figure F.4 decomposes total farm-level spending by the 2-digit cnae sector of the upstream supplier, separately for farmers linked to beef and soy exporters. For both commodities, the largest spending category is agriculture and livestock, which captures inter-farm transactions such as purchases of feed, seed, and live animals. Soy is a key input in cattle feed, linking the two commodity chains at the farm level. The next-largest categories are transportation and logistics, wholesale trade, and chemicals and fertilizers. Soy-linked farmers spend a notably larger share on chemicals and fertilizers, reflecting the input intensity of soybean cultivation. The three spending categories that we study in our empirical analysis, machines, capital goods and irrigation, and technology goods and services, are visible in the lower portion of the figure, each accounting for roughly 1 to 2 percent of total spending.

Figure F.4: Farm-Level Spending by Supplier Sector



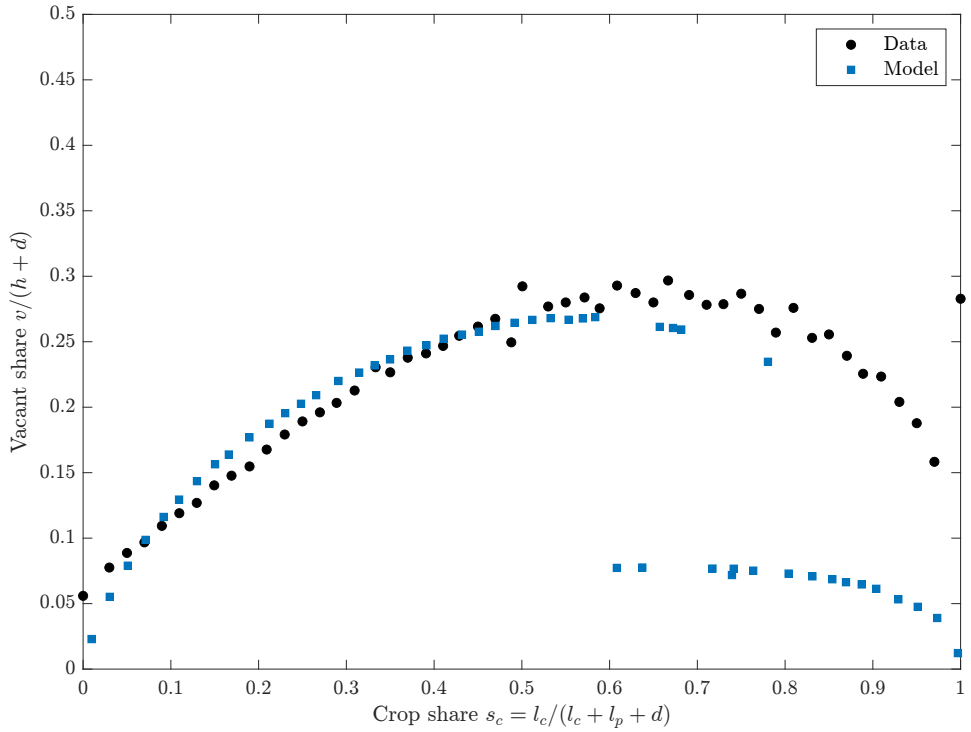

*Notes:* The figure displays the share of total farm-level spending directed to each supplier category (based on 2-digit cnae classification), separately for farmers linked to beef exporters (red) and soy exporters (blue). Categories are ranked by average spending share across both groups.

Figure F.1: The Plot Constraint for Different Values of $\varepsilon_h$




*Notes:* The figure plots the plot constraint (1) at equality, $\left(l_c^{(\varepsilon_h-1)/\varepsilon_h} + l_p^{(\varepsilon_h-1)/\varepsilon_h}\right)^{\varepsilon_h/(\varepsilon_h-1)} = 1$, with crop land $l_c$ on the horizontal axis and pasture land $l_p$ on the vertical axis, for $\varepsilon_h \in \{1.5, 3, 10\}$. The dashed line shows the limit $\varepsilon_h \to \infty$, where the constraint reduces to $l_c + l_p \leq 1$. Lower values of $\varepsilon_h$ bow the constraint inward, so the sum $l_c + l_p$ is largest at full specialization.

Figure F.2: Vacant Share of Total Property versus Crop Share of Farmed Land




*Notes:* The figure plots the median vacant share $v/(h+d)$ against the crop share of farmed land $s_c = l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$ in 50 equal-width bins. Black dots are bin medians across 6.7 million CAR properties using MapBiomas land cover in 2003, all of Brazil. Blue squares are the calibrated model at $\varepsilon_h = 3.1$.

## G Calibration Tables

Table G.1: Internal calibration (parameters and matched moments)

| Parameter | Moment | Value | Model | Data | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\rho$ | Crop share of agricultural production value | 0.76 | 0.35 | 0.34 | FAO |
| $\varepsilon_h, \varepsilon_p$ | Crop-share response, Legal Amazon (demeaned) | 3.10, 1.95 | $-1.90$ | $-1.84$ | Shift-share (this paper) |
| | Crop-share response, Non-Amazon (demeaned) | | $+0.15$ | $+0.37$ | Shift-share (this paper) |
| $\bar{c}$ | Pasture share of farm area, mean | 0.018 | 0.65 | 0.60 | CAR |
| $\underline{c}$ | Pasture-to-crop land ratio | 0.007 | 4.19 | 4.03 | MapBiomas |
| $\varepsilon$ | Pasture share of farm area, standard deviation | 2.18 | 0.37 | 0.41 | CAR |
| $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ | Agricultural export / consumption ratio | 0.009 | 0.019 | 0.021 | OECD I-O |
| $\mathcal{D}_n^*$ | Non-agricultural export / consumption ratio | 61.5 | 0.33 | 0.26 | OECD I-O |
| $A_m$ | Employment size distributions, ag and non-ag | 1.45 | Figure 11 | | RAIS, IBGE-Censo |
| $\kappa_{tn}$ | Employment size distribution, non-ag | 0.041 | Figure 11 | | RAIS |
| $\kappa_{mn}$ | Employment size distribution, non-ag | 0.232 | Figure 11 | | RAIS |
| $\zeta$ | Employment size distributions, ag and non-ag | 4.87 | Figure 11 | | RAIS, IBGE-Censo |
| $\delta$ | Employment size distribution, non-ag | 1.03 | Figure 11 | | RAIS |
| $\kappa_{ta}$ | Employment size distribution, ag | 0.049 | Figure 11 | | IBGE-Censo |
| $\kappa_{ma}$ | Employment size distribution, ag | 0.010 | Figure 11 | | IBGE-Censo |

Table G.2: Amazon propensity $\beta(s_c)$ estimated on the 2003 CAR farm cross section

| | $\Pr(i \in \text{Legal Amazon})$ |
|---|---|
| $s_c$ | $-19.719^{***}$ |
| | $(0.044)$ |
| $s_c^2$ | $40.747^{***}$ |
| | $(0.115)$ |
| $s_c^3$ | $-23.789^{***}$ |
| | $(0.077)$ |
| Constant | $-0.764^{***}$ |
| | $(0.001)$ |
| Observations | 6,729,685 |
| $R^2$ | 0.170 |

*Notes.* Logistic regression of an indicator for location in the Legal Amazon on a cubic polynomial in the crop land share $s_c = l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$, estimated on the 2003 CAR farm cross section. Robust standard errors in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table G.3: External calibration

| Parameter | Value | Source |
|---|---|---|
| $\eta_a$ | 4.1 | Heresi (2024) Table 6 (agriculture, markup 1.32) |
| $\eta_n$ | 3.2 | Heresi (2024) Table 6 (non-agriculture, markup 1.45) |
| $\sigma$ | 2 | Feenstra et al. (2018) |
| $\theta$ | 5 | Qiu et al. (2026) |
| $\nu_c$ | 0.44 | Pellegrina (2022) |
| $\nu_p$ | 0.17 | Pellegrina (2022) |
| $\gamma_c$ | 0.50 | Pellegrina (2022) |
| $\gamma_p$ | 0.53 | Pellegrina (2022) |
| $\nu_n$ | 0.543 | OECD SNA Table 6A (labor share) |
| $\alpha_a$ | 0.963 | OECD I-O: home bias (agriculture) |
| $\alpha_n$ | 0.928 | OECD I-O: home bias (non-agriculture) |
| $\phi_a$ | 0.035 | OECD I-O: consumption share (agriculture) |
| $\phi_n$ | 0.965 | OECD I-O: consumption share (non-agriculture) |
| $A_t$ | 1 | Normalization |
| $h$ | 1 | Normalization |
| $N$ | 1 | Normalization |
| $P^*_{f,a}$ | 1 | Normalization |
| $P^*_{f,n}$ | 1 | Normalization |
| $\tau$ | 0 | Policy baseline |

## H Land Tenure in Brazilian Agriculture

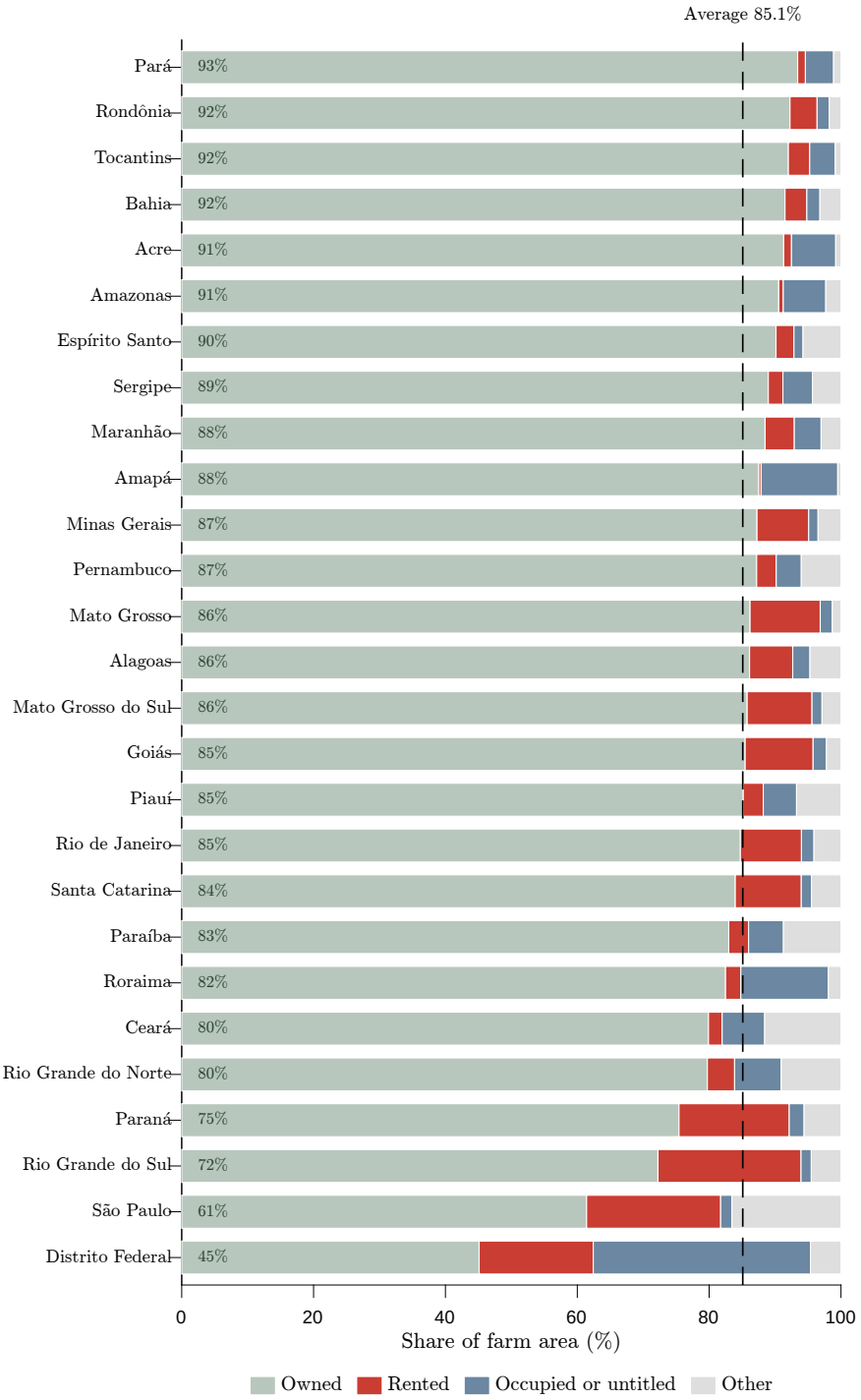



Figure H.3: Land tenure by state, Brazil 2017

*Notes:* Each bar shows the share of total agricultural establishment area by legal condition of the land, from the IBGE Censo Agropecuário 2017 (SIDRA Table 6754). Owned, rented, and occupied or untitled follow the census categories, and other combines sharecropped and loaned land. States are ordered by the owned share, and the dashed line marks the national average.

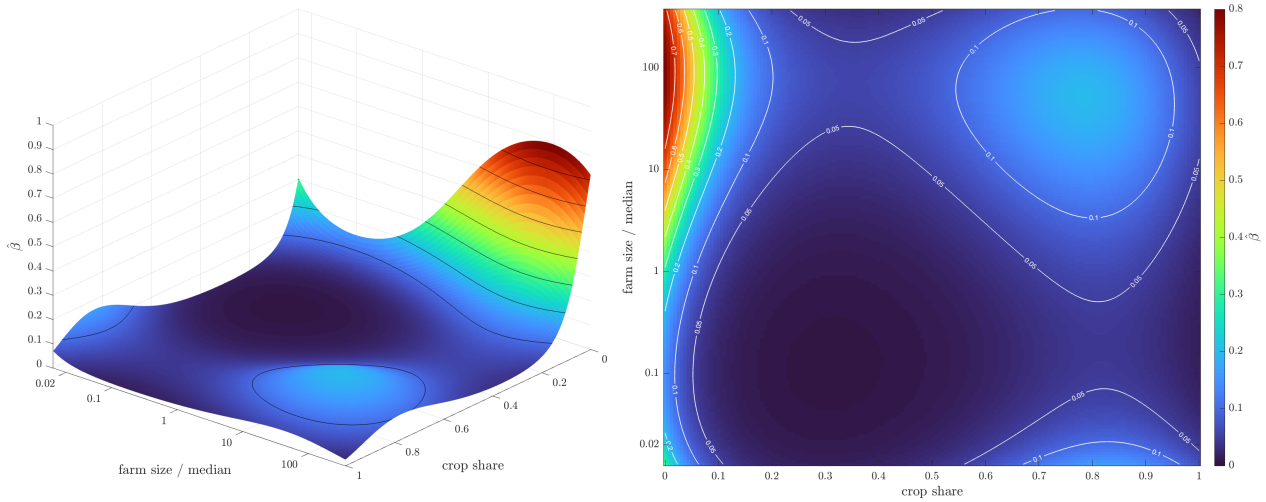
## I Robustness: A Size-Augmented Amazon Bridge

In our baseline calibration, we map the model to the Legal Amazon through the propensity $\hat{\beta}(s_c)$ from a logistic regression of a dummy for being located in the Amazon on a cubic polynomial in the crop share of farm area. In this appendix, we repeat the quantitative analysis under a richer bridge that adds farm size as a second observable. We estimate

$$\hat{\beta}(s_{c,i}, x_i) \equiv \widehat{\Pr}\big(j(i) \in \text{Legal Amazon} \,\big|\, s_{c,i},\, x_i\big), \qquad x_i \equiv \ln\big(\text{farm size}_i / \text{median farm size}\big), \tag{47}$$

by a logistic regression with cubic polynomials in $s_c$ and $x$ and their interaction on the same 6.7 million farms of the 2003 CAR cross section ($R^2$ of $0.242$ against $0.170$ for the univariate bridge). Farm size is farmed area, crops plus pasture; its model counterpart is total farmed land $h + d$, measured relative to the model's own mass-weighted median. We plot the resulting fit in Figure I.4. At the median size, a farm without crop land is in the Legal Amazon with probability $0.29$, falling below five percent once crops cover a third of the farm. Conditional on the crop share larger farms are substantially more likely to lie in the Amazon. Large, pasture-dominated farms are therefore the most likely to be located within the Legal Amazon.

Figure I.4: The Amazon propensity $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ as a function of crop share and farm size




*Notes.* Both panels show the fitted probability $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ that a farm lies in the Legal Amazon as a function of its crop share of farm area and its farm size relative to the median (farm size is farmed area, crops plus pasture; the size axis is in levels on log spacing). The left panel plots the fitted surface with contour lines at intervals of $0.1$; the right panel shows the same surface as a heatmap with labeled contours. Estimated by a logistic regression with cubic polynomials in the crop share and in log relative farm size, plus their interaction, on 6.7 million farms in the 2003 CAR cross section.

We then re-calibrate $\varepsilon_h$ and $\varepsilon_p$ with the propensity $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ while holding all other parameters at their baseline values. Table I.4 compares the two calibrations. Both land-use elasticities are essentially unchanged, with $\varepsilon_h = 3.25$ and $\varepsilon_p = 1.98$ against $3.10$ and $1.95$ from our baseline estimation using $\hat{\beta}(s_c)$

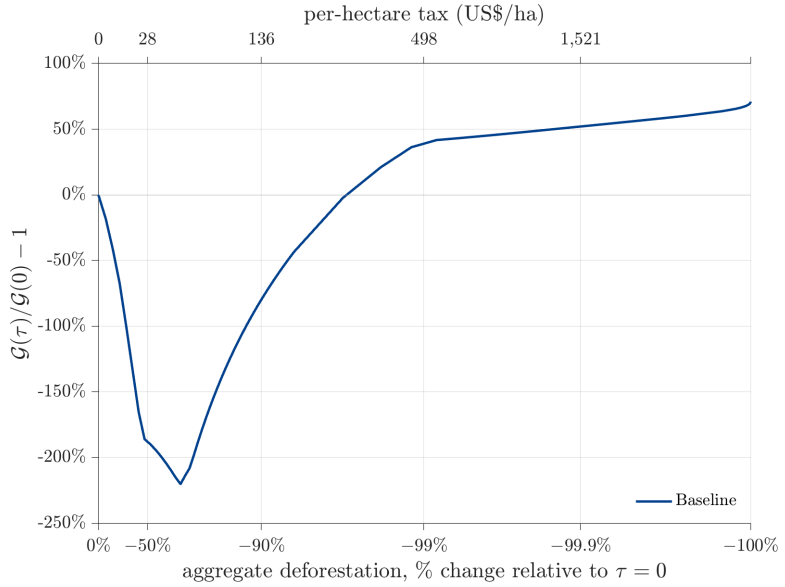
Table I.4: Land elasticities and targeted land-use responses under the size-augmented bridge

| | Data | Baseline $\hat{\beta}(s_c)$ | Bivariate $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| $\varepsilon_h$ | | 3.10 | 3.25 |
| $\varepsilon_p$ | | 1.95 | 1.98 |
| Crop-share response, Legal Amazon (pp) | $-1.84$ (0.29) | $-1.90$ | $-1.89$ |
| Crop-share response, Non-Amazon (pp) | $+0.37$ (0.17) | $+0.15$ | $+0.16$ |

*Notes.* The table shows the recalibrated values of $\varepsilon_h$ and $\varepsilon_p$ using the propensity $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$ while holding all other parameters at their baseline values. We also show the implied model response of the average crop share to a unit change in $\ln \mathcal{D}_a^*$, demeaned by the national average, where we weight each farm by its propensity $\hat{\beta}$ to be located within the Legal Amazon and by $1 - \hat{\beta}$ for the rest of Brazil, along with our empirical estimates at horizon $\tau = 4$ (in percentage points with standard errors in parentheses).

Our policy conclusion survives. Converting the tax with agricultural value added per hectare, one unit of $\tau$ is worth about US$3,700 per hectare in 2006 dollars: a tax of US$28 per hectare halves aggregate deforestation, US$136 removes ninety percent, and US$498 ninety-nine percent. At the US$42.5 tax studied by Souza-Rodrigues (2019) the model eliminates 63 percent of deforestation, against roughly 64 percent implied by his estimated land demand. Figure I.5 shows the gains from trade along the policy path in our re-calibrated model using $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$.

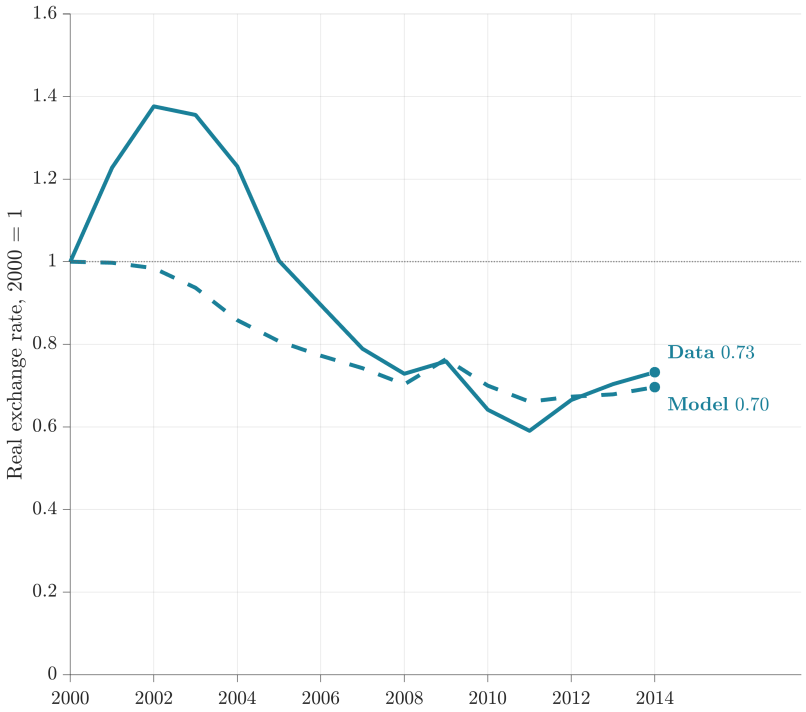
Figure I.5: Environmental policy and the gains from trade under $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$




*Notes.* The vertical axis shows the change in the gains from trade $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ relative to the untaxed alternative baseline calibrated using $\hat{\beta}(s_c, x)$, where $\mathcal{G}(\tau)$ is defined in equation (45) and computed by doubling $\mathcal{D}_a^*$ at every level of $\tau$. The lower horizontal axis converts each tax into the change in aggregate deforestation on a logarithmic scale, and the upper horizontal axis reports the corresponding per-hectare tax in 2006 US dollars.

## J The Real Exchange Rate over Time

Figure J.6: The exchange rate along the boom path, 2000–2014




*Notes.* Both series are normalized to one in 2000 and labels report the 2014 value relative to 2000. The solid line plots the real exchange rate which is calculated as the annual average reais per US dollar multiplied by the US consumer price index and divided by the Brazilian consumer price index (data from FRED and IBGE). The dashed line plots the model-implied real exchange rate $\mathcal{H}/P_c$.

## K Mathematical Appendix

### K.1 Proof of Proposition 1

The Lagrangian of the farmer problem is

$$\mathcal{L} = p_c\, l_c^{\gamma_c} k^{\nu_c} n_c^{1-\gamma_c-\nu_c} + p_p\, \bar{l}_p^{\gamma_p}\, n_p^{1-\gamma_p} - r\,k - n_c - n_p - c\,d + \lambda\big(1 - l_c - l_p\big), \tag{48}$$

with first-order conditions

$$k: \quad r\,k = \nu_c\, p_c\, y_c, \qquad n_c: \quad n_c = (1-\gamma_c-\nu_c)\, p_c\, y_c, \qquad n_p: \quad n_p = (1-\gamma_p)\, p_p\, y_p, \tag{49}$$

$$l_c: \quad \gamma_c\, p_c\, \frac{y_c}{l_c} = \lambda, \qquad l_p: \quad \gamma_p\, p_p\, \frac{y_p}{\bar{l}_p}\Big(\frac{\bar{l}_p}{l_p}\Big)^{\frac{1}{\varepsilon_p}} = \lambda, \qquad d: \quad \gamma_p\, p_p\, \frac{y_p}{\bar{l}_p}\Big(\frac{\bar{l}_p}{d}\Big)^{\frac{1}{\varepsilon_p}} = c. \tag{50}$$

Since $\lambda = \gamma_c\, p_c\, y_c / l_c > 0$, the plot constraint binds, $l_c + l_p = 1$, and dividing the $l_p$ condition by the $d$ condition in (50) gives the shadow value of owned land, $\lambda = c\,(d/l_p)^{1/\varepsilon_p}$.

Substituting the input conditions (49) and the inverse demands into the technologies yields the revenue functions

$$p_c\, y_c = \Big[\Big(\frac{\nu_c}{r}\Big)^{\nu_c}(1-\gamma_c-\nu_c)^{1-\gamma_c-\nu_c}\Big]^{\frac{\eta-1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}} \big(\rho\, p^w\big)^{\frac{\eta}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}}\; l_c^{\frac{\gamma_c(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}}, \tag{51}$$

$$p_p\, y_p = (1-\gamma_p)^{\frac{(1-\gamma_p)(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)}} \big((1-\rho)\, p^w\big)^{\frac{\eta}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)}}\, \bar{l}_p^{\frac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)}}. \tag{52}$$

Totally differentiating the land conditions (50), the binding plot constraint, and the revenues (51)–(52) with respect to $\ln p^w$, and eliminating $d\ln \bar{l}_p$, $d\ln l_p^*$, and $d\ln d^*$, yields

$$\frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} = \frac{\dfrac{\eta}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \dfrac{\eta}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)} + \dfrac{\eta\,\varepsilon_p}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}\Big(\dfrac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \dfrac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\Big)\Big(\dfrac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}}{-\dfrac{1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}\Big[1-\varepsilon_p\Big(\dfrac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \dfrac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\Big)\Big(\dfrac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}\Big] - \dfrac{l_c}{l_p}\cdot\dfrac{1}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)}}, \tag{53}$$

where $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} \in [0,1]$ is the cleared-land share of the pasture composite and

$$\frac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p} = \frac{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)-\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_p\big[1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)\big]} > 0 \qquad \text{if } \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_p(\eta-1). \tag{54}$$

It can be shown that the denominator of (53) is bounded away from zero,

$$\begin{aligned} &-\frac{1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}\Big[1-\varepsilon_p\Big(\frac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\Big)\Big(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}\Big] - \frac{l_c}{l_p}\cdot\frac{1}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} \\ &\quad\le -\frac{\varepsilon_p}{\big[1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)\big]\big[1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)\big]} < 0 \qquad \text{if } \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_p(\eta-1) \end{aligned} \tag{55}$$

and that the equilibrium has the limiting behavior

$$\lim_{c\to 0}\Big(\frac{d^*}{\bar{l}_p^*}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} = 1, \qquad \lim_{c\to 0}\frac{l_c^*}{l_p^*} = 0, \qquad \lim_{c\to\infty}\Big(\frac{d^*}{\bar{l}_p^*}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} = 0 \qquad \text{(the last two if } \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)). \tag{56}$$

**Part (i).** Since the denominator of (53) is strictly negative by (55), $d\ln l_c^*/d\ln p^w < 0$ iff the numerator of (53) is positive; rearranging the numerator, using (54),

$$\frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} < 0 \quad \text{iff} \quad \Big(\frac{d^*}{\bar{l}_p^*}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} > \frac{(\eta-1)(\gamma_p-\gamma_c)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)-\varepsilon_p}. \tag{57}$$

The constant on the right side of (57) satisfies

$$0 < \frac{(\eta-1)(\gamma_p-\gamma_c)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)-\varepsilon_p} < 1 \qquad \text{if } \gamma_c < \gamma_p \text{ and } 1 < \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_c(\eta-1). \tag{58}$$

The share $(d^*/\bar{l}_p^*)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ is continuous and strictly decreasing in $c$ and falls from 1 to 0 by (56); by continuity and monotonicity it crosses the constant in (57) exactly once, from above, at some $c^\star > 0$. Hence

$$\frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} < 0 \ \text{ for } c < c^\star, \qquad \frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} > 0 \ \text{ for } c > c^\star \qquad \text{if } \gamma_c < \gamma_p \text{ and } 1 < \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_c(\eta-1). \tag{59}$$

Fix $c < c^\star$. Differentiating the binding plot constraint $l_c + l_p = 1$ gives

$$\frac{d\ln l_p^*}{d\ln p^w} = -\frac{l_c}{l_p}\,\frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} > 0. \tag{60}$$

Substituting (60) into the $d$ condition in (50), totally differentiated with respect to $\ln p^w$, and solving for $d\ln d^*/d\ln p^w$,

$$\frac{d\ln d^*}{d\ln p^w} = \frac{\dfrac{\eta}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} + \left[\dfrac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \dfrac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\right]\left(\dfrac{l_p}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \dfrac{d\ln l_p^*}{d\ln p^w}}{\dfrac{1}{\varepsilon_p}\left[1-\varepsilon_p\left(\dfrac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \dfrac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\right)\left(\dfrac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}\right]} > 0, \tag{61}$$

where the numerator is positive by (54) and (60), and it can be shown that the denominator satisfies $1-\varepsilon_p\left(\frac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\right)(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} \geq \varepsilon_p/\left[1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)\right] > 0$. Finally, differentiating $\ln s_c^* = \ln l_c^* - \ln(1+d^*)$,

$$\frac{d\ln s_c^*}{d\ln p^w} = \frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} - \frac{d^*}{1+d^*}\frac{d\ln d^*}{d\ln p^w} < 0, \tag{62}$$

where the first term is negative by (59) and the second by (61). This proves part (i): if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ and $1 < \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)$, then

$$\frac{d\ln d^*}{d\ln p^w} > 0, \quad \frac{d\ln s_c^*}{d\ln p^w} < 0 \text{ for } c < c^\star, \qquad \text{and} \qquad \frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w} > 0 \text{ for } c > c^\star.$$

**Part (ii).** By the capital condition in (49) and the crop revenue (51), $rk^* = \nu_c\, p_c y_c$, so

$$\frac{d\ln(rk^*)}{d\ln p^w} = \frac{\eta}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)} + \frac{\gamma_c(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_c(\eta-1)}\frac{d\ln l_c^*}{d\ln p^w}, \tag{63}$$

which is negative iff $d\ln l_c^*/d\ln p^w < -\eta/\gamma_c(\eta-1)$. Substituting (53) into this inequality and multiplying through by the denominator of (53), negative by (55), yields: $d\ln(rk^*)/d\ln p^w < 0$ iff

$$\begin{aligned}&\frac{\eta}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\eta}{\gamma_c(\eta-1)} + \frac{\eta\,\varepsilon_p}{\gamma_c(\eta-1)}\left(\frac{\gamma_p(\eta-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}\right)\left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \\ &\quad - \frac{\eta}{\gamma_c(\eta-1)\left[1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)\right]}\frac{l_c}{l_p} > 0 \qquad \text{if } \varepsilon_p < 1+\gamma_p(\eta-1).\end{aligned} \tag{64}$$

The left side of (64) is continuous and strictly decreasing in $c$: $(d^*/\bar{l}_p^*)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ is strictly decreasing and enters with a positive coefficient by (54), while $l_c^*/l_p^*$ is strictly increasing and enters with a negative coefficient. Evaluating the left side of (64) at the limits (56), it can be shown that its limit as $c \to 0$ equals

$$\frac{\eta\left[\gamma_c(\eta-1)-\varepsilon_p\right]}{\gamma_c(\eta-1)\left[1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)\right]} > 0 \qquad \text{if } \varepsilon_p < \gamma_c(\eta-1), \tag{65}$$

while its limit as $c \to \infty$ is at most

$$\frac{\eta}{1+\gamma_p(\eta-1)} - \frac{\eta}{\gamma_c(\eta-1)} < 0 \qquad \text{if } \gamma_c(\eta-1) < 1+\gamma_p(\eta-1), \tag{66}$$

which holds if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$. By continuity and monotonicity, the left side of (64) crosses zero exactly once, at some $\bar{c} > 0$, so that by (64)

$$\frac{d\ln(rk^*)}{d\ln p^w} < 0 \text{ for } c < \bar{c}, \qquad \frac{d\ln(rk^*)}{d\ln p^w} > 0 \text{ for } c > \bar{c} \qquad \text{if } \gamma_c < \gamma_p \text{ and } 1 < \varepsilon_p < \gamma_c(\eta-1). \tag{67}$$

For $c \geq c^\star$, $d\ln l_c^*/d\ln p^w > 0$ by (59), so $d\ln(rk^*)/d\ln p^w > 0$ by (63); then the left side of (64) is negative, by (64) with both inequalities reversed. If $\bar{c} \geq c^\star$, the left side of (64) would be both zero and

negative at $c = \bar{c}$, a contradiction. Hence $\bar{c} < c^\star$. This proves part (ii): if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ and $1 < \varepsilon_p < \gamma_c(\eta - 1)$, then

$$\frac{d\ln(rk^*)}{d\ln p^w} < 0 \ \text{ for } c < \bar{c}, \qquad \frac{d\ln(rk^*)}{d\ln p^w} > 0 \ \text{ for } c > \bar{c}, \qquad 0 < \bar{c} < c^\star,$$

which completes the proof. □

### K.2 General Equilibrium Model

#### K.2.1 Setup

Consider a farm with draws $(z, c)$ and technology $A_i \in \{A_t, A_m\}$, taking $Y_a$, $P_{d,a}$, and $P_n$ as given. We assume

$$\eta_a > 1, \qquad \varepsilon_p > 1, \qquad \gamma_c \le \gamma_p, \qquad \gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) < \varepsilon_h - 1, \qquad \frac{1}{\varepsilon_h} + \frac{\gamma_c}{\varepsilon_p}(\eta_a - 1) > 1. \tag{68}$$

The last condition in (68) is equivalent to $\varepsilon_p \frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h} < \gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)$. Combined with $\gamma_c(\eta_a - 1) \le \gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) < \varepsilon_h - 1$, this implies

$$\varepsilon_p < \varepsilon_h, \qquad \varepsilon_p - 1 < \gamma_c(\eta_a - 1) \le \gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) < \varepsilon_h - 1. \tag{69}$$

The Lagrangian of the farm problem is

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{L} = {} & \rho\, p_d^c \Big(\frac{p_d^c}{P_{d,a}}\Big)^{-\eta_a} Y_a + (1-\rho)\, p_d^p \Big(\frac{p_d^p}{P_{d,a}}\Big)^{-\eta_a} Y_a - P_n(x_c + x_p) - (n_c + n_p) - (P_n c + \tau)\, d \\
& + \lambda^c \left[ z A_i\, l_c^{\gamma_c} x_c^{\nu_c} n_c^{1-\nu_c-\gamma_c} - \rho \Big(\frac{p_d^c}{P_{d,a}}\Big)^{-\eta_a} Y_a \right] \\
& + \lambda^p \left[ z \Big( l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} + d^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} \Big)^{\frac{\gamma_p \varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_p - 1}} x_p^{\nu_p} n_p^{1-\nu_p-\gamma_p} - (1-\rho) \Big(\frac{p_d^p}{P_{d,a}}\Big)^{-\eta_a} Y_a \right] \\
& + \mu \left[ h - \Big( l_c^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} + l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} \Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h}{\varepsilon_h - 1}} \right],
\end{aligned} \tag{70}$$

where $\lambda^c$ and $\lambda^p$ are Lagrange multipliers, $\mu \ge 0$ is the shadow value of plot land, and $\bar{l}_p = \big( l_p^{(\varepsilon_p - 1)/\varepsilon_p} + d^{(\varepsilon_p - 1)/\varepsilon_p} \big)^{\varepsilon_p/(\varepsilon_p - 1)}$. The FOCs are

$$\begin{aligned}
p_d^c: \quad & \lambda^c = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, p_d^c, & p_d^p: \quad & \lambda^p = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, p_d^p, \\
x_c: \quad & P_n x_c = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, \nu_c\, p_d^c\, y^c, & x_p: \quad & P_n x_p = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, \nu_p\, p_d^p\, y^p, \\
n_c: \quad & n_c = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, (1 - \nu_c - \gamma_c)\, p_d^c\, y^c, & n_p: \quad & n_p = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, (1 - \nu_p - \gamma_p)\, p_d^p\, y^p,
\end{aligned} \tag{71}$$

and the FOCs for $l_c$, $l_p$, and $d$ are

$$l_c: \quad \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, \gamma_c\, p_d^c\, y^c = \mu\, h^{\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h}}\, l_c^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}, \tag{72}$$

$$l_p: \quad \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, \gamma_p\, p_d^p\, y^p \Big(\frac{l_p}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} = \mu\, h^{\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h}}\, l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}, \tag{73}$$

$$d: \quad \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\,\gamma_p\, p_d^p\, y^p \Big(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} = (P_n c + \tau)\, d. \tag{74}$$

Since (72) gives $\mu = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\,\gamma_c\, p_d^c\, y^c\, h^{-\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h}}\, l_c^{-\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} > 0$, the plot constraint binds, such that

$$l_c^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} + l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} = h^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}, \qquad \bar{l}_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} = l_p^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} + d^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}}. \tag{75}$$

Dividing (74) by (73) and rearranging,

$$\frac{d}{l_p} = \left[\frac{\mu\,(h/l_p)^{\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h}}}{P_n c + \tau}\right]^{\varepsilon_p}, \qquad \Big(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} = \frac{1}{1 + \big(\frac{l_p}{d}\big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}}}. \tag{76}$$

Substituting the FOCs for $x_c$ and $n_c$ and $y^c = \rho\,(p_d^c/P_{d,a})^{-\eta_a} Y_a$ into $y^c = z A_i\, l_c^{\gamma_c} x_c^{\nu_c} n_c^{1-\nu_c-\gamma_c}$ and solving for $p_d^c\, y^c$ yields

$$p_d^c\, y^c = \big(\rho\, P_{d,a}^{\eta_a} Y_a\big)^{\frac{1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}} \left[z A_i \Big(\frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\Big)^{1-\gamma_c} \Big(\frac{\nu_c}{P_n}\Big)^{\nu_c} (1-\nu_c-\gamma_c)^{1-\nu_c-\gamma_c}\right]^{\frac{\eta_a - 1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}} l_c^{\frac{\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}{1+\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}}, \tag{77}$$

and similarly for $p_d^p\, y^p$:

$$p_d^p\, y^p = \big((1-\rho)\, P_{d,a}^{\eta_a} Y_a\big)^{\frac{1}{1+\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)}} \left[z \Big(\frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\Big)^{1-\gamma_p} \Big(\frac{\nu_p}{P_n}\Big)^{\nu_p} (1-\nu_p-\gamma_p)^{1-\nu_p-\gamma_p}\right]^{\frac{\eta_a - 1}{1+\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)}} \bar{l}_p^{\frac{\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)}{1+\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)}}. \tag{78}$$

Substituting (71) and (72)–(75) into the objective yields operating profit

$$\pi_i^o = \frac{p_d^c\, y^c + p_d^p\, y^p}{\eta_a} + \mu\, h. \tag{79}$$

By the envelope theorem it can then be shown that

$$\frac{\partial \pi_i^o}{\partial \tau} = -d, \qquad \frac{\partial \pi_i^o}{\partial \ln A_i} = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a}\, p_d^c\, y^c. \tag{80}$$

Integrating gives

$$\pi_m^o - \pi_t^o = \frac{\eta_a - 1}{\eta_a} \int_{\ln A_t}^{\ln A_m} p_d^c\, y^c(z, c, A)\; d \ln A. \tag{81}$$

Totally differentiating (72)–(75) and eliminating $d\ln(p_d^c\, y^c)$ and $d\ln(p_d^p\, y^p)$ by (77)–(78) yields

$$d \ln l_c = \frac{\varepsilon_h \Big[d \ln\big(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a} Y_a\big) + (\eta_a - 1)\big(d \ln z + d \ln A_i\big) - M_c\, d \ln \mu\Big]}{\varepsilon_h - M_c}, \tag{82}$$

$$\begin{aligned} d \ln l_p = \frac{\varepsilon_h}{\varepsilon_h - M_p} \Big[&d \ln\big(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a} Y_a\big) + (\eta_a - 1)\, d \ln z - M_p\, d \ln \mu \\ &- \Big(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}} \big[\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)\big]\, d \ln(P_n c + \tau)\Big], \end{aligned} \tag{83}$$

$$d \ln d = \Big(1 - \frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_h}\Big)\, d \ln l_p + \varepsilon_p \big[d \ln \mu - d \ln(P_n c + \tau)\big], \tag{84}$$

$$0 = \Big(\frac{l_c}{h}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} d \ln l_c + \Big(\frac{l_p}{h}\Big)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}} d \ln l_p, \tag{85}$$

where

$$M_c \equiv 1+\gamma_c(\eta_a-1) \qquad \text{and} \qquad M_p \equiv 1+\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)\left(\frac{l_p}{l_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}+(\varepsilon_p-1)\left(\frac{d}{l_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}. \tag{86}$$

By (69), $1<M_c,M_p<\varepsilon_h$, so both denominators are strictly positive. Substituting (82)–(83) into (85) and multiplying by $\frac{1}{\varepsilon_h}(\varepsilon_h-M_c)(\varepsilon_h-M_p)>0$,

$$\begin{aligned}0=&\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_p)\Big[d\ln\big(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)+(\eta_a-1)\big(d\ln z+d\ln A_i\big)-M_c\,d\ln\mu\Big]\\&+\left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_c)\Big[d\ln\big(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)+(\eta_a-1)\,d\ln z-M_p\,d\ln\mu\\&\qquad-\left(\frac{d}{l_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}}\big[\gamma_p(\eta_a-1)-(\varepsilon_p-1)\big]\,d\ln(P_nc+\tau)\Big],\end{aligned} \tag{87}$$

which pins down $d\ln\mu$. Since both coefficients are strictly positive, the two brackets in (87) have opposite signs, and by (82)–(83) $d\ln l_c$ and $d\ln l_p$ have the same sign as the first and the second bracket, respectively.

### K.2.2 Hump-Shaped Modernization Gains

Consider a common shift $d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)$ at fixed $A_i$ and $P_nc+\tau$. Solving (87),

$$\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}=\frac{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_p)+\left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_c)}{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_p)\,M_c+\left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h-M_c)\,M_p}>0. \tag{88}$$

Log-differentiating (72),

$$d\ln(p_d^c\,y^c)=d\ln\mu+\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}\,d\ln l_c, \tag{89}$$

and substituting (82) into (89),

$$\left.\frac{d\ln(p_d^c\,y^c)}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}\right|_{A_i}=\frac{\dfrac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}-\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)\dfrac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}}{\dfrac{\varepsilon_h-M_c}{\varepsilon_h}}. \tag{90}$$

Differentiating (81) under the integral and substituting (90),

$$\frac{d\big[\pi_m^o-\pi_t^o\big]}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}=\frac{\eta_a-1}{\eta_a}\int_{\ln A_t}^{\ln A_m}p_d^c\,y^c\,\frac{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}-\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}}{\frac{\varepsilon_h-M_c}{\varepsilon_h}}\,d\ln A. \tag{91}$$

Since $p_d^c\,y^c>0$ and $\varepsilon_h-M_c>0$, it can be shown that the gain is increasing (decreasing) whenever, for every $A_i\in[A_t,A_m]$,

$$\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}\;<\;(>)\;\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h\,\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}. \tag{92}$$

Suppose $M_p\geq M_c$, then indeed by (88)

$$\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\big(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\big)}\;\leq\;\frac{1}{M_c}\;=\;\frac{1}{1+\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}\;<\;\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h\,\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}, \tag{93}$$

where the last inequality follows from $\gamma_c(\eta_a - 1) < \varepsilon_h - 1$ in (69). Subtracting the two definitions in (86) and eliminating $(l_p/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} = 1 - (d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ by (75),

$$M_p - M_c = (\gamma_p - \gamma_c)(\eta_a - 1) - \left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \big[\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)\big], \tag{94}$$

so, given $\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1) > 0$ from (69),

$$M_p \geq M_c \quad \text{if and only if} \quad \left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \leq \frac{(\gamma_p - \gamma_c)(\eta_a - 1)}{\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)}\,. \tag{95}$$

By (92), (93), and (95), the modernization gain is therefore strictly increasing whenever $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ lies below the right-hand side of (95).

Let $z \to \infty$, then it is straightforward to show that

$$\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p} \to \infty \qquad \text{and} \qquad l_c \to 0. \tag{96}$$

By (76), $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} \to 1$, such that by (86) $M_p \to \varepsilon_p$, and taking these limits in (88),

$$\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln\left(z^{\eta_a-1}P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\right)} \longrightarrow \frac{1}{\varepsilon_p} > \frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h\,\gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)}\,,$$

where the inequality follows from the last condition in (68). Hence, by (92), the modernization gain is strictly decreasing for all sufficiently large $z$. Moreover, the numerator on the right-hand side of (90) tends to $\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h} - \frac{\gamma_c(\eta_a-1)}{\varepsilon_p} < 0$, so the right-hand side of (90) is eventually negative and bounded away from zero, such that $p_d^c\, y^c \to 0$, and, by (81),

$$\pi_m^o - \pi_t^o \longrightarrow 0 \qquad \text{as } z \to \infty. \tag{97}$$

It follows that the set $\{z : \pi_m^o - \pi_t^o \geq P_n\kappa_{ma}\}$ is bounded, so $\overline{z}_{ma}(c) < \infty$.

### K.2.3 Proof of Proposition 2

*Part (1).* By the envelope theorem $\partial\pi_t^o/\partial\ln\left(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\right) = (p_d^c y^c + p_d^p y^p)/\eta_a > 0$. Totally differentiating $\pi_t^o(z_{ta}(c), c) = \kappa_{ta}$ therefore gives

$$\frac{\partial\ln z_{ta}(c)}{\partial\ln P_{d,a}} = -\frac{\eta_a}{\eta_a - 1} < 0 \qquad \text{for all } c. \tag{98}$$

We set $d\ln\left(P_{d,a}^{\eta_a}Y_a\right) = \eta_a\, d\ln P_{d,a} > 0$ and $d\ln z = d\ln A_i = d\ln(P_n c + \tau) = 0$ in (87). By (88), $d\ln\mu/d\ln P_{d,a} > 0$. The difference between the first and the second bracket of (87) equals $(M_p - M_c)\, d\ln\mu$, and since the two brackets have opposite signs, the first bracket, and hence $d\ln l_c/d\ln P_{d,a}$, is positive if and only if $M_p > M_c$. Thus, by (94)–(95),

$$\begin{aligned} &\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln P_{d,a}} < 0 \quad \text{if} \quad \left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} > q, \\ &\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln P_{d,a}} > 0 \quad \text{if} \quad \left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} < q, \end{aligned} \qquad \text{where} \quad q \equiv \frac{(\gamma_p - \gamma_c)(\eta_a - 1)}{\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)}\,. \tag{99}$$

Note that $q > 0$ if $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$ and $q < 1$ by $\varepsilon_p - 1 < \gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)$ from (69). It can then be shown that $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ is strictly decreasing in $c$ and that, at $\tau = 0$,

$$\left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \longrightarrow 1 \quad \text{as } c \to 0 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \left(\frac{d}{\bar{l}_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p-1}{\varepsilon_p}} \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } c \to \infty.$$

If $\gamma_c < \gamma_p$, $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p}$ therefore crosses $q$ exactly once, from above, at some $c^\star \in (0, \infty)$ (by continuity and monotonicity). If $\gamma_c = \gamma_p$, it follows that $q = 0$ such that $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} > q$ for all $c$, and hence $c^\star = \infty$.

This means that for $c < c^\star$, $(d/\bar{l}_p)^{(\varepsilon_p-1)/\varepsilon_p} > q$, so by (99) and (85),

$$\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln P_{d,a}} < 0 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \frac{d\ln l_p}{d\ln P_{d,a}} > 0,$$

and vice versa for $c > c^\star$. For $c < c^\star$, by (84) with $d\ln(P_n c + \tau) = 0$ and $\varepsilon_p < \varepsilon_h$ from (69),

$$\frac{d\ln d}{d\ln P_{d,a}} = \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_h}\right)\frac{d\ln l_p}{d\ln P_{d,a}} + \varepsilon_p \frac{d\ln \mu}{d\ln P_{d,a}} \; > \; 0.$$

Finally, since $s_c = l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$, the quotient rule gives

$$\frac{ds_c}{d\ln P_{d,a}} = \frac{l_c}{(l_c + l_p + d)^2}\left[(l_p + d)\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln P_{d,a}} - l_p \frac{d\ln l_p}{d\ln P_{d,a}} - d\frac{d\ln d}{d\ln P_{d,a}}\right] \; < \; 0.$$

This proves part (1).

*Part (2).* Using the envelope theorem it is straightforward to show that

$$\frac{\partial \ln z_{ma}(c)}{\partial \ln P_{d,a}} = \frac{\partial \ln \overline{z}_{ma}(c)}{\partial \ln P_{d,a}} = -\frac{\eta_a}{\eta_a - 1} \; < 0 \qquad \text{for all } c, \tag{100}$$

and since

$$e_a = \int_0^\infty z_{ta}(c)^{-\zeta}\, G(dc) \qquad \text{and} \qquad a_a = \int_0^\infty \left[z_{ma}(c)^{-\zeta} - \overline{z}_{ma}(c)^{-\zeta}\right] G(dc)$$

the partial derivative $\partial(a_a/e_a)/\partial P_{d,a} = 0$ follows immediately. This proves part (2).

*Part (3).* Implicit differentiation of $\pi_m^o - \pi_t^o = P_n \kappa_{ma}$ gives

$$\frac{\partial z_{ma}}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial \overline{z}_{ma}}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} < 0,$$

it follows that $\frac{\partial a_a}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} < 0$ and $\frac{\partial e_a}{\partial \kappa_{ma}} = 0$. Set $d\ln A_i \neq 0$ and all other changes to zero in (87) such that

$$\frac{d\ln \mu}{d\ln A_i} = \frac{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_p)(\eta_a - 1)}{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_p) M_c + \left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_c) M_p} \; > \; 0.$$

Substituting into (82),

$$\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln A_i} = \frac{\varepsilon_h(\eta_a - 1)\left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}} M_p}{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_p) M_c + \left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h-1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_c) M_p} \; > \; 0,$$

so by (85), $d\ln l_p/d\ln A_i < 0$ follows immediately. Substituting $d\ln l_p/d\ln A_i = -\frac{\varepsilon_h M_p}{\varepsilon_h - M_p}\, d\ln\mu/d\ln A_i$ from (83) into (84),

$$\frac{d\ln d}{d\ln A_i} = \frac{\varepsilon_h(\varepsilon_p - M_p)}{\varepsilon_h - M_p}\,\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln A_i} \;< 0,$$

since $M_p - \varepsilon_p = \left(\frac{l_p}{l_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}}\left[\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)\right] > 0$ by (75) and (69). Hence, for farms that switch from $A_m$ to $A_t$ after a marginal increase in $\kappa_{ma}$ ($d\ln A_i < 0$), $l_c$ falls, $l_p$ and $d$ rise, and (as in part (1)) $s_c$ falls. This proves part (3).

*Part (4).* Note that $d\ln(P_n c + \tau) = d\tau/(P_n c + \tau) > 0$, so from equation (87) (setting all other changes to zero) it follows that

$$\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} = \frac{-\left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_c)\left(\frac{d}{l_p}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_p - 1}{\varepsilon_p}}\left[\gamma_p(\eta_a - 1) - (\varepsilon_p - 1)\right]}{\left(\frac{l_c}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_p)\,M_c + \left(\frac{l_p}{h}\right)^{\frac{\varepsilon_h - 1}{\varepsilon_h}}(\varepsilon_h - M_c)\,M_p} \;< 0, \tag{101}$$

and by (82),

$$\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} = -\frac{\varepsilon_h M_c}{\varepsilon_h - M_c}\,\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} \;> 0,$$

and by (85), $d\ln l_p/d\ln(P_n c + \tau) < 0$. By (84), since $\varepsilon_p < \varepsilon_h$ from (69),

$$\frac{d\ln d}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} = \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon_p}{\varepsilon_h}\right)\frac{d\ln l_p}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} + \varepsilon_p\left[\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} - 1\right] \;< 0.$$

Since $s_c = l_c/(l_c + l_p + d)$, the quotient rule gives

$$\frac{ds_c}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} = \frac{l_c}{(l_c + l_p + d)^2}\left[(l_p + d)\,\frac{d\ln l_c}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} - l_p\,\frac{d\ln l_p}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} - d\,\frac{d\ln d}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)}\right] \;>\; 0.$$

Substituting $d\ln l_c/d\ln(P_n c + \tau)$ into (89) gives

$$\frac{d\ln(p_d^c\, y^c)}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} = -\,\frac{\varepsilon_h\,\gamma_c(\eta_a - 1)}{\varepsilon_h - M_c}\cdot\frac{d\ln\mu}{d\ln(P_n c + \tau)} \;> 0, \tag{102}$$

so by (81) the modernization gain rises for a marginal increase in $\tau$. Since, as in part (3), the gain crosses $P_n\kappa_{ma}$ from below at $z_{ma}$ and from above at $\overline{z}_{ma}$,

$$\frac{\partial z_{ma}}{\partial\tau} < 0, \qquad \frac{\partial\overline{z}_{ma}}{\partial\tau} > 0,$$

so $\frac{\partial a_a}{\partial\tau} > 0$. Then, $\frac{\partial z_{ta}}{\partial\tau} > 0$ follows from $\frac{\partial\pi_t^o}{\partial\tau} = -d < 0$ which means that $\frac{\partial e_a}{\partial\tau} < 0$. Hence, $\frac{\partial a_a/e_a}{\partial\tau} > 0$. This proves part (4). □

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